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PREVENTIVE MEASURES

SC suggests steps to curb sexual offences in Delhi

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EXPANDED COOPERATION

India to boost ties with Switzerland

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WIDENING GAPS

The looming crisis of world unemployment

The Global South faces an unprecedented challenge

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VOLATILE PRICES

IndiGo raises fuel surcharge on bookings

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SC distances itself from Form 6 tweaks, issues notice to EC

Plea seeks suspension of CEC over allegations of bias, overreach during SIR; court takes note of post-retirement immunity for top poll officials

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday distanced itself from the controversial alterations made to Form 6 for registering new voters during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls across several States, shifting scrutiny to the Election Commission (EC).

"We are making it clear, any modifications to Form 6 have not been made by us," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, said.

The oral observation was made during the hearing of two petitions demanding the suspension of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over allegations of bias, administrative unilateralism, and procedural overreach during the SIR process.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench, pointed to how the CEC and Election Commissioners continue to enjoy immunity from legal proceedings even after demitting office, a protection not available to even judges.

> We are making it clear, any modifications to Form 6 have not been made by us... We will examine the records, look into the particular records. We would like to see some responses [from the EC] first
>
> **SURYA KANT**
> Chief Justice of India



Senior advocate Vikas Singh, for petitioner Rakesh Singh, urged the court to suspend the CEC or divest him of any authority till the Supreme Court took a final call on the petition. "But then, who will conduct elections? You have to file petitions keeping in mind the working of the Constitution," Justice Bagchi responded. Mr. Singh submitted that it was a grave situation that threatened the very basis of democracy. He requested the court to grant an interim relief on the petition, saying the "country will burn".

Issuing notice, the Chief Justice said the court would act on authenticated information regarding the allegations.

"We will examine the records, look into the particular records. We would like to see some responses [from the EC] first," Chief Justice Kant said on the plea for interim orders. Justice Bagchi added that the Supreme Court cannot be asked to "put the cart before the horse and presume that all the EC orders were issued unilaterally".

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VOTERS TO MISS BYPOLLS » PAGE 9

ILLEGAL CHANGE: RAHUL » PAGE 9

Trio wins medicine Nobel for 'controlling' neurons with light

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A trio of scientists was on Monday declared the winners of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for discoveries leading to a technique called optogenetics, which allows scientists to control select nerve cells using light.

The Nobel Assembly said the work of the laureates – Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel – allowed neuroscience to move beyond observing correlations and testing how particular neurons and neural circuits are related to different behaviours and emotions. Today, optogenetics helps scientists study schizophrenia, depression, Alzheimer's and Parkinson's diseases, and test treatments to restore vision and hearing loss.

In the 1990s, Mr. Hegemann, now at Humboldt University in Berlin, and his team found that shining light on a microscopic alga called Chlamydomonas rapidly triggered an electric signal within its body. He reasoned that the molecule involved in detecting light might be, or linked to, a protein that lets certain charged ions enter cells.

The team of Mr. Deisseroth, who is at the Stanford University in U.S., published its first major result in 2005 using rat neurons, and a year later, the technique had its name: optogenetics.

In 2007, Mr. Deisseroth's group stimulated specific neurons in the brain of live mice with light sent through a slender fibre-optic cable, moving the mice's whiskers.

Since then, scientists have used optogenetics to identify networks in the brain involved in pain, attention, sleep, memories, and social behaviours.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 8

Bright minds

The trio won the Nobel for contributions towards **optogenetics**, which helps in the study of schizophrenia, depression, and Alzheimer's disease



Peter Hegemann
Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany

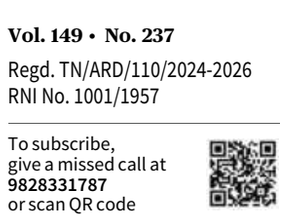
Karl Deisseroth
Stanford University, U.S.





Georg Nagel
University of Würzburg, Germany

NEARBY



Madurantakam, Dharapuram byelections today

CHENNAI
Over 4 lakh voters in Madurantakam and Dharapuram are set to vote on Tuesday as the constituencies go to polls for the second time in six months. » PAGE 4

TVK MLA upset as MP gets to light lamp before him

TIRUCHI
TVK's MLA Navalpattu S. Viji caused a flutter when he seemingly tried to take away a candle from Congress MP Christopher Tilak while he was about to light a lamp at a function here. » PAGE 4

Vijay writes to Centre for release of fishermen

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday urged External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar to take steps to secure the release of 20 fishermen from the State who are in the custody of Sri Lankan authorities. » PAGE 4

Further demands on India-U.S. deal 'very difficult': Sitharaman

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Negotiations for the India-U.S. trade deal have reached a "plateau", where it will now be "very difficult" to add to the list of demands and concessions that have been agreed to, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday.

Speaking at the Munich Leaders Meeting here, Ms. Sitharaman said that India's imports of Russian oil did not feature as a condition during the negotiations for its free trade agreement (FTA) with the European Union, which is set to be signed in December.


Nirmala Sitharaman

"One thing about the U.S. agreement, which is yet to get finalised, it has been a hard and very rigorously negotiated agreement," the Finance Minister said. "The negotiations are still ongoing but we would like to believe that both sides have reached a plateau beyond which giving or taking might be very difficult."

She added that a predominant feature of the India-U.S. trade relationship is that India has a substantial trade surplus, something the U.S. is looking to address.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 8

DVAC begins probe into T.N. 'sand scam'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) has launched an investigation into the alleged ₹4,730-crore sand mining scam which had taken place during the previous DMK government.

A detailed inquiry was ordered on the basis of a complaint filed by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) which alleged serious irregularities in the mining of river sand across Tamil Nadu, official sources said on Monday.

The DVAC has sent notice to the contractors, officials, and others involved in the scam as part of the detailed inquiry which is usually conducted for establishing *prima facie* offence before a case is registered, the sources said.

The central agency had written to the Tamil Nadu Director-General of Police on June 13, 2024, giving evidence of the illegal sand mining and requesting registration of a First Information Report.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 4

SC refuses to stay proceedings against Nicobar project

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Saying that "preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right", the Supreme Court on Monday refused to agree with a Union government plea to stay Calcutta High Court proceedings in a petition challenging the Great Nicobar Island Project. A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant instead urged the Calcutta High Court to hear the case and decide the issues without delay.

Appearing for the Centre, Attorney-General R. Venkataramani and Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati said the project worth over ₹72,000 crore was of "immense" national importance and strategic value. Mr. Venkataramani said there was "no loss of habitation" for the indigenous tribal population like the endangered Shompen tribe of the Great Nicobar Island.

Ms. Bhati submitted that the National Green Tribunal (NGT) had already twice disposed of the applications raised regarding the project. It had cleared the environmental clearance given to the project, subject to conditions and the formation of a high-powered committee to re-examine specific ecological impacts. She said even a review against the environmental clearance was rejected by the NGT subsequently in April 2023.

> Preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right... tribe culture requires constitutional protection
>
> **JUSTICE JOYMALYA BAGCHI**
> Supreme Court judge



However, the Calcutta High Court had entertained writ petitions filed by former Union Environment Secretary Meena Gupta claiming that the project violated the Forest Rights Act, 2006, and highlighting severe environmental threats it may allegedly cause.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench along with Justice V. Mohana, said there should be some degree of filtration between what constitutes the security of the state and what involved commercial interests. "Preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right. When you are talking about tribe cultures in Nicobar ecology... tribe culture requires constitutional protection," he observed orally.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 8



INBRIEF



Eye care camp conducted for Vedic students in Tambaram

A comprehensive eye care screening programme was conducted for Vedic students of Sri Saraswathi Vedantha Vidhyalaya at Irunbuliyur in West Tambaram on Sunday. The initiative was organised by TwinTech Healthcare Services to support students who spend over 12 hours a day in intensive Vedic studies. The organisers said the initiative aimed to protect the students' eye heath amid their demanding academic routine. The eye tests were conducted by Dr. R. Krishna Kumar and Dr. A. Mahalingam.



Young musicians honoured by Indian Fine Arts Society

Carnatic music is in safe hands with talented young performers taking an increasing interest in the classical tradition, veteran vocalist N. Vijay Siva said on Sunday. Speaking at a prize distribution ceremony of the annual music competition organised by the Indian Fine Arts Society at Ethiraja Kalyana Nilayam in Alwarpet, Mr. Siva said such initiatives were important to sustain and promote India's classical arts and culture. He urged the young participants to value the friendships they formed during competitions.



Jus' Onco opens sixth cancer care centre in Kottivakkam

Jus' Onco, a cancer-care initiative focused on making oncology treatment accessible and affordable, opened its sixth centre on Old Mahabalipuram Road (OMR) at Kottivakkam on Monday. The centre was inaugurated by actor and South Indian Artistes' Association president Nasser, in the presence of Nirmala Jayashankar, Senior Consultant, Obstetrics and Gynaecology, Apollo Hospitals, and Ranjan Kumar Mohapatra, Director and Head of Oncology, Utkal Hospital, Bhubaneswar. The centre will cater to patients from OMR and nearby areas, including Navalur, Sholinganallur, and Siruseri, with the aim of reducing the need for long or repeated travel for cancer treatment and follow-up consultations.

Music event to raise awareness on Retinopathy of Prematurity

Radhatri Nethralaya, a tertiary eye-care hospital in Chennai, will organise 'Nethra '26: A Night of Music and Hope' on October 10 to raise awareness on Retinopathy of Prematurity (ROP), a potentially blinding eye condition affecting premature babies. The event, featuring popular Kerala-based band AGAM, will be held at 6 p.m. at The Music Academy. ROP affects the developing retina of premature babies and can lead to vision loss if not treated early. Radhatri Nethralaya, under the aegis of its public charitable trust Gurupriya Vision Research Foundation, has been involved in screening premature babies from underprivileged families.

Chief gastroenterologist of MedIndia Hospitals honoured

T.S. Chandrasekar, chairman and chief gastroenterologist, MedIndia Hospitals, Chennai, received the 2026 ISG FP Antia Memorial Lifetime Achievement Award of the Indian Society of Gastroenterology (ISG) from Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda during the joint meeting of the ISG and the World Congress of Gastroenterology in New Delhi on September 30. World Gastroenterology Organization president Carolina Olano was also present. The award is in recognition of Dr. Chandrasekar's outstanding contributions to gastroenterology through his dedicated clinical work and research, teaching, and mentorship,

GCC completes 57 out of 63 flood-mitigation works recommended by panel

The Thiruppugazh Committee's 600-page report has made basin-wise recommendations, as per which the GCC completed works worth ₹307 cr.; the report, however, is still not in public domain

CITY MATTERS

R. Aishwaryaa
CHENNAI



Monsoon measures: GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran and officials inspecting the stormwater drain works being carried out at Tidel Park ahead of the Northeast monsoon. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Thiruppugazh Committee report on Chennai's flood risks largely remains unavailable in the public domain, despite the the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) completing 57 of the 63 flood-mitigation works recommended by the panel in the last five years.

Formed after the 2021 floods, the committee headed by retired IAS officer V. Thiruppugazh had produced a 600-page report with basin-wise recommendations and numerous measures.

As per these recommendations, the GCC had completed works worth ₹307.51 crore, including 198 metres of stormwater drains, 200 Internet of Things (IoT) street sensors, and 7,072 silt catchpits with rainwater harvesting structures within the Adyar and Cooum basin, as per a recent Action Taken Report (ATR) accessed by *The Hindu*.

Further, four works were in progress for an estimated ₹118.75 crore, and five more, worth ₹51.86 crore, were yet to be taken up, as on September 18.

An official said some bridge works, including four on the Mambalam Canal and nine on the Virugambakkam Canal, had to be taken up in phases. In Adyar Zone, the construction of a cut-and-cover drain is under way at Tidel Park at an estimated cost of ₹7.75 crore.

In Valasaravakkam Zone, Chennai Metro Rail Limited is reconstructing a stormwater drain at a cost of ₹104 crore along Arcot Road after completing the Metro Rail work on the stretch.

Works proposed

The GCC is planning to begin certain works after the monsoon, as building new infrastructure during the rains would lead to complications, an official said.

The works proposed include the construction of bridges across Mambalam Canal in Teynampet Zone at an estimated cost of ₹40 crore, and across MGR Canal on Anna Main Road in Kodambakkam Zone at ₹8 crore; infrastructure and stormwater drain works in Gajalakshmi Nagar in Alandur Zone at ₹1.40 crore; and a box culvert drain on OMR near the Software Technology Park of India in Sholinganallur Zone at an estimated ₹2.46 crore.

Following the committee's recommendations, the GCC established sponge parks in 57 locations and eco-block rainwater harvesting structures in 778 locations.

It also completed 7,072 silt catchpits within the Adyar and Cooum basin, and built 43,500 additional structures in the Kovalam and Kosasthalaiyar basin.

To improve groundwater recharge and storage, 208 wells were sunk in the Adyar and Cooum basins, Miyawaki forests were planted in 38 locations, and 197 out of the 210 planned ponds and lakes restored, the ATR said.

Additionally, based on recommendations regarding protection of waterways and removal of encroachment, 4,979 families along the banks of the Adyar and 13,484 families along the Cooum have been resettled into Tamil Nadu Urban Habitat Development Board tenements.

Pre-monsoon desilting is being regularly carried out across 44 canals using amphibian vehicles and robotic excavators, and at least 200 IoT street sensors have been installed near key waterways and strategic areas to track flood levels, the report added.

White paper

In 2024, the then DMK-led State government promised to release a white paper on the Thiruppugazh committee report's recommendations to explain the expenditure, progress of projects, and areas requiring drain repair works, besides the works already undertaken.

The State government had cited this report to justify design changes and drain upgrades, the creation of artificial waterbodies, and its request for Central funds for an 'Integrated Urban Flood Management' project, yet the report remains unavailable in the public domain.

The TVK-led government has said it would publish the entire report soon.



Gagandeep Singh Bedi, Additional Chief Secretary, MAWS, at a meeting held on Monday to review the precautionary measures being taken ahead of the monsoon in the city.

Meeting held to take stock of monsoon preparedness in city

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Municipal Administration and Water Supply (MAWS) Department's Additional Chief Secretary Gagandeep Singh Bedi reviewed the preparedness for the Northeast monsoon in Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) areas, at a meeting with zonal monitoring officers and officials of various departments held at the Secretariat on Monday.

According to a press release, Mr. Bedi directed officials to expedite the completion of the ongoing stormwater drain works, and continue desilting stormwater drains and silt catch pits. It said 1.10 lakh silt collection pits had been desilted in the first phase and the second phase was under way.

The release added that officials had been asked to complete stormwater drain connectivity works and keep motor pumps ready at locations where the works were incomplete. It said water hyacinth should be removed and silt cleared from 44 waterways and from the Cooum, Adyar and Buckingham Canal, besides waterbodies under the Water Resources Department (WRD).

The release mentioned that 28 minor railway bridges were to be fully desilted and that 1,320 motor pumps were available for use at 219 identified waterlogging locations. Measures had to be taken to prevent waterlogging in 24 subways.

The release stated that 65,000 tree branches had been pruned and removed. It also said that 215 relief centres and 116 kitchens were ready, while 36 Corporation boats and 275 boats, in coordination with the Fisheries Department, were to be kept ready. More than 5,000 volunteers had registered, it added.

The officials were also directed to undertake monsoon preparedness and disaster management works in coordination and on a war-footing.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran, Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board Managing Director T. Anand, zonal monitoring officers, and officials from the Corporation, WRD, Highways Department, Railways, Electricity Department, and Chennai Metro Rail Limited were present.

Multi-lingual Theatre Festival begins, to be held till Oct. 10

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Multi-lingual Theatre Festival was inaugurated at Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan (BVB) here on Monday.

N. Ravi, chairman of Bhavan's Chennai Kendra, said this year's theatre festival includes plays in Malayalam, Kannada, Telugu, Hindi, Bengali, and English. "These have been put together with meticulous care. Plays go beyond language; the actors' talent communicates the story and the theme to the audience," he added.

Mr. Ravi said the main objective of this institution was to preserve, foster, and spread Indian culture and history. "From a small centre in Mumbai, in 1938, the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan has become a massive complex of Indian culture, education, and publications," he added.



Dignitaries at the inauguration of the Multilingual Theatre Festival at Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan in Mylapore on Monday. M. SRINATH

The event was organised by BVB, in association with the Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL), and Nalli.

K. Venkitachalam, deputy director, Bhavan's Chennai Kendra, said the festival was not only about bringing plays in different languages, but also different cultures, sensibilities, and ways of storytelling, together.

S.G. Venkatesh, director (technical), CPCL, said he was glad such a festival was being organised, and hoped to see such festivals in the future as well.

Nalli Kuppuswami Chetti, vice chairman, Bhavan's Chennai Kendra, also spoke at the event. The event was followed by the play *Haripodogunin* (Bengali). The festival will be held till October 10.

The event, organised by Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, will feature plays in several languages

Among the plays to be presented at the festival are *Chillara Samaram* (Malayalam) on October 6, *Ladies Compartment* (Hindi) on October 7, *Ushaharana* (Kannada) on October 8, *New Bombay Studio* (Telugu) on October 9, and *Animal Farm* (English) on October 10.

MLHPs stage hunger protest for better pay

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu Midlevel Healthcare Providers' Union on Monday staged a hunger protest here to raise several demands, including job regularisation, 'equal pay for equal work', and maternity leave benefits. They were recruited in 2021. N. Sundari, State president, Tamil Nadu Midlevel Healthcare Providers' Union, said that Mid Level Health Providers were paid ₹21,000 as salary in Tamil Nadu, whereas many other States paid a higher amount.

Govt. allocates ₹812 cr. for first phase of Annan Seer Thittam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The State government on Monday issued an order allocating ₹812 crore for the first phase of the Annan Seer Thittam, under which eligible brides will be given eight grams of gold and a silk saree. Women from families with an annual income not exceeding ₹2.5 lakh will be eligible for the scheme.

The order, issued by Pallavi Baldev, Secretary to the Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department, said detailed guidelines for implementing the scheme would be issued separately. The gold and the sarees would be procured in accordance with the Tamil Nadu Transparency in Tenders Act, 1998. The price of gold would be based on the rate fixed by the Indian Bullion and Jewellers' Association, it said.

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Last date and time for submission of sealed Tender **22.10.2026, 3.00 p.m.**

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NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER THROUGH GeM PORTAL FOR HIRING ACCOMODATION FOR ESIS DISPENSARY

The Regional Director (I/c), Regional Office, Chennai, invites e-Tender through GeM portal from the interested and eligible owners of the premises for hiring of accommodation on rental basis for ESIS Dispensary as detailed below:-

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	Date of time of Opening of Tender through GeM Portal	27.10.2026 by 03.00 p.m

All other terms & conditions and tender documents are available in **www.esic.gov.in/tenders** and **www.gem.gov.in**

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CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

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SCOOPER PRESENT

"Multi-Lingual Theatre Festival" from **October 5** to **10, 2026 daily at 6.30 P.M. Today:** 6th Oct: **Malayalam "Chillara Samaram"** by Theatre Kochi. **Tomorrow**: 7th Oct: **Hindi "Ladies Compartment"** by Being Theatre. High Tea at 6.00 pm.
All are Welcome.

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ANNOUNCEMENTS

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, IRENE ROY JOJO JOJO ROY D/o. Jojo Roy Date of Birth: 02/07/1997 Residing at No.68, Anna Nagar, Thimmavaram, Athur, Chengalpattu, Kanchipuram – 603101. Shall henceforth be known as IRENE ROY JOJO

I, HAROON ABBHAS J S/o. JALALDEEN ABBAS Dob 08-06-1990 Native Dist: Chennai, Residing at No.23/2, Rehan Manzil, 2nd flr S1, VOC 2nd St, Ponniammanmedu, Chennai - 600110. Shall henceforth known as HAROON ABBHAS JALALDEEN. - HAROON ABBHAS J.

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Train derails near Fort Station, services hit for almost 2 hours

The derailment occurred around 10.30 a.m., affecting the operation of Beach-bound trains; the services were restored by 12.15 p.m., a release said

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A suburban train derailed near the Fort railway station in Chennai on Monday morning, affecting the services on one stretch of the Beach-Chengalpattu section (through Tambaram).

The electrical multiple unit (EMU) train, proceeding from Chengalpattu to Beach, was stopped after one set of the wheels of the seventh coach derailed near the Fort railway station around 10.30 a.m.

A senior official from Southern Railway said an accident relief train (ART) was deployed immediately and the maintenance staff were engaged in restoration work on a priority basis.

The derailment that occurred on the Beach-Chengalpattu via Tambaram section, however, did not affect the other line, where train services continued normally.

A few incoming trains bound for the Beach station were stopped at the Park and Egmore railway stations and operated towards Tambaram, he added. Senior officials from the Chennai Division of Southern Railway were present at the site and were closely monitoring the restoration work.

According to a press release, the wheels were rerailed at 12.15 p.m., and the services were restored.


Restoration work under way near Fort Station after a suburban train derailed on Monday. R. RAGU

'There should be no GST on MDR for UPI transactions'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The GST Council should come out with a clear statement that it would not levy tax on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) fees to be paid by the merchants for UPI transactions above ₹2,000, C. Rangarajan, former Governor, Reserve Bank of India, said here on Monday.

"I would urge that the GST Council, which is meeting in one or two days from now, must clearly come out and say that GST should not be levied," he said, at the launch of a book on 10 years of UPI roll out. The new UPI Payment Rules 2026 stipulates a 0.4% MDR fee for person-to-merchant transactions above ₹2,000 from October 15, 2026.


Dignitaries at the launch of the book, *Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything,* in the city on Monday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

While maintaining that there were no ground rules over pricing of public good, Dr. Rangarajan wondered whether it was the correct time to levy MDR, when 75% of the UPI transactions were below ₹2,000. "Perhaps one could have waited for some more time and then levied charges after it has completely taken roots," he said. In the 10 years of its existence, UPI has progressed well in the country through the good work put up by the National Payments Corporation of India (NCPI). He, however, said that there was a cost involved in running the system and it must be recouped.

"It can be recouped at a time when it is really considered to be appropriate."

Soumya Swaminathan, Chair, M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation, and former Chief Scientist, World Health Organisation, cautioned about financial exclusion of people due to the digital divide. She said it was well known that the gender divide was quite high in terms of digital access, especially among the lower socio-economic groups. While AI brings with it scope in several disciplines, such as education, health, agriculture, or climate resilience, "we have to keep in mind are we reaching everybody or are we further excluding those who are excluded from the system".

V. Kamamoti, Director, IIT-M, said that the roll out of UPI demonstrated three things - scale, equity, and democratisation of opportunity.

The book - *Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything* - is authored by Santanu Paul, computer scientist and entrepreneur and an IIT-M alumnus, and B. Sambamurthy, a retired banker and former Chairman of NPCI. It throws light on the various institutional, policy, and regulatory aspects of UPI as also the contestations, between banks and fintechs for example, and how the NPCI resolved all those.

Sundaraman Ramamurthy, MD and CEO, Bombay Stock Exchange, and Ashwin Mahalingam, Dean - Alumni and Corporate Relations, IIT-M, also spoke.

Woman dies after being hit by train while crossing tracks

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 63-year-old woman died and a one-and-half year old baby was seriously injured after being hit by a suburban train near Korukkupet railway station on Sunday.

A senior official of the Government Railway Police (GRP) said A. Moideen Beevi, a resident of Pazhaverkadu near Ponneri, had brought her grandchild, Mohammad Zayan, to visit her daughter-in-law in Royapuram.

After visiting her, Beevi was to board a suburban train to return home with the child. As she was carrying the child and crossing the tracks, a suburban train hit her. Beevi was killed on the spot after suffering head and body injuries.

The baby suffered a head injury and is undergoing treatment at the Government Stanley Medical College Hospital. The Korukkupet Railway Police have filed a case and are investigating.



Court orders fresh investigation into actor Saranraj's death

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

The XVI Additional Sessions Court has ordered a fresh investigation into the death of actor Saranraj, rejecting the police's initial conclusion that it was in a motor vehicle accident.

The judge, C. Sanjai Baba, strongly criticised the investigating officer (IO), accusing her of conducting a perfunctory and "tainted" probe to shield the accused.

Saranraj, 29, had acted in notable films, including *Asuran*, *Vada Chennai*, and *Viduthalai*. He died on the night of June 7, 2023, after a car collided with his two-wheeler on Arcot Road.

Based on a complaint filed by the victim's wife, the Guindy Traffic Police Station initially registered a case under sections concerning rash driving and causing death by negligence. After the police filed the final reports in the court, the deceased's mother, K. Mariyammal, filed two petitions, contending that her son's death was not an accident, but a murder orchestrated by his acquaintances – art directors Palaniappan, Durairaj, and their associates – over financial disputes.

Reviewing CCTV camera footage and digital evidence submitted by the petitioner (the actor's mother), the court said the car driven by the accused deliberately rammed the victim's two-wheeler from behind and crushed him against a pillar-like structure, contradicting the police's conjecture that the car hit another vehicle first.

The court also directed the DGP to initiate legal and departmental action against the then IO - Inspector Akila - for suppressing vital material evidence and filing a false report. The DGP must depute a officer of appropriate designation to conduct a comprehensive investigation and file a supplementary final report within 60 days.

THE HINDU
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We would like to place the facts on record that Tablets (India) Limited has no factory or manufacturing facility in Sri City, Andhra Pradesh. It is further clarified that Tablets (India) Limited and TIL Healthcare Private Limited are two completely different and independent entities, with no common ownership & management between them.

We convey our deepest condolences to the bereaved families. We request the media and the public to take note of the distinction between the two companies to avoid any further confusion.

This clarification is being issued to correct the record, prevent any misunderstanding and ensure that the facts are accurately communicated to readers and the public.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER

RFP No. CET - 77/2026 | GLOBAL INVITATION | PPP – DBFOT

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Corrigenda / addenda, if any, will be published only on the above websites and not in newspapers.

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Man killed after he files complaint on harassment of his daughter

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUTTANI

A 45-year-old farmer was murdered by two persons in Tiruttani of Tiruvallur district on Sunday.

A senior police official from Tiruvallur district said the victim, Yuvaraj, was a resident of Periyar Nagar in Tiruttani.

He had given a complaint to the Tiruttani police against a youth of the same locality for persistently harassing his minor daughter.

Enraged by this, the youth, identified as Sanjay Lawrence, along with a friend, hacked Yuvaraj to death. The Tiruttani police have arrested Sanjay Lawrence and are searching for the other accused.

Timings
CHENNAI

TUESDAY, OCT. 06		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:56
RISE	01:56	SET 14:54
WEDNESDAY, OCT. 07		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:55
RISE	02:52	SET 15:37
THURSDAY, OCT. 08		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:55
RISE	03:46	SET 16:17

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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From Page One

DVAC begins probe into ₹4,730-crore 'sand scam' during previous govt.

A reminder was sent to the DGP on July 18 that year, but no action was taken.

The ED had registered a case of illegal sand mining under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002. Investigators collected evidence by deploying advanced scientific techniques with the assistance of experts associated with a company incubated at the Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur.

Quantum of illegal excavation

The quantum of illegal sand excavated was assessed across all 28 river-sand mining sites with the help of advanced techniques.

The ED said in a report that the survey revealed mining beyond permissible limits. The value of the illegally mined sand was quantified at ₹4,730 crore, which the investigators alleged was the proceeds of crime.

ED officials also relied on the GPS data provided by the company which had sold the excavators used by the contractors.

Technical data

The technical data – precise GPS co-ordinates, Geo Scanning, and Geo Fencing – provided by the company revealed the details of operational hours and excavation timings of the machines at precise locations.

"The ED compared the data with the GPS coordinates of the permitted quarries and the number of machines permissible under the State government rules. The findings conclusively established that the subject excavators were deployed and operated beyond the demarcated boundaries," the agency said.

Madurantakam, Dharapuram go to polls for second time in six months

Over 2.13 lakh voters in Madurantakam and more than 2.23 lakh voters in Dharapuram set to exercise their franchise. The Tamil Nadu government has declared a public holiday in both constituencies today on account of the byelection

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/TIRUPPUR

Madurantakam (SC) and Dharapuram (SC) Assembly Constituencies will go to polls for the second time in six months on Tuesday.

Over 2.13 lakh voters will exercise their franchise in Madurantakam (SC) constituency. Out of the 2.13 lakh electors, 1.08 lakhs are women.

Chengalpattu Collector M. Veerappan said polling materials and Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) have been dispatched to all 285 polling stations on Monday. A mock poll would be held at 5.30 a.m. on Tuesday before polling begins at 7 a.m. Sixty polling stations have been identified as vulnerable. There would be a micro-observer deputed by the Election Commission (EC) in each of the polling stations. The Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) personnel have been stationed at 60 locations in the constituency, Dr. Veerappan added.



All set: Voting will be held between 7 a.m. and 6 p.m. at 285 and 320 polling stations in Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies, respectively. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

Till Monday, polling officials seized cash, precious metals such as gold, freebies such as saris and towels, and liquor bottles, worth ₹2.53 crore in total. All 167 polling locations will have wheelchair facility for persons with disabilities, the Collector said. Besides, *pandals* have been set up at polling locations for shade, and drinking water facilities have been made available. Each polling station will have live web streaming through two cameras, one inside the station, and another outside facing the queue. Out of 931 postal ballots dispatched to persons with disabilities and those aged above 80, 893 have been received.

Elaborate arrangements have been made for the byelection in the Dharapuram (SC) constituency, with 320 polling stations set up at 186 centres. Polling will be held from 7 a.m. to 6 p.m.

The constituency has 2,23,306 voters – 1,07,285 men, 1,16,013 women, and 27 service voters. Voter information slips have been distributed to 2,21,365 voters, accounting for 99.13% of the electorate. Of the 1,236 applications received from voters aged above 85 and persons with more than 40% disability for home voting, 1,201 have exercised their franchise through postal ballots. A total of 1,536 polling personnel have been deployed.

Security and surveillance have been intensified for the bypoll. General, Expenditure, and Police Observers have also been deployed by the Election Commission. The constituency has 18 vulnerable polling stations spread across nine locations.

Officials said non-voters from outside the constituency, who had come to campaign for candidates, were required to leave the constituency by 6 p.m. on Sunday, when campaigning ended. The police have been checking hotels, marriage halls, and other accommodations, while checkposts have been set up on the constituency's borders.

After polling, the EVMs and election records will be moved to the strongroom at the LRG Government Arts and Science College in Tiruppur and will be put under a three-tier security arrangement. Counting will take place at the college on October 9.

The State government has declared a public holiday in both constituencies on Tuesday on account of the byelection.

An order issued by Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar said employees working in Chengalpattu, Tiruppur, and neighbouring districts, but registered as voters in Madurantakam and Dharapuram, should also be given a paid holiday.

Ram Madhav takes part in BJP meeting in Chennai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

BJP leader Ram Madhav, who has been named as State in-charge for Tamil Nadu, took part in a meeting of party functionaries at the party's State unit head office in Chennai on Monday. BJP State unit president Nainar Nagenthran, and State and district-level functionaries were also present.

Talking to reporters, BJP leader Pon. Radhakrishnan said Mr. Madhav and the party's co-in-charges for the State Nirmal Kumar Surana and D.K. Aruna took part in the meeting, on the directions of the party's national leadership. Mr. Radhakrishnan was hopeful that his party would emerge successful in all the upcoming elections.

The BJP will organise events in all State district headquarters on October 7 to mark BJP leader and Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public service, Mr. Radhakrishnan said. He also hailed the leadership of Mr. Modi.

CM writes to Centre over arrest of fishermen

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday urged External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar to take steps to secure the release of 20 fishermen from the State who are in the custody of Sri Lankan authorities and the return of 270 fishing boats seized by them.

In a letter to Mr. Jaishankar, he said nine fishermen from Rameswaram had recently been arrested by the Sri Lankan Navy and their boat seized. "Such incidents have been occurring regularly, causing considerable distress and unrest among the fishing community. The arrests have plunged the affected families into a crisis and jeopardised their livelihood," he said. Mr. Vijay also made a strong case for reviving the India-Sri Lanka Joint Working Group on Fisheries and convening a meeting at the earliest to discuss the issues confronting fishermen and find constructive and lasting solutions.

He urged the Centre to take up the issue with the Sri Lankan government.

Court permits DMK to file defamation suit against Ministers, TVK IT wing

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday granted leave (permission) to the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) to file a ₹1-crore defamation suit against Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar and the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) Information Technology wing.

Justice K. Govindarajan Thilakavadi allowed an application filed by the DMK, through senior counsel J. Ravindran, seeking the leave of the court, as the TVK IT wing's office, as well as the headquarters of social media giants such as X Corp, Meta Platforms, and YouTube, were located outside the territorial jurisdiction of the High Court.

The plaintiff party, represented by its general secretary Duraimurugan, had filed the defamation suit seeking damages from the two Ministers as well as the TVK's IT wing for reportedly accusing the DMK of having shielded child sexual abuse case accused R. Veeramani of Gem Granites during the party's previous government.



Duraimurugan

In its plaint, the plaintiff party said the First Information Report (FIR) in the case registered under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, was promptly registered during its rule on October 7, 2025, just a day after a child rights activist had handed over a video clipping of the alleged sexual assault of a minor girl child to the police.

Thereafter, the investigation proceeded in accordance with the law on the basis of the available evidence. Making it clear that the DMK, being the then ruling party, had not interfered with the investigation in any manner, the party told the court that it had no connection or connivance with the accused.

On the other hand, the two Ministers vehemently opposed the plea for grant of leave on the ground that the suit, in its present form, was not maintainable for want of adherence to procedures prescribed under the Code of Civil Procedure (CPC). The Ministers said the DMK had failed to issue notices to them under Section 80 of the CPC.

Claiming that they had been sued in their official capacity as members of the State Cabinet, the Ministers said the plaintiff party ought to have issued notices to them under Section 80(1) of the CPC or in the alternative obtained the leave of the court under Section 80(2) for dispensing with the statutory requirement of issuing such notice.

Veeramani's drivers held on charges of abetment

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Central Crime Branch (CCB) on Monday arrested three drivers working for Gem Granites Veeramani for alleged abetment in connection with the sexual offences cases against the industrialist, the police said.

Four cases had already been registered against Veeramani, and another case was registered on October 2. Investigation is under way in all five cases. During the investigation, the police identified Veeramani's drivers – Lazar, Parthiban, and Babu – as allegedly having assisted him by bringing minor girls to him.

The police said Lazar had worked for Veeramani for 23 years, while Babu had been employed for eight years. The police also conducted searches at the residences of the three accused in connection with their alleged role in facilitating Veeramani's offences. Eight mobile phones and 55 documents were seized. Further investigation is on

TVK MLA upset as MP gets to light lamp ahead of him

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam's Tiruverumbur MLA, Navalpattu S. Viji, caused a flutter when he seemingly tried to take away a candle from Congress Rajya Sabha Member Christopher Tilak while he was about to light a traditional lamp at a 'Samuthaya Valaikappu' (community baby shower) organised here on Monday by the Department of Social Welfare.



Causing a flutter: TVK Tiruverumbur MLA Navalpattu S. Viji tried to get hold of the candle held by Congress MP Christopher Tilak at a 'Samuthaya Valaikappu' in Tiruchi on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Upset at Mr. Tilak being handed the candle ahead of him, after HR&CE Minister S. Ramesh, the District Collector, and other TVK MLAs had lit the lamp, Mr. Viji tried to get hold of the candle held by the MP, while gesticulating and making a point. In the melee, the wax candle with flame fell down. Mr. Ramesh and officials quickly intervened and pacified Mr. Viji and asked him to light the lamp.

Speaking to reporters after the event, Mr. Ramesh tried to downplay the incident, claiming that the MLA was only insisting on following the protocol. He dismissed suggestions that there was a rift among the TVK members and those who joined the ruling party from the AIADMK or its allies. "You should have seen us work [in the byelection campaign] in Dharapuram. We all worked together as siblings, and we are united by love. Do not try to create unnecessary confusion," he said in response to a question.

He denied that the TVK had distributed cash to voters in the run-up to the byelections. "I do not want to respond to unsubstantiated charges," Mr. Ramesh said, commenting on CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugham's allegation that the TVK had distributed cash to voters.

He dismissed DMK president M.K. Stalin's and AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami's claims that the public mood had turned against the TVK owing to the "rise in the prices" of essential commodities and power tariff. "There is no public sentiment against the TVK; the people are keen to ensure the victory of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay again and again," he said, claiming that the Opposition had tried to set a narrative by orchestrating a few instances of sloganeering.

Families of labourers who died while cleaning septic tank in Ariyalur refuse to accept bodies

The Hindu Bureau
ARIYALUR

Families of the three labourers, who suffocated to death on October 2 after entering a septic tank in a house under construction at Sendurai in Ariyalur district, have refused to receive the bodies after an autopsy and demanded ₹30 lakh as compensation for each victims from the State government.

The CPI(M), Tamil Nadu Untouchability Eradication Front (TNUEF), and the Annihilation of Hazardous Sewerage Killings, a people science movement, have extended their support to the families. The deceased were identified as K. Bhaskar, 42, of Srinivasapuram in Tiruvarur district; K. Dhinakaran, 60, of Alivalam village in Tiruvarur district, and K. Ramachandran, 45, of Nakkambadi village in Ariyalur district.

The Sendurai police arrested the building owner M. Subramanian of Sendurai. He was remanded in judicial custody. The autopsy was conducted at the Government Hospital, Ariyalur, but the victims' families have refused to receive the bodies, said police and CPI(M) sources. The party, along with the TNUEF, has been holding talks with officials demanding ₹30 lakh as compensation for the families. However, no headway has been made.

Their other demands include government jobs for one of the family members of the labourers, for the government to bear the educational expense for the labourers' children, and grant either a free house or a house site *patta* to the three families. Udhayan, State organiser of the Annihilation of Hazardous Sewerage Killings-Sarinigar, said a fact finding team would soon be sent to Ariyalur, and a report would be submitted to the State government.

A group of CPI(M) and TNUEF members, who allegedly tried to stage a protest at the Ariyalur Collectorate, on Monday were detained, the police said.

HC dismisses as withdrawn pleas against new T.N. Secretariat plan, free bus travel scheme

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday dismissed as withdrawn a public interest litigation (PIL) petition filed by a lawyer, seeking a direction to the Tamil Nadu government to abandon its plan to construct a new Legislative Assembly-cum-Secretariat complex on 25.55 acres of Tamil Nadu Housing Board (TNHB) land at Pattinapakkam (Foreshore Estate) in Chennai.

The First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan permitted the petitioner, R.S. Tamilvendan of Chennai, to withdraw the case without granting any kind of liberty. The litigant took the call after the judges said the case had been filed "casually" and "for publicity" with no research on the matter and without raising valid grounds.



The First Division Bench said the PIL petition against the proposed Secretariat at Pattinapakkam in Chennai had been filed "casually" with no research on the matter. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

During the course of the hearing, the Chief Justice asked, "How can you say that it is wastage of public money? It is for the government to construct [the Secretariat] wherever it wants. Please tell us, what is the power of the court to direct the government to construct a particular building at this place or that place? Where is that power? There may be hundreds of reasons, but where is the power?" "You have not even made an attempt to do any research. When you come up with a public interest litigation petition, is it not your duty to work on all this?" Justice Murugan asked.

'Looking for publicity'

The Chief Justice said, "In fact, such cases require the imposition of costs. You just want publicity, that's all." However, the Bench refrained from imposing costs, since the petitioner's counsel chose to withdraw the case.

The Bench also dismissed as withdrawn a writ petition filed by a private bus operator from Erode district, challenging the constitutional validity of the Tamil Nadu government's 'Vettri Payanam' scheme, which offers no-fare travel to 84.32 lakh women every day on 12,695 government buses across the State.

However, granted liberty to the petitioner, N. Kalamani, to work out other remedies available to her under the law.

The petitioner's counsel chose to withdraw the case after the judges wondered how she could challenge a scheme applicable to the entire State.

A.P. assures financial help, jobs to kin of pharma unit blast victims

A.D. Rangarajan
TIRUPATI

Tirupati Collector S. Venkateswar has said that the Andhra Pradesh government would stand by the families of the workers who died in the industrial explosion at a pharmaceutical unit in Sri City on October 3, 2026.

He said the company, TIL Healthcare Private Limited, and the State government would provide assistance to the victims' next of kin.

"This is a deeply painful and irreparable tragedy. To ensure immediate financial relief for the dependents, compensation is being provided to each bereaved family under the Workmen's Compensation Policy, alongside financial support from TIL Healthcare," the Collector said.

Concurrently, the State government had committed to extending complete assistance to rehabilitate the affected families, including securing employment opportunities for eligible family members, the Collector said. He added that the full compensation finalised for the grieving families would be handed out in a couple of days.

Mr. Venkateswar said TIL Healthcare would directly transfer ₹50 lakh to each victim's nominee within two days, while the remaining dues under the Workmen's Compensation Policy will be disbursed at the earliest.

Set up SIT to probe bulk filing of Form 7: Telangana Congress

Party alleges coordinated attempt to remove genuine voters, including Congress leaders, workers, family members; delegation urges Hyderabad Police Commissioner to immediately register FIR

Ravi Reddy
HYDERABAD


Complaint was made by chairman of TPCC Election Commission Coordination Committee and its members. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee (TPCC) approached Hyderabad Police Commissioner V.C. Sajjanar alleging a coordinated attempt to remove genuine voters, including Congress leaders, workers, their family members and supporters, from electoral rolls through the use of pre-filled Form 7 applications during the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR). The party demanded the immediate registration of an FIR and the constitution of a Special Investigation Team (SIT) to conduct a comprehensive probe.

A delegation led by TPCC Election Commission Coordination Committee chairman Pulipati Rajesh Kumar, along with SSA In-charge Gampa Venugopal, DCC presidents Motha Rohit, Deepak John, and Khalid, submitted a detailed complaint alleging that suspicious Form 7 applications within a span of a few days, indicating a possible organised operation.

'Organised operation'

According to the complaint, in Musheerabad constituency, a BJP booth-level agent (BLA) allegedly submitted Form 7 applications seeking the deletion of the names of Congress BLA Sharfuddin and around 31 members of his family. Congress leaders claimed the applications appeared to have been pre-printed or pre-filled, raising serious concerns over their authenticity.

The complaint also cited similar incidents in Bahadurpura and Goshamahal.

Telangana Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), meanwhile, directed District Election Officers (DEO) and Collectors to instruct Electoral Registration Officers (ERO) to take action against applicants who made knowingly false statements or declarations in Forms 6, 6A, 7 and 8.

No inquiry initiated into bulk Form 7 submissions so far, says Karnataka CEO

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Amid multiple cases of Form-7, which is used to file objections and seek deletion of names from the electoral rolls, being filled in bulk, mostly targeting Muslim and minority communities, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V. Anbu Kumar said that "in none of the cases has an inquiry been initiated by the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO)". Directions have been given to all EROs to take action as per law against those who knowingly make false statements or declarations in writing while filling forms such as Form 7, preceded by an inquiry under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

"So far, no such inquiry has been initiated, and it is left to the ERO to decide when to begin one, if an inquiry is needed. Once it is initiated, the timeline for a response is seven days," the CEO said on Monday.

Forms to be 'examined'

Between June 16 and October 4, 91,278 Form 7 applications have been received by the CEO's office. However, when asked if the figure included bulk Form 7 applications submitted across various constituencies such as Babaleshwar, Bhalki and Belagavi, the CEO said, "It may be included, while some may be rejected. But none of the voters are deleted, and none of the deletions will happen just based on receiving an objection via Form 7. A hearing will be conducted, and only following this will the deletion happen, if need be."

When questioned if submitting bulk applications was valid, he maintained it needed to be "examined" and depended on the ERO.

UDF convener meets Kharge, airs grievances over Keralam government

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

United Democratic Front (UDF) convener Adoor Prakash on Monday sought the intervention of the All India Congress Committee (AICC) to address his publicly aired grievances about a lack of consultation in the ruling alliance in Keralam, including "arbitrariness and opaqueness in key decision-making."

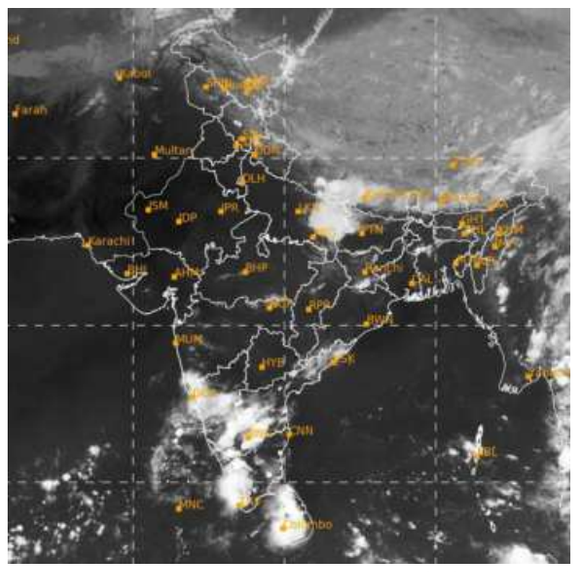
Mr. Prakash held a closed-door meeting with AICC president Mallikarjun Kharge in New Delhi. Emerging from the meeting, Mr. Prakash gave a brief nod to presspersons when asked whether he had brought his criticism, which seemed to obliquely target Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan's style of functioning, to the notice of the party's high command.

A Congress leader in New Delhi said Mr. Prakash had given a written statement to Mr. Kharge and had sought an appointment with the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi.

Mr. Prakash had seemingly targeted the government for "keeping the ruling alliance in the dark" about two key political appointments, notably those of Indian Union Muslim League leader M.K. Muneer as the Administrative Reforms Committee chairperson, and G. Devarajan, national general secretary of the Forward Bloc, as Keralam's special representative in New Delhi.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Delhi, Bihar, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Lakshadweep and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	21.2	32.7	23.0	Kurnool	—	36.6	27.2
Ahmedabad	—	36.5	25.0	Lucknow	—	35.4	24.8
Aizawl	—	29.9	21.9	Madurai	—	38.0	25.6
Bengaluru	—	30.0	22.1	Mangaluru	72	29.5	23.2
Bhopal	—	36.2	20.2	Mumbai	—	34.8	24.2
Bhubaneswar	—	35.8	23.9	Mysuru	—	32.0	20.0
Chandigarh	—	34.7	23.0	New Delhi	—	36.6	23.8
Chennai	—	35.0	27.3	Patna	—	34.2	26.1
Coimbatore	—	34.0	23.2	Port Blair	6.2	31.5	25.2
Dehradun	—	31.9	21.2	Prayagraj	—	35.4	23.8
Gangtok	24	21.2	14.0	Puducherry	—	35.2	27.2
Goa	—	33.5	25.8	Pune	—	35.6	22.0
Guwahati	—	31.3	24.7	Raipur	—	34.4	23.1
Hubballi	—	32.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	31.2	19.0
Hyderabad	—	34.2	22.8	Shillong	0.1	23.6	14.7
Imphal	—	30.2	18.4	Shimla	—	26.8	16.8
Jaipur	—	37.0	25.1	Srinagar	—	30.8	12.3
Kochi	0.2	31.8	25.4	Thiruvananthapuram	—	34.4	24.6
Kohima	—	23.0	14.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.9	26.4
Kolkata	1.4	34.3	26.2	Vijayawada	—	34.2	26.2
Kozhikode	86.8	35.0	24.3	Visakhapatnam	—	33.4	27.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.69	..69	14	... 136	...194	
Bengaluru	.30	..27	22	 66	...119	
Chennai	...5	..11	15	 63	88	
Delhi	.32	..54	76	... 175	...248	
Hyderabad	...6	..17	10	... 109	...121	
Kolkata	...9	..54	28	... 240	...147	
Lucknow	...5	..25	86	... 113	...141	
Mumbai	...9	..30	34	... 115	...115	
Pune	.15	..52	60	 67	75	
Visakhapatnam	.25	..59	19	... 148	...124	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Noida, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 268 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Gangtok, Sikkim recorded a healthy AQI score of 21

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

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Ministry of MSME Govt. of India | MINISTRY OF MICRO, SMALL & MEDIUM ENTERPRISES, GOVT. OF INDIA | KIADB Industrial Estate, Devanahalli, Bengaluru | website:www.msmetcblr.org
GOVERNMENT CERTIFICATE COURSE ON
CONTRACT DRAFTING, NEGOTIATION AND DISPUTE MANAGEMENT
Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 11 & 18 October 2026 Time : 11:00 AM to 2:30 PM
Course Content: Understanding the definitive contract checklist, Non disclosure agreement, Cloud computing & the law, Contract negotiation, **Drafting and review of commercial contracts, Service level agreements (SLAs)**, Data protection and privacy provisions, Intellectual property licensing agreements, **Vendor and procurement contracts, E-contracts and digital signatures Termination and exit management Practical contract negotiation exercises Case studies on contractual disputes**.. More
Fees : Rs.4,130/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 8603769900, 9818528498, 9686564246
Government of India certificate will be awarded

MSME TECHNOLOGY CENTRE
Ministry of MSME Govt. of India | MINISTRY OF MICRO, SMALL & MEDIUM ENTERPRISES, GOVT. OF INDIA | KIADB Industrial Estate, Devanahalli, Bengaluru | website:www.msmetcblr.org
2 DAYS GOVT. CERTIFICATE
NEW LABOUR CODES
(WITH CENTRAL RULES & LATEST UPDATES)
Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 10 & 11 October 2026 Time : 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM
Course Content: Introduction to Labour Codes, Code on Wages, 2019, Industrial Relations Code, 2020, Occupational Safety, Health & Working Conditions Code, 2020, Code on Social Security, 2020, Compliance & Legal Risk Management, ESG, Labour Rights & Labour Codes, Practical HR & Payroll Workshop, Implementation Roadmap.. More
Training is useful for Jobs, Professionals & Education
Fees : Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 9818676612, 9818528498, 9686564246
Government of India certificate will be awarded

Government of Tamil Nadu
ELECTRONICS CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI
ELCOT Angadi
9th Floor, Sigapi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai-600 008
https://elcotangadi.tn.gov.in | +91 44 2855 1234 | tenders@elcotangadi.in
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No. E-ANGADI-RC-IT02-2026-0021
ELCOT Angadi invites "Rate Contract Tender for empanelment of vendors for supply, installation and commissioning of IT Consumables through **ELCOT Angadi e-Commerce portal"**. For complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting : **13.10.2026, 11:00 AM** at **ELCOT Nandanam Office.** Last date for submission of ebids : **05.11.2026, 03.00 PM.** For queries: **tenders@elcotangadi.in.**
DIPR / 3027 / TENDER / 2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)**

TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER - II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI – 600 008.
Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589 / E-mail id – tasmac.msection@gmail.com
e-Tender
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Ltd (TASMAC) invites online tenders/bids in two cover system (Cover I-Technical bid and Cover II-Financial Bid) for Empanelment of Internal Auditors for District Manager Offices and Retail Vending shops under its control for the period October 2026 – March 2027 and extendable for 2 financial years April 2027 to March2028 and April 2028 to March 2029

TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER-II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI – 600 008.
Phone: 044 28521970, 044-28524589 NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(For publishing in the Website)
Tender Reference No. TASHO/2341/2026-T-1

Tender forms available at	https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
Bid validity	The Bid remain valid for a period of not less than 120 days from the last date of submission of the bid.
Place of opening of technical bid	TASMAC, Corporate Office, Egmore, Chennai-8.

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule
1	Commencement of download of the Tender Document	05.10.2026 at 6.30 P.M
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	09.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M
3	Seek Clarification Start Date	09.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M
4	Seek Clarification End Date	12.10.2026 at 04.00 P.M
5	Bid submission start date	09.10.2026 at 5.00 P.M
6	Last date and time for submission of Bids	20.10.2026 at 06.30 P.M
7	Opening of Technical Bids	21.10.2026 at 10.00 A.M
8	Opening of Financial Bids	To be communicated to the qualified Bidders

1. .The tender document can be downloaded from the portal https:// tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.
2. Tenderers are advised to follow the instructions provided in the Tender document for the e-submission of the bids through online e-procurement system of Government of Tamil Nadu website. https://tntenders.gov.in

Note: If any of the dates mentioned above is declared as Government Holiday or unplanned shutdown by the State, the due date will be postponed to the next working day at the same scheduled time. To enable TASMAC to meet the target dates, bidders are expected to respond promptly to any clarifications requested during the evaluation process. TASMAC will adhere to the above schedule to the best of its ability, but reserves the right to modify it. Notification of any changes will be provided to all bidders.

DIPR/3028/TEN/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Sr. Coaching Depot Officer, Santragachi, S.E. Railway, Kharagpur Division, acting through the President of India invites an open tender, through e-tendering in **www.ireps.gov.in** website as per details mentioned below : **Tender Notice no. : SRC-C-OBHS-COMBINE-011026; Name of the work :** "On Board Housekeeping Service (OBHS) and Linen Distribution for trains of Santragachi " for a period of 02 Years; **Tender value :** ₹ 75,12,26,809.98; **EMD :** ₹ 39,06,100.00; **Cost of tender document (Non-refundable)** : ₹ 25,000.00; **Closing date of tender** : 24/10/2026 at 11:30 hrs. Eligible tenderers are requested to apply for the same through online only in **www.ireps.gov.in** website as per details mentioned below. No offline tender will be accepted. Please read the tender document uploaded in the document section for details. **(PR-848)**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Chief Engineer (CON)/II/ South Eastern Railway, Garden Reach -700 043 invites e-tender for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in.** The tender will be closed at 12:00 hrs. on due date : **Pre Bid Meeting :** 09.10.2026, **Time :** 15.00 hrs. **Venue:** Office of the Chief Administrative Officer (Con), 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043; **e-Tender Notice No. : 4680-GRC-CE-C-II-46-2026; Brief Description of Works :** Construction of 4th line track work in between Gamharia-Chandil (Excluding Yards) including earthwork, blanketing, major bridges (Bridge Nos. 329, 334 & 335 for both 3rd & 4th line), Road Over Bridge (6B), Road Under Bridge, minor bridges, LC work and other miscellaneous works for 32.5T Indian Railway Standard Loading. execution of indoor & outdoor S&T works, execution of general electrical works, installation and commissioning of 2x25 KV overhead equipment (OHE) for traction and power supply in connection with the Gamharia-Chandil 4th line project of Chakradharpur Division, South Eastern Railway on Engineering, Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode; **Approx. Cost:** ₹ 301.27 Crore; **Bid Security:** ₹ 6,02,54,500.00; **Period of Completion:** 30 months; **Closing Date** : 12:00 hrs. (IST) on 19.11.2026; Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted, **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders." **(PR-851)**

झारखण्ड सरकार
पथ निर्माण विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, लातेहार
(1ST Call)
ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना
ई–टेन्डर रिफरेंस संख्या– **RCD/LATEHAR/2026-27/839** दिनांक– **05.10.2026**

1.	कार्य का नाम	कुटमु – गारू – महुआडॉड़ पथ के चैनेज 77+315 कि0मी0 में अवस्थित राजडंडा नदी पर उच्च स्तरीय पुल का निर्माण कार्य।
2क.	प्राक्कलित राषि (रू0 में)	रू0 – 4,47,63,448.00(चार करोड़ सैंतालीस लाख तीरसठ हजार चार सौ अड़तालीस रूपये) मात्र।
2ख.	बिड सिक्यूरिटी – (रू0 में)	रू0– 4,48,000.00 (चार लाख अड़तालीस हजार) मात्र।
3.	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	18 (अठारह) माह।
4.	वेवसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	07.10.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 10.30 बजे से।
5.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	27.10.2026 को दोपहर 12.00 बजे तक।
6.	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमडल लातेहार, पिन कोड– 829206
7.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का संपर्क संख्या	06565–247907
8.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	0651–2403007

नोट : निविदा की प्राक्कलित राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है।
निविदा की अन्य जानकारी http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है।
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल लातेहार
PR 391142 Road(26-27)#D

THE HINDU IN SCHOOL PRESENTS SCHOOL BUZZ
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

CULTURAL FEST HELD



Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram, Kilpauk, celebrated their intra-school cultural extravaganza 'Aakruti', themed 'The Seen and the Unseen', at Bhavan's auditorium. The inauguration was presided over by Bharatanatyam exponent Smt. Sushama Ranganathan. Students from Classes 6 to 12, representing houses Abhimanyu, Arjun, Bheeshma and Karna, showcased talent through on-stage and off-stage events. Samriddh Santhosh of Class 10 B was crowned Mr. Aakruti 2026, while Karna House emerged overall champion. The valedictory ceremony was presided over by Principal Shri. P.G. Subramanian, who called it a celebration of talent and teamwork.

ANNUAL DAY MARKED



Sri Sankara Global Academy marked their 13th Annual Day at the Crescent University Auditorium, themed 'Tavamithram Sarvada', bringing together learners, parents and teachers. The cultural showcase featured classical dances, group songs and a synchronised Western dance, alongside traditional performances and skits. Chief Guest Mr. S. M. Balaji stressed the need for empathetic parental care to help learners navigate challenges, and said discipline and patriotism must remain integral to a learner's character. The Annual Report and Prize Distribution Ceremony honoured learners, concluding with an English skit and mime on friendship.

COMMUNITY OUTREACH INITIATIVE



Pon Vidyashram Senior Secondary School, Valasaravakkam, under their Karuna Club, undertook a community outreach initiative as part of CBSE's SEWA (Social Empowerment through Work and Action) programme. Students made voluntary contributions towards residents of old-age homes, children in orphanages and destitute communities, distributing essential items, and also presented sarees to the school's support staff in a gesture of gratitude. The initiative sought to nurture empathy and social responsibility among students. Mr. M.K. Rajagopalan, Chairman, Pon Vidyashram Group of Schools, commended the Karuna Club for fostering compassion and voluntary service.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Subramaniam P: Handphone:+91 98408 98088 | Email: subramaniam.p@thehindu.co.in

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH


Smt. **JAYALAKSHMI GOPALASWAMY**
Retired AO, United India Insurance Company Chennai
Beloved Wife, Mother, Grandmother, Aunt, Sister & Friend
Attained Sivaloka Prapthi on 28th Sept '26
Fondly Remembered by
Family & Friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

NINTH ANNIVERSARY


Smt.SAROJA SAMPATH (ROJI)
18.08.1944 - 06.10.2017
We cherish with gratitude the years we shared and remember you always with Love and Affection
K.M.SAMPATH
Vasumathi, K.S. Lakshminarayanan, Sriram Sampath, Harini, Nisha & Vibha

OBITUARY

With profound grief we inform the sad demise of our beloved mother


Smt. C. SUBBULAKSHMI
(1960 - 2026)
on 04-10-2026 May her kind soul be blessed with eternal peace.
in grief
Husband, Daughters, Son, Sons-in-law & Grandsons.
Ph: 9003131111

26th ANNIVERSARY


24.10.1951 06.10.2000
MRS. CHANDRA JEYAKARAN
Fondly Remembered by
Husband : JEYAKARAN
Daughter : PRIYA PHILOMINA
Son in Law : SANTHOSHA KUMAR
Son : HENRY FORD
Daughter in Law : CHRIS ANITA
Grand Daughters : Dr. BENITTA CHANDRA, PEARLIN CHANDRA
Grand Son : STANLEY JEYAKAR

Sad Demise


Swaminathan V (Sama)
1934 – 2026
S/o Mayavaram R Viswanathaiyer (Anandathandavapuram), Retd. Manager - Tool Room, Ashok Leyland
Remembered fondly by wife, children and grandchildren

8th Death Anniversary
Aum Sai Ram


01.03.1950 - 06.10.2018
Mrs. K.S. YAMUNA BAI
Wife. of Mr. E. Janardhanan
A loving mother, a wonderful & affectionate teacher. An amazing woman. You will always be alive in our hearts
E Janardhanan, Deepak J, Shilpa J & Family
Mobile: 94440 07423

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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Good, not good enough

Without raising sports standards, India should not bid for hosting the Olympics

Aspiring to host the Olympic Games in 2036, India faced a harsh reality check at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games. Compared with the previous Hangzhou Games, where it won 106 medals with a 650-plus contingent, the country won 85 medals from around 500 athletes. The aggregate fell short of an internally projected figure of around 100 medals. It is likely to invite a thorough postmortem, given the hundreds of crores of public money spent on the athletes' preparation. India laboured to 21 gold medals, seven fewer than in Hangzhou, after a late surge of 11 top honours in the last two days, driven by the exploits of archers, boxers, wrestlers, and hockey and cricket players. It tied with Uzbekistan but managed to retain its fourth spot on the strength of a bigger haul of silver. Thirteen of the gold medals came from team events, with cricket, kabaddi and hockey making a clean sweep of titles. It underscored a stark reality: the country needs to raise its bar in medal-fetching individual sports, such as athletics, swimming, gymnastics, fencing and cycling, which determine success in multi-disciplinary Games. China, the runaway winner with a massive aggregate of 341 medals, including 169 gold, secured 54 medals in swimming alone. Barring athletics, India stood nowhere.

On a brighter note, India fielded 310 debutants and recorded a marginal increase in its athlete-to-medal ratio ahead of Los Angeles 2028. Several historic performances provided reasons to rejoice. Seventeen-year-old rookie recurve archer Kumkum Mohod dismantling the Korean women's hegemony to help the archery team contribute five gold medals was a defining moment. Trap shooter Neeru Dhanda, golfer Pranavi Urs, wrestler Sujeet Kalkal and the women's hockey team, which upset Paris Olympics silver medallist China to clinch gold after 44 years, hogged the limelight. Lovlina Borgohain, Aman Sehrawat, Mirabai Chanu, Vithya Ramraj and Gulveer Singh lived up to their billing. Boxers, wrestlers and golfers registered noticeable improvement. Olympic quota places in archery and hockey added to the excitement. Indian women catching up with men – both genders delivered 38 medals apiece – was another encouraging sign. On the flip side, India's two major contributors, athletics and shooting, which earned 24 and 15 medals, respectively, yielded 12 fewer medals than in 2023. The shuttlers slipped, while the tennis players returned empty-handed after 40 years. P.V. Sindhu and Manu Bhaker flopped. Stricter scrutiny of athletes' funding and efficient implementation of the revamped Khelo India scheme, designed with a long-term vision, are essential for course correction. Without propelling India's sporting standards, a bid to host the Olympics may become a countdown to international embarrassment.

Bird islands

India's conservation efforts must go beyond symbolism

This week, at the Desert National Park in Jaisalmer, two male Great Indian Bustards were released into the wild. It was a ceremony with considerable bureaucratic pomp; the Union and the Rajasthan Environment Ministers were in attendance. The conservation plan now has 97 birds, with nine more awaiting release. Of these, 57 are captive-bred and have produced 29 chicks this year and 24 last year. These are notable numbers for a species with a population of around 120 that has teetered on the brink of extinction for nearly half a century. It is worth recounting the bird's conservation travails. Ornithologist Salim Ali wanted it as the national bird, so that protection would follow; the Indian Board for Wildlife chose the peacock instead. Numbering about 1,260 in 1969, it dipped to 600 by 2000, and 140-175 in Rajasthan by the 2010s. Hunters, royal ones included, prized the bird, with shooting reportedly lasting into the late 1970s. The rise of irrigation in Rajasthan led to the grasslands, which were once dismissed as 'wastelands,' give way to irrigated, pesticide-soaked fields and roads making the bird more vulnerable. The most recent threat came in the form of high-tension power lines. As a heavy bird, the bustard tends to fly at the same height as power lines and has poor vision. The Supreme Court in 2021 ordered that low-voltage lines in priority habitats be underground. After opprobrium from renewable energy companies, on the grounds that this compromised the economics of solar power, the Court modified the order requiring that only a subset of the power lines – those part of the bird's 'critical' habitat – be made underground.

While the cultural links of the 'Godawan' - the bird's local name - to Rajasthan's habitat are now part of government and private marketing efforts, there are several other birds that are not as fortunate. Nearly 1,256 bird species, about 11.5% of the world's total, are classified as threatened. Skylark numbers have fallen nearly 80% and Indian rollers 30% in 12 years. India's conservation policy is captive to symbolism. A tigress from Valmiki flown to Buxa; African cheetahs in enclosures; Gir's lions, confined to Saurashtra and straying into human habitations stoking conflict; the Delhi Ridge, being planted with peepal and banyan that ecologists say do not belong to its dry ecology. The conservation ethos – on paper emphasising coexistence between the wild and human – is practically promoting islands and African-style reserves. These have merits but populations that thrive inside walls overflow into villages and fields, as India's challenges with elephants show. Landscapes, not species, ought to be the unit of conservation.

The looming crisis of world unemployment



Shashi Tharoor

Four-term Member of Parliament (Congress) for Thiruvananthapuram, who served nearly three decades at the United Nations, where he rose to the position of Under-Secretary-General. He has also been Minister of State for External Affairs and for Human Resource Development in the Government of India and is the bestselling author, among others, of 'Pax Indica: India and the World of the 21st century'

A recent World Bank forecast reveals that the global economy stands at the precipice of a silent catastrophe. A recent warning issued by Bank President Ajay Banga is stark: over the coming decade, an astonishing 1.2 billion young men and women in the Global South will reach working age, but the global economy is projected to generate no more than 400 million viable jobs. This creates a staggering deficit of 800 million opportunities in the job market, a demographic chasm of such unprecedented magnitude that it threatens to convert what should be the greatest economic dividend of the 21st century into a catalyst for widespread instability.

A failing blueprint

For decades, economic theorists have championed the demographic dividend as the primary engine for lifting developing nations out of poverty. The formula appeared straightforward: as fertility rates decline, the proportion of working-age adults relative to dependents increases, creating a temporary window of high productivity, elevated domestic savings, and rapid capital accumulation that fuelled the East Asian economic miracle in the late 20th century. Today, however, that classic blueprint is failing. Developing nations such as India are experiencing their youth bulges at a historical moment when the traditional escalators of economic mobility are stalling. The sheer velocity of demographic growth in many countries is outstripping the rate at which domestic markets, infrastructure, and institutional frameworks can absorb new labour, turning the potential dividend into a looming crisis.

Central to the dilemma is the rapid evolution of global trade, technology, and manufacturing. Historically, light manufacturing served as the indispensable bridge for low-income nations transitioning away from subsistence agriculture, absorbing millions of unskilled and semi-skilled workers into productive urban employment. Today, automation, robotics, and advanced industrial software have drastically reduced the labour intensity of manufacturing. As a result, developing nations are experiencing premature deindustrialisation: their manufacturing sectors are losing jobs before reaching the income thresholds of industrial economies of the past. Furthermore, the modern global economy increasingly rewards high-skilled, technology-driven labour, widening the chasm for millions of youth in developing countries who lack access to modern digital infrastructure, quality vocational training, or tertiary education.

There is no easy solution. The World Bank recommends unlocking private sector capital and dismantling the regulatory sclerosis that throttles domestic enterprise in many developing economies. Potential entrepreneurs face prohibitive costs of capital, erratic regulatory environments and predatory taxation. Complex legal frameworks and weak property rights scare away long-term foreign direct investment, confining capital to speculative assets rather than employment-generating ventures. Simplifying regulatory regimes, establishing transparent governance structures, and bolstering institutional integrity are essential preconditions for creating environments where small and medium-sized enterprises, the main engines of global job creation, can launch, grow, and hire.

A widening jobs gap threatens the promise of demographic dividends; the Global South faces an unprecedented employment challenge

India lags here, but does better in improving infrastructure, another key recommendation. A small business cannot compete in global supply chains, nor can it grow locally, if it suffers from routine power failures or exorbitant logistics costs caused by dilapidated roads and port congestion. Modernising physical and digital infrastructure serves a dual economic purpose: the construction and deployment phase itself absorbs massive quantities of immediate labour, while the resulting assets lower the cost of doing business across the economy.

Sector-specific strategies are ideal

Within this broader macroeconomic overhaul, targeted sector-specific strategies offer the most realistic pathway toward mass labour absorption. Agriculture still remains the largest employer in the developing world. Transitioning from low-yield subsistence farming to high-value, technology-enabled agri-tech and commercial agribusiness can transform rural economies. By investing in cold-chain logistics, localised food processing, and climate-resilient farming techniques, nations can create sophisticated rural value chains that offer meaningful, remunerative employment to young people, reducing the desperate tide of distress migration to the cities.

Health care and the broader care economy offer other possibilities for employment expansion. The demand for trained health-care workers, nurses, community health personnel, and elder-care specialists is exploding. Investing in health human resources delivers a powerful double dividend: it creates millions of resilient, non-outsourceable domestic jobs (predominantly for young women who are often excluded from formal labour markets) while simultaneously building the human capital necessary to sustain long-term national productivity.

Similarly, tourism and culture offer an extraordinary vehicle for decentralised job creation. Tourism is inherently labour-intensive, engages semi-skilled and unskilled workers and is resistant to total automation. It possesses a uniquely broad multiplier effect, driving revenues down to local transport providers, hospitality workers, artisans, and historical preservation efforts. Strategic investments in sustainable tourism infrastructure and international destination marketing translates directly into widespread employment.

Manufacturing, too, must be reimagined. Modern light assembly, green-transition manufacturing (such as the production of solar components, electric two-wheelers, and energy-efficient materials) and decentralised production networks can still absorb substantial labour if paired with agile skill-building programmes.

History demonstrates that when vast cohorts of educated, energetic, and ambitious young people are denied access to productive economic life, the resulting frustration erodes trust in governments, fuels social polarisation, and creates fertile ground for extremist or criminal ideologies and civil unrest. In an interconnected world, failure to generate livelihoods in the Global South will inevitably accelerate forced migration flows toward the Global North, exacerbating political tensions worldwide.

Preventing prolonged youth unemployment from leading to global catastrophe requires an unprecedented alignment of international finance, domestic political courage, and private sector dynamism. Developed economies and multilateral financial institutions must facilitate affordable, long-term development financing and technology transfers, while developing nations must undertake the hard, often politically painful work of institutional reform. The global economy possesses the financial resources and technological tools required to meet this challenge. But can the international community muster the collective resolve to build an inclusive global order where every young person is afforded a fair opportunity to work, contribute, and thrive? In today's climate this writer would not count on it.

As the world's most populous nation, India sits at the epicentre of this dynamic, adding millions of young entrants to its workforce each year while grappling with an economy that has struggled to match GDP growth with employment creation. The nation's immediate challenge, in a dwindling demographic window, includes matching skills to markets, persistent underemployment, low female labour force participation, and an agrarian sector that still absorbs nearly half the population despite producing just 16% of GDP (FY24). India, with a median age under 30, must move toward labour-absorbing value creation. Otherwise its celebrated demographic dividend could collapse into a demographic disaster.

America's new-age military populism takes shape



Harsh V. Pant

Vice President, Observer Research Foundation (ORF), New Delhi



Vivek Mishra

Deputy Director, Strategic Studies Programme at the Observer Research Foundation

As the second Trump administration nears the midpoint of its term, 'a rapidly changing America' appears to be a most apt description. Internal and external repositioning has cast the United States in a new light, forcing recalibrations across countries and regions. While Washington's foreign policy shifts and their repercussions have been the most palpable external lens, consequential internal changes are beginning to shake the old structures of governance, security and finance. One of the most noticeable, indeed momentous, changes is the renaming of the Department of Defense (DoD) as the Department of War (DoW) – its original historical name. This exercise in rechristening itself may be a microcosm symbolising the Trump administration's attempts to redraw the arc of America. And Pete Hegseth, the Secretary of War, is at the helm of that endeavour.

The outline from Hegseth's address

One of the administration's fiercest attacks on its predecessor was over diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI) across programmes and institutions. On September 30 this year, when Mr. Hegseth delivered his 'State of the Force' address at the Marine Corps Base Quantico, he led his administration's charge against those values, spelling out his own in turn. He doubled down on his 2025 speech to an assembly of admirals and generals, which starkly outlined his motto of "reviving the warrior ethos, rebuilding the military, and re-establishing deterrence".

A closer look at some of the initiatives and changes that Mr. Hegseth emphasised reflects the fast-changing nature of modern warfare and the need for America, as indeed for any other military, to reform quickly. The unveiling of a four-star combatant command for autonomous warfare (AutoWarCom) is geared towards overhauling the procurement, testing and deployment of drones. This is in sync with the appointment of Elon Musk, Palmer Luckey and Newt Gingrich to jointly lead "Project Meridian" – an initiative to study the future of warfare. That the study must submit its findings within just 120 days underscores both the urgency of, and the challenges to, America's war-fighting adaptability. A key aim of the Project Meridian initiative will be to place technological superiority *vis-à-vis* China front and centre. Among the other steps announced to overhaul the U.S. military is the "Fortress America" project, intended to redesign energy and cyber connectivity so that U.S. bases become self-sufficient in both electricity grids and cyber command. Towards realigning the recruitment system, the Pentagon will now work with five select universities to establish a new corps of cadets. The absence of any Ivy League institution is telling of the Trump administration's long war against elite educational institutions and the values that new-age Republicans associate with them.

America's military transformation under the Trump administration combines technological reform with the politics of populism

Perhaps the most consequential move was Mr. Hegseth's announcement of a 20% cut in general and flag officer positions across the armed forces by January 1, 2027 – double the reduction he announced in 2025. Mr. Hegseth's broad definition of "redundant force structure", which he has used as a pretext to trim the military's senior ranks, now also extends to ending new tenured appointments of civilian academics at military service academies. Besides these measures, the decision to establish an Office of Religious Affairs (ORA), reporting directly to the Secretary of War and providing religious support and spiritual readiness, bears all the hallmarks of Republican evangelical outreach writ large.

Drivers behind the overhaul

Behind the overhaul of the DoW lies a convergence of competing drivers: populism, rapid technological evolution, cultural revivalism, assessments of comparative military might and capability, and a race against time. Americans view the changes differently on each metric. For instance, while most see the decision to set up the Autonomous Warfare Command as a necessity, the removal of senior military ranks has drawn flak – as a decapitation of the military leadership from within. The departure of the Army Secretary, Dan Driscoll, in August was the culmination of the urge to purge that Mr. Hegseth has evinced.

Mr. Hegseth's measures, taken together, offer a decidedly mixed picture. The U.S. is approaching the end of a military era that began with the Reagan administration's sweeping military-industrial transformation in the aftermath of Vietnam. The strategic challenge before Washington today is therefore not simply to expand military capacity, but to undertake the next generation of reforms in defence manufacturing, technology and innovation if it is to retain its lead over China and simultaneously contend with multiple adversaries across different theatres.

Reform and strategic necessity

The problem is that the Trump administration's sense of urgency has too often conflated the politics of populism with the imperatives of military reform. In the process, the distinction between political messaging and strategic necessity-and, at times, between friend and foe-has become blurred.

Mr. Hegseth's rhetoric about creating forces with "no fatties, no trannies, no beardos, no weirdos", alongside his proposal for mandatory testosterone-deficiency testing in the annual health screenings of personnel aged 30 years and above, takes the notion of a "warrior ethos" into territory that appears increasingly disconnected from the demands of modern warfare. At a time when technological superiority, automation, artificial intelligence and precision systems are reshaping the character of conflict, military effectiveness cannot be reduced to an increasingly narrow conception of physical warriorhood.

Yet, it would be a mistake to allow the excesses of this rhetoric to obscure the genuine opportunities before the U.S.. President Trump's two terms have coincided with an extraordinary acceleration in technological change, creating both significant challenges and important possibilities for American military power. The re-establishment of the Space Command in 2019 was one such consequential step, while the more recent announcement of AutoWarCom could, if pursued seriously, have transformative implications for the organisation and the deployment of military power.

The larger task is to ensure that such initiatives are driven by the requirements of future warfare rather than subsumed by the vocabulary of populism. For the world's most powerful military, the stakes are ultimately too high for political theatre to substitute for strategic clarity.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Push Russia towards peace

It is disquieting that inspite of appeals, proddings including warnings by a raft of global leaders and organisations, there is no indication on the part of the Russian President Vladimir Putin to halt the hostilities against Ukraine that have entered the fifth year. (Inside pages, October 4). The relentless aerial attacks by Russia have caused colossal destruction. Before the situation spins out of control, it is incumbent upon the key countries which profess supremacy in warfare to step up various forms of pressure on Russia to end the war.

V. Johan Dhanakumar,
Chennai

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao

In the passing of Singeetham Srinivasa Rao, Indian cinema has lost a legendary director who envisioned concepts far ahead of his time. With extraordinary command of various crafts, he created unique and pathbreaking films.
His landmark projects inspired a generation of film-makers. Indian cinema has also lost a celluloid innovator who explored almost every genre with limited resources.

Satish Reddy Kanaganti,
Tipparthi, Nalgonda, Telangana

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

Encroachment of land in Mumbai



Santosh Karmarkar

Paediatric surgeon and social activist based in Mumbai



Slum houses and skyscrapers along Mumbai's coast in February 2026. AFP

The average Mumbaikar's plight has become like that of the poor peasant in Tagore's epic poem *Dui Bigha Jomi (two bighas of land)*, in which the poor man says to his zamindar -"O Lord, countless are the plots of land you already own, But consider – I only have land enough to bury me when I'm gone!". The zamindar brushes him aside saying – "Your half-acre will allow me to design a lovely fountain". The poor peasant replies: "Spare this poor man's land, or else he dies!"

Today, the average Mumbaikar occupies two positions when it comes to land ownership. Is he from the builders' lobby (the zamindars of today) or is he a poor Mumbaikar (today's landless farmer) whose only remaining *Dui Bigha Jomi* is being taken away from him? Zamindari exists in India's financial capital today. And it is called '*Builderdari*'.

Rise of the builderdari

The plight of the common Mumbaikar is worse than that of the farmer in Tagore's poem for he has no access to the *builderdar*. He cannot even meet him or speak with him to plead his case. And right under his very nose, he is forced out of his land – land which should have been for him; for the public; for the millions of *aam* Mumbaikars.

When large tracts of mill lands were taken over to build luxury malls and high-rises, when gardens and recreational plots were usurped, when prime plots near Railway stations were given to builders instead of being used for public benefit such as for the much needed expansion of Railway stations and bus terminals, and when redundant Port Trust land is being leased out to *builderdars* and billionaires, where does the common man go? A few months back, a prime plot of land facing the Sea Link bridge, was walled off by a realty company owned by one of India's richest billionaires.

Quite recently, this problem reached its zenith, when the plot of land which was being taken over to build a luxury apartment tower, was already being used by a public hospital viz-a-viz the Sion Hospital for more than 25 years. This happened because one of the alleged *builderdar*s in this case has been the Guardian Minister for Mumbai.

There is no denying that the Sion Hospital urgently requires more space and land to be able to carry out its myriad activities which include outpatient, inpatient, medical college and students-related activities as well as space for sufficient parking and open space for the rehabilitation of patients. The demand for indoor beds and other facilities is so huge that the conditions in the wards of the Sion Hospital, as is the case with any public hospital in the city, resemble wards in war zones. Overcrowded corridors, two patients on one bed, and cluttered IV stands and medical equipment are a common sight. And yet, the above-mentioned prime plot of land has been taken over by the *builderdars* for building luxury apartments.

Do these *builderdars*, their political benefactors and their rich clients (who get world-class treatment in the city's private hospitals) really care for the poor Mumbaikar?

This has been a recurring theme of land usage in Mumbai for decades. Converting public land for private luxury residences prioritises the luxury of a few over the lives of millions. *Chawls* (which provided low-income housing to millions) and mills have been converted to skyscrapers and luxury malls.

The courts must take *suo moto* cognisance of this matter and seek a record of all existing public land in Mumbai and the suburbs and freeze any further conversion of public land. This is a step that should have been taken long ago. This has now become imperative for saving the lives of many Mumbaikars and the life of the city itself.

Converting public land for private luxury residences prioritises the luxury of a few over the lives of millions

Disabled citizens and the future of AI



Navin Aade

works on climate, disability inclusion and AI at NClude

A friend of this author has been blind since birth. He uses Artificial Intelligence (AI) almost every day – to read a document; to make sense of a photograph; or to get through a government form his screen reader cannot open, all without relying on a sighted person for help. Watching what it gives him, independence in the small things most people never have to think twice about, the promise of this technology is impossible to dismiss. At the same time, it is impossible to assume that this promise will reach disabled Indians on its own. AI models are moving into government services, recruitment and healthcare. Behind them, data centres and power lines are rising as the Centre courts $200 billion in AI investment for the next two years.

Disabled people are being brought into the conversation late, if at all.

In the November 2024 *Rajive Raturi* judgment, the Supreme Court held that accessibility is a facet of the fundamental right to life and dignity, and that India's accessibility rules were toothless; they were merely polite suggestions whereas the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 intended binding ones. The court gave the Centre three months to frame mandatory standards. Nearly two years later, the petitioners are back in court because too little has changed. Disabled people should not be made to adapt to systems built without them; AI is the newest such system.

The Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities penalised 155 establishments, government ministries among them, for websites and apps a disabled citizen simply cannot use. While the 2016 Act has required accessible digital services since 2019, compliance remains the exception. This is the ground on which we are now deploying AI.

Inherent bias

AI is not neutral. When researchers ran 21 language models through AccessEval, a benchmark spanning nine kinds of disability, the models became more error-prone, more negative in tone, and more likely to stereotype the moment disability entered the question. A study of the widely used image model CLIP found it 15 percentage points less accurate on photographs taken by blind and low-vision users than on web images, and that objects central to disabled lives, such as a white cane or a Braille display, appeared up to 17 times less often in the datasets used to train such models. You can see this bias in everyday digital interactions as well. Tell a mainstream chatbot you are blind and want to become a software engineer, and it often opens with some version of "I'm sorry you're blind." The person asked a career question but the model answered as if they had reported a loss.

Further, a survey of 2,462 users of the NClude platform, which uses these same models to help disabled people complete job applications and government forms on inaccessible websites, revealed findings that were striking: 1,313 users said they had completed a task previously closed to them, but only 543 managed it through AI alone. The rest needed a staff member to step in. A system without that fallback leaves users to improvise a workaround.

Any AI system the government deploys should be tested for disability bias. Training datasets need genuine disability representation, gathered with consent

The same neglect is being set in concrete. India's data-centre capacity is projected to more than quadruple by 2030, to 6.5 gigawatts or more. States compete for these projects with power subsidies and duty waivers; Maharashtra this year relaxed its renewable-energy requirement for data centres from 100 to 51%. Rarely does anyone ask what the new load does to a grid already straining at summer peaks, or what the servers' heat adds to cities that are dangerously hot to begin with.

For millions of disabled Indians, this is not a distant environmental debate. Some depend on powered wheelchairs, oxygen machines or other equipment that cannot be switched off when the grid strains. Many are the first to be stranded when a power cut or an inaccessible emergency alert throws daily life into disorder.

None of this is a case against AI, or the infrastructure a growing economy needs. Disabled people should not be asked to surrender tools they depend on in the name of sustainability. Any AI system the government deploys should be tested for disability bias. Training datasets need genuine disability representation, gathered with consent. And State incentives for data centres should carry conditions on renewable sourcing and on grid and heat impact.

Disabled Indians must have a voice in helping to decide what this technology becomes, from the data that trains the models to the grids that keep them running.

Coal stocks critically low as power demand rises in India

High temperatures and strong El Nino events have increased the pressure on coal-fired thermal power plants

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis

On September 28, Union Coal and Mines Minister G. Kishan Reddy on Monday denied any shortage of coal in the country, despite data showing that more than 44% of India's thermal power plants had critically low stocks. Mr. Reddy said the problem was not a coal shortage but a surge in power demand.

According to the Central Electricity Authority (CEA), data as of September 30 show that among the 191 thermal power plants, 84 plants were critically low on stock. The CEA considers a power plant to be critical when inventories fall below 25% of the required normative stock or when the stock can support power generation for less than three days **(Chart 1)**.

While data contradict Mr. Reddy's claim, he is right about the increase in demand. India saw an increase of 10% in power demand in 2026 – the highest year-on-year increase in the past decade.

India also saw a surge in power shortages in September 2026, the highest since August 2023, according to a *Reuters* report. The report also states that reliance on coal-fired thermal power plants has increased during this period due to a decline in hydro-power generation. It links this to the El Nino phenomenon (a warming of the central and eastern Pacific that alters atmospheric circulation and weakens monsoon winds over the subcontinent).

India has seen weaker monsoons in the last six years in which it experienced strong El Nino events.

Chart 2 shows India's rainfall departure percentage over the past 20 years, specifically in the monsoon months; June, July, August, and September. The rainfall departure percentage compares the rain that actually fell against the historical average for that exact location and period. The data show that in June, India experienced its highest rainfall deficit for that month since 2014, another year that saw a strong El Nino event.

As Chart 3 shows, coal was the primary source for 79% of the total energy generated in 2024-25, according to the "Energy Statistics India 2026" report by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

The International Energy Agency (IEA) posits that unprecedented higher temperatures experienced around the world contributed heavily to the rising demand for electricity.

Chart 4 compares India's average power demand (in gigawatts) per month in 2025 with each month's highest temperatures. The country's average power demand rose in the beginning months of the year along with the temperatures, which went from a maximum of 25.53°C in January 2025 to an annual peak of 35.97°C in April 2025. The consequent decline in the demand for energy saw a concomitant dip in temperatures. In their report regarding thermal comfort in India, the IEA states that the surge in energy demand is driven by rising ownership of cooling technologies such as fans and ACs.

According to the IMD, India experienced its hottest August, since nationwide record-keeping began in 1901, along with the rest of the world, in 2026. The national average mean temperature soared to 28.01°C, which is 0.67°C higher than the "normal" temperature of 27.34°C. The country also saw its highest power demand of all-time recently: 270.8 GW on May 21, 2026.

Although India's coal stocks are deteriorating by the day, the later months of the year generally promise lower temperatures and eased power demand. However, the decreased pressure on coal stocks does not imply a decreasing shortage of supply.

High demand

The data for the charts were sourced from the the Central Electricity Authority, India Meteorological Department, the Ministry of Power, and the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

With inputs from Gauri Singavarapu. who is interning with The Hindu Data Team



CHART 1: As per the Central Electricity Authority, 85 out of 191 thermal power plants have critically low coal stock. The chart shows the number of critically low plants at the end of each month

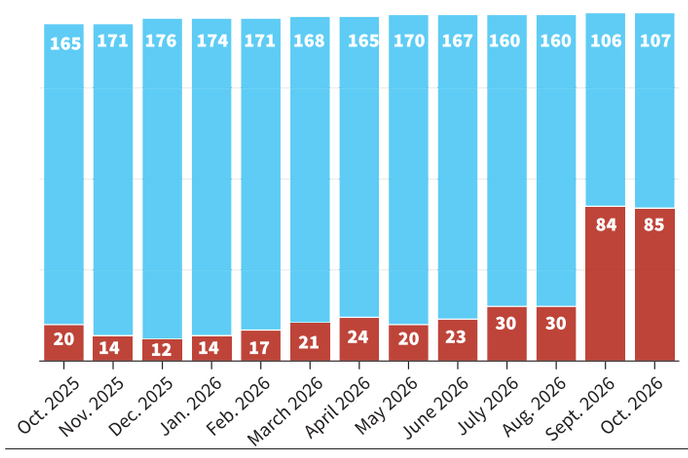


CHART 2: The rainfall departure percentage compares the rain that actually fell against the historical average for that exact location and period. The bars in red show years with moderate to strong El Nino events

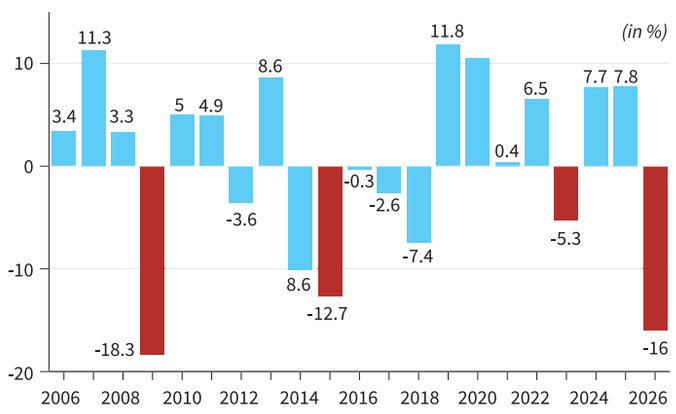


CHART 3: Coal still accounts for most of the energy generation in India. In 2024-25, 79% of total primary energy generation was from coal, as shown below

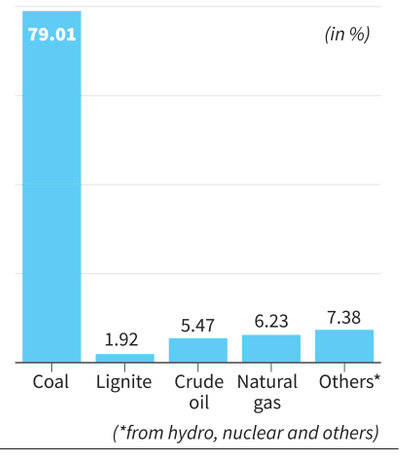
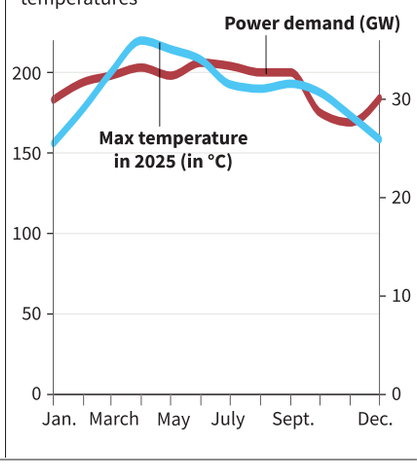


CHART 4: The average power demand rose in the beginning months of 2025 along with temperatures



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 6, 1976

Ajanta, Ellora complex to be put on tourism map

Aurangabad, October 5: Air-India which works in close collaboration with the Government's tourist offices abroad in promoting tourist traffic to India would shortly extend this arrangement to Australia and the Far East, the Managing Director, Mr. K.K. Unni, said here yesterday.

Mr. Unni, who is here in connection with the inauguration of the "Operation Aurangabad" scheme designed to put the Ajanta-Ellora-Aurangabad-Daulatabad complex on the world tourism map, told Samachar that this was being done following the success of such joint operations in the U.S., the U.K., and Europe, which had led to a significant inflow of tourist traffic from those countries.

Mr. Unni said that Air-India, as one of the co-sponsors of "Operation Aurangabad", considered this a unique example of a very practical purposeful, pragmatic and professional approach to the task of developing tourism in a region which was full of archaeological and cultural treasures. Sufficient infra-structure had been built here in the shape of a convenient air service linking two of the most important aerial gateways to India, Delhi and Bombay, he said.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 6, 1926

A huge python on board a steamer

As there was no issue dated October 6, 1926, from the issue dated October 5, 1926

Calcutta, October 5: There was much excitement on board the steamer "Creeve Hall" on Monday forenoon when alarm was raised that a python had been seen among the cargo in the ship's hold. According to the "Englishman", the vessel had arrived the day previous from Colombo and was lying at No. 6 jetty. When coolies began unloading the cargo in twin decks of No. 6 hatch, a python was observed coiled up in one corner alongside some cargo. The chief officer immediately communicated with the police and Inspector Humble of the Reserve Force and Sergeant Green of the River Traffic police were soon on board both armed with shot guns. A hunt for the python then began by the police and the officers of the ship carrying electric torches and the coolies shifting the cargo.

From Page One

SC distances itself from Form 6 tweaks

Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service, and Term of Office) Act of 2023 provides that "no court shall entertain or continue any civil or criminal proceedings against any person who is or was a Chief Election Commissioner or an Election Commissioner…"

"A protection when in office is always understood. But the 'was' in the provision is perhaps only protection with regard to the President. It does not apply even to judges… Look at the Judges Inquiry Act," Justice Bagchi observed.

Senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy, for petitioner Shailendra Mani Tripathi, pointed out that 30% of the electorate in Delhi and 25% of the electorate in West Bengal have been deleted in the SIR process. "See how SIR was conducted in Delhi. Form 6 has two new conditions added. They were circulated. Under the Schedule, Form 6 cannot be modified," she submitted.

Form 6 is a statutory document provided in the Schedule of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. Modifications to Form 6 should be done through the proper lawmaking process, and not by unilateral administrative actions.

Ms. Guruswamy said the franchise rights of the world's largest democracy were under threat. The petition said the CEC was directly accountable under the law, and should be subject to police investigation, evidence gathering, and regular trial proceedings as an "ordinary accused". The court tagged both petitions and indicated it may list the case for next week to hear the Commission's side.

Trio wins Nobel for optogenetics research

In 2000, following his alga experiment, Mr. Hegemann approached Mr. Nagel, currently at the University of Würzburg in Germany, who confirmed the idea in an experiment. The team identified two proteins that were channels, and they opened when exposed to light. The scientists called them channelrhodopsin-1 and channelrhodopsin-2. Channelrhodopsin-2 in particular opened within 0.2 ms when light was shone on it, allowing positively charged ions to flow into a cell and produce an electric signal. Mr. Hegemann and Mr. Nagel showed that putting the gene for this protein in mammal cells also made them sensitive to light.

At Stanford University, Mr. Deisseroth realised this discovery could transform the way scientists study the brain. Genetic methods could make sure the protein was associated with a specific set of neurons, while light could turn those neurons on or off. This level of control offered greater precision than previous methods such as drugs and electrical stimulation.

The laureates will share the prize, worth 12 million Swedish kronor (₹11.5 crore), equally.

More demands on U.S. deal 'very difficult': FM

"The trade imbalance with China for India, for instance, since 2014 has been growing exponentially," the Union Finance Minister said. "So, when you are talking about trade imbalance being the sole criteria, to what extent beyond negotiation can you go? Negotiation used to be the only platform through which countries could highlight the discrepancies and lopsidedness."

However, the imbalance is now being sought to be addressed through other means, she said. "Tariffs have become weaponised. So I can probably take the same position, can I not, with China, because the trade with it is so lopsided? But no, you can't. You will have to talk it out. You will have to negotiate and have a give-and-take," she said.

SC refuses to stay case against Nicobar project

In May, the Calcutta High Court dismissed the Union government's preliminary objections regarding the *locus standi* of Ms. Gupta, banking on the submission that she was not a local. The High Court had scheduled the case for November 25 and November 26 for hearing constitutional issues centring on fundamental rights and preservation of the tribal peoples' way of life.

Senior advocate S. Muralidhar, for Ms. Gupta, said the Centre's argument in maintainability of the writ petitions before the High Court has become academic as the tribal councils have already been impleaded.

Mr. Venkataramani said the tribes were integrated, and were not in the protected category.

"There is a lot of international…" he said. "The Shompen are classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group," Mr. Muralidhar intervened.

The Shompen and the Nicobarese tribes are said to be affected by the project.

The Bench said the Union government could place the NGT decisions, with whatever persuasive value they may command, before the High Court. Mr. Venkataramani urged the top court to at least allow the Centre to continue pressing the question of maintainability before the High Court.

But the Bench said it would limit itself to asking the High Court Chief Justice to decide the case, including all the petitions, without delay.

India, Switzerland to boost defence, nuclear ties: Modi

The two sides agree to extend visas, student permits based on equal treatment principles; other agreements promote research, innovation, and explore opportunities in transport, infrastructure

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI


Swiss President Guy Parmelin and Narendra Modi at a joint press meet at Hyderabad House in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

India and Switzerland have identified new opportunities for cooperation in areas of defence and nuclear energy, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said, following a bilateral meeting with Swiss President Guy Parmelin on Monday.

Agreements signed by the two sides included one to extend visa durations and student permits.

Mr. Parmelin is in India for a three-day visit to commemorate the first anniversary of the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) between India and the four-country European Free Trade Association (EFTA), which came into force on October 1, 2025.

"Today, we identified new opportunities for cooperation in military exchanges and defence production," Mr. Modi said in a statement following the meeting. "We also agreed to further deepen cooperation in nuclear energy."

The two countries also signed an agreement on transport, mobility, and infrastructure. "We invite Swiss infrastructure companies to invest in India at a large scale and participate in capacity building, design, and manufacturing," Mr. Modi said.

Mr. Parmelin is accompanied by a large business delegation, underscoring the Swiss business community's desire to make the most of the TEPA. However, the Swiss President noted that there are unfinished aspects, which will spur further investments once complete.

"To continue stimulating investment, Switzerland hopes to conclude an investment protection agreement quickly," Mr. Parmelin said. "In this context, it is equally important to achieve results in the discussions on intellectual property protection."

Multiple-entry visas

The two countries signed five agreements, including Memorandums of Understanding (MoU) and Letters of Intent (LoI), across a wide variety of sectors, the External Affairs Ministry said.

The MoU on Migration and Mobility Partnership "aims to develop migration and mobility cooperation under equal treatment principles, and to prevent and combat irregular migration/human exploitation/trafficking in accordance with national laws," the MEA said. "It provides for multiple-entry visas for up to 5 years, including stays of up to 6 months on each visit, and renewable 1-year student permits," it added.

The Agreement on the Exchange of Young Professionals covers young people taking up temporary employment in the other country to enhance their professional and language skills within their field. This agreement incorporates an exchange of 300 people annually per country, which "may" increase to 500, among other provisions.

An LoI was signed between the Department of Science and Technology (DST) and the Swiss National Science Foundation to promote long-term cooperation between the Indian and Swiss research communities.

Delhi Police file FIR against those seeking action against ACP

Protesters came out in support of a journalist who said she was sexually harassed by officer

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police on Monday registered an FIR against a journalist who has accused Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat of sexual harassing and manhandling her while she was covering a protest. The FIR was also registered against 17 others, who were staging a demonstration along with the journalist, demanding the registration of a case against the police officer.

The action came shortly after they were detained for their protest outside Parliament Street police station on Monday. The journalist and protesters were initially taken to the Delhi Cantonment police station before being taken to different police stations in the New Delhi district. The charges filed against them included unlawful assembly, physical defacement or vandalism, obstructing a public servant from discharging duties and assaulting a police officer on duty, among others.

Meanwhile, Mr. Bhagat, was promoted to the rank of Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police in an order signed by the Deputy Secretary (Home) Ramesh Kumar. A senior police officer said the promotions are routine and the request for the promotions was sent some time ago.

The complaint alleging sexual harassment and manhandling by police has been transferred to the Crime Branch but no FIR had been registered, nearly 48 hours after the alleged incidents.

Police custody

The two women journalists among the protesters were released from Mandir Marg police station on Monday evening, while the remaining 16 protesters were kept in police custody and are expected to be produced before a Magistrate.

A Delhi police official had also told *The Hindu* on Sunday that there was no evidence to substantiate the allegation.

Legal affairs head of the Cockroach Janta Party Ratna Singh alleged that the detainees were assaulted by the police.

MP defends plan by simultaneous polls panel to meet CJI

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Defending the study tour to the Supreme Court of India, DMK Rajya Sabha MP P. Wilson, a member of Parliament's Joint Committee reviewing the simultaneous poll legislation, wrote in a letter to panel chairperson P.P. Chaudhary on Monday that seeking the views of the Chief Justice of India and Supreme Court judges was not "unconstitutional".

The letter follows Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal's claim on Thursday that the visit would be unconstitutional and against the separation of powers. The study tour was eventually cancelled.

Foregrounding the DMK's opposition to simultaneous polls, Mr. Wilson said that his remarks in the letter are solely confined to the question of separation of powers. Mr. Wilson, who played a central role in arranging for the study tour, said that the meeting was called off over political objections raised by "vested interests".

Separation of powers, he wrote, does not mean the three organs operate in watertight compartments. "The Constitution does not establish three isolated islands," he said. Seeking informal views is not the same as seeking adjudication, and the Committee was not asking judges to certify or pre-judge the Bill. He cited March 1948, when Federal Court judges and High Court Chief Justices met to formulate views on the Draft Constitution. He also pointed to Article 143, under which the President may seek the Supreme Court's opinion on questions of public importance, and said the provision could not remain if the opposing argument held.

Set up 24-hour monitoring cells to curb sexual offences, SC tells police

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI



Underlining the need to take preventive measures against sexual offences, the Supreme Court on Monday asked the Delhi Police to set up 24-hour monitoring cells for continuous surveillance of vulnerable areas. The court also asked the police to strengthen patrolling, particularly around educational institutions and public spaces.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran observed that the mere installation of CCTV cameras in public spaces would serve little purpose without continuous monitoring to detect suspicious activity and enable a swift police response.

"When we are talking about surveillance through CCTV cameras, how far will they help curb crimes if there is no continuous monitoring at different war rooms? The cameras will help you in catching hold of the culprit, but how will you prevent such crimes? There has to be a 24-hour cell which keeps monitoring what is happening," the Bench observed.

The court was hearing a *suo motu* case concerning a spate of sexual assault incidents involving minors and women in the Delhi-National Capital Region. It had earlier indicated that it intended to fix accountability on authorities entrusted with preventing crime and protecting vulnerable persons.

"Focus on educational institutions, colleges, where there are goons [who] keep harassing young girl students. We are also told that there are hundreds of illegal eateries across NCT (National Capital Territory) of Delhi where all anti-social elements get together. Even liquor is provided over there. Start identifying all those vulnerable pockets," the Bench said.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Delhi Police, acknowledged that there appeared to be deficiencies in police patrolling.

'Interact with society'

The Bench also pointed to reports that, even prior to the gangrape of a 17-year-old at New Delhi's Astha Kunj Park, near Lady Shri Ram College, residents of the area had repeatedly flagged safety concerns in the locality to the police, but their concerns remained unaddressed.

"It has been reported that before this unfortunate incident occurred, residents of that area had brought it to your notice that there are some anti-social elements who are creating nuisance… Nobody paid any heed to it. Therefore, what is important is one-to-one interaction with society. You are the protector," the Bench said, addressing senior police officers present in court.

Justice Pardiwala also stressed the need to instil a fear of the law among potential offenders as a deterrent against such crimes. Referring to the upcoming festival holidays, he asked the Delhi Police to heighten vigilance to ensure that such incidents did not recur. "You need to create a fright, a fear in the mind of a man who is prone to commit such offences… Unless and until you create that fear, that fright in the minds of those anti-social elements, you will not be able to prevent the commission of such crimes," he said.

HC orders CBI probe into Punjab graft charges

Vikas Vasudeva
CHANDIGARH

The Punjab and Haryana High Court on Monday directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations linked to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's office.

The allegations raised by the Enforcement Directorate against public servants and private individuals linked to the AAP government include corruption in transfers and postings, policy manipulation, cash for tenders, and other irregularities. The Bench of Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor said a fair and transparent investigation was required into the issue.

BJP releases list of 8 candidates from U.P. for Rajya Sabha polls

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Monday announced eight candidates from Uttar Pradesh for the upcoming biennial Rajya Sabha polls. The party has named Radhakant Ojha, Prakash Pal, Dharampal Singh, Vidyasagar Sonkar, Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan, Gopi Krishna Pandey, Priyanka Singh Rawat and Shruti Gangwar as its candidates.

In the candidate selection, the party focused on representation to Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and Brahmins with three and two candidates, respectively, from these social segments.

Dharampal Singh, a Cabinet Minister in the Uttar Pradesh government, hails from Lodhi (OBC) social group; Prakash Pal is the State president of the BJP Uttar Pradesh Backward Classes Morcha; and Shruti Gangwar belongs to the Kurmi (OBC) community.

Among Brahmins, Radhakant Ojha is a former president of the Allahabad High Court Bar Association and Gopi Krishna Pandey is a senior party functionary.

The other significant takeaway from the BJP list is that they dropped all its eight outgoing members, including Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri and Union Minister of State B.L. Verma.

Free speech case: top court may not hear reference on merits

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A seven-judge Constitution Bench may not commence hearing, on October 6, questions touching upon whether legislative privilege can stifle free speech, arising out of a 2003 Tamil Nadu Assembly resolution to arrest editors of *The Hindu* for an editorial criticising the then Chief Minister Jayalalithaa.

The Bench is convening on Tuesday, as scheduled, for the sake of formality, but would not proceed to hear the reference on merits.

The development came after senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, appearing for the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, made an oral mentioning before a Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant that the 2003 resolution was withdrawn the following year.

Mr. Ramachandran said the order of reference to the Constitution Bench does not reflect this particular fact about the withdrawal of the resolution.

"It is not noticed [in the court's order of reference in August]," Mr. Ramachandran submitted.

He urged the Chief Justice to consider his preliminary objections against hearing the referral on the merits, saying it would only be an academic exercise.

Chief Justice Kant said the court did not want to get into a prolonged academic exercise, particularly when several other part-heard matters were pending.

Senior advocates Kapil Sibal and Amit Anand Tiwari, appearing for the petitioners, said the fact was indeed mentioned, but may not have been noticed.

Mr. Sibal said the Tamil Nadu issue specifically "may be dead", but the larger question of legislative privilege versus free speech was very much alive and relevant. Chief Justice Kant suggested the case could be kept formally open in the court, to be taken up when an occasion arises in future.

The case dates back to 2003, when *The Hindu* had published the editorial, prompting the Assembly Speaker at the time to pass a resolution in the House accusing the daily of having "distorted the proceedings of the Assembly".

Gyanesh Kumar changed Form 6 'illegally' during SIR, says Rahul

Congress accuses the CEC of 'betraying' the Constitution, seeks his resignation and scrapping of SIR; reacting to Supreme Court's observation, Jairam says it has opportunity to restore public confidence in EC; poll body fact-checks Rahul's X post

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



> It is now established beyond doubt that Gyanesh Kumar changed Form 6 illegally and unilaterally. This is just one more proof of him abusing his position to help the BJP. He...will be held accountable
>
> **RAHUL GANDHI**
> Congress leader

Mounting an offensive against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the Congress on Monday accused him of "lying" after the Supreme Court said it had not approved any of the changes made to Form 6 during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, on his X handle, shared a screenshot of the September 26 Election Commission (EC) statement which read – "The declaration attached to Form 6 for SIR has been upheld by the Hon'ble Supreme Court. For non-SIR period, the Forms applicable as per Rules (the Registration of Electors Rules 1960) will be used."

"It is now established beyond doubt that Mr. Kumar changed Form 6 illegally and unilaterally. This is just one more proof of him abusing his position to help the BJP. He and everyone else involved in this criminal assault on our democracy will be held accountable," he said.

However, the Election Commission fact-checked Mr. Gandhi in a post on X. It said Mr. Gandhi's post was misleading, asserting that the June 24, 2025 order for the SIR in Bihar was issued with the unanimous approval of the EC and was upheld by the Supreme Court in its May 27 judgment. Further, the September 26 press note, categorically stated that the declaration attached to Form 6 for the SIR had been upheld by the Supreme Court.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said resignation of the CEC, annulling the SIR and conducting elections on ballot papers are "non-negotiable demands" of the principal Opposition party.

'In solidarity'

Mr. Kharge said Congress workers and INDIA bloc partners are on the streets over these three issues across the country. He said the Congress stands in solidarity with civil society members and youth organisations that are struggling on these issues in various places across the country.

"The dictator is extremely panicked; get ready for another chapter in the distraction tactics," Mr. Kharge said.

Taking note of the Supreme Court's notices to the EC and the Centre and the top court's observation, Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh said the Supreme Court has a remarkable opportunity to restore public confidence in the EC.

He accused the CEC of "betraying" the Constitution in letter and spirit at the behest of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

"Based on the recent damning revelations regarding (1) the ad-hoc, illegal and slip-shod manner in which the SIR was taking place, (2) criticism from both sitting and retired Judges of the Supreme Court, (3) the vast and indiscriminate (and many obviously incorrect) deletions without adequate due process, the Supreme Court has a remarkable opportunity to restore public confidence in an institution vital to the integrity of our republic," the Congress leader said on X.

CEC has lost public trust, must be removed: activists

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI



Taking a stand: Activist Anjali Bhardwaj and former Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Najeeb Jung in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

A group of retired bureaucrats, civil society activists, and academics on Monday accused Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar of six instances of "proved misbehaviour" and sought his removal.

They could not submit their "notice of impeachment" to him in person, as heavy barricading and police deployment prevented the delegation from reaching the Election Commission's office.

They subsequently emailed their "chargesheet" to the CEC. It invokes Article 324(5) of the Constitution, which protects the CEC from removal except on grounds of "proved misbehaviour or incapacity", and alleges that the CEC's conduct amounted to a sustained disregard of law and constitutional duty.

The 14-member delegation included former Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Najeeb Jung, former Union Home Secretary G.K. Pillai, and other former IAS officers and Ambassadors.

Six accusations

The chargesheet lists six accusations against Mr. Kumar, including that he undermined the collective functioning of the EC, made unauthorised changes to the statutory Form 6, centralised electoral-roll functions through the ECINET platform, and presided over the special intensive revision of electoral rolls that the activists alleged has resulted in large-scale disenfranchisement.

The group said the charges amounted to a "people's impeachment" of the CEC and argued that he had lost the public trust necessary to continue in office. "EC is functioning illegally and failing in its responsibility. We believe that the CEC must resign," activist Anjali Bhardwaj said.

The chargesheet alleges that the conduct of the EC had compromised citizens' ability to establish their eligibility for inclusion in the electoral rolls, adding that such conduct undermined the EC's public credibility.

D. Raja slams Gyanesh over 'changes to Form 6'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Calling for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation for allegedly misleading the public over changes made to Form 6, Communist Party of India (CPI) general secretary D. Raja said the Supreme Court's remarks on the issue on Monday raised questions over the Election Commission's credibility and impartiality.

Mr. Raja alleged that Mr. Kumar had invoked the Supreme Court's name to justify the changes and had ignored objections raised by the other Election Commissioners.

The Election Commission, Mr. Raja said, needs to provide answers on who changed Form 6, and who authorised the false claim with reference to the Supreme Court.

19,000 West Bengal voters to miss bypolls as appeals remain pending in tribunals

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI



People wait to submit petitions before a tribunal after their names were deleted during the special intensive revision process. PTI

Nearly 19,000 voters in Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly constituencies in West Bengal, where byelections will be held on Tuesday, are among the 38.31 lakh voters who remain disenfranchised due to the crawling pace of work at the Appellate Tribunals that handle their pending cases.

The Calcutta High Court had in July observed that at the current rate, it would take 21 years for the tribunals to clear the cases.

In Rejinagar, the total number of appeals submitted was 12,452, out of which four have been included so far, and in Nandigram, the total number of appeals submitted was 6,443, with 89 included so far.

While in both places, no one has been excluded so far, the tribunals have till now cleared only 1.26 lakh of the total 38.31 lakh appeals – approximately 3% of the total cases.

Out of the 19 Appellate Tribunals set up by the Election Commission (EC) in March, only 16 remain functional as three retired judges – Justice T.S. Sivagnanam, Justice Ranjit Bag and Justice Indrajit Chatterjee – have quit citing various functional issues. Their positions remain vacant.

The EC's proposal to increase the number of tribunals from 19 to 42 has also not moved forward. The Appellate Tribunals came out of the Supreme Court's supervision of the SIR.

Rahul is 'spreading lies' over Form 6: BJP

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

Rejecting Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's charge regarding Form 6 used for registering new voters, the BJP said the Supreme Court's decision to issue notices to the Centre and the Election Commission demonstrated a functioning democratic process.

At a briefing on Monday, BJP spokesperson Sambit Patra accused Mr. Gandhi of "spreading lies and confusion regarding Form 6", arguing that the Supreme Court had neither called it illegal nor rejected it.

Responding to Mr. Gandhi's charge in an X post that Form 6 was changed illegally and unilaterally to help the BJP, Mr. Patra said: "Nowhere in court today did the Chief Justice say that Form 6 was illegal." He said the Supreme Court had earlier upheld the declaration attached to Form 6 for the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

During a press conference earlier in the day, Mr. Patra said: "Going to the Supreme Court with a PIL, having the Supreme Court hear it, and issuing notice so that the other side can also be heard, is a democratic and judicial process. Therefore, naturally, a process is taking place."

Mr. Patra said that those who alleged dictatorship and an "atmosphere of fear" in the country would now think twice before making such claims.

Cong. to launch campaign against vote *chori*, help re-enrol deleted names

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Plan of action: Congress leaders K.C. Venugopal, Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi at a meeting in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

The Congress on Monday announced a series of nationwide campaigns against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and alleged vote theft, using a slogan of 'Vote *bachao, desh bachao* (Save your vote, save the country)'.

Congress workers will reach out to more than 13.3 crore people whose names have been struck off the voters' list during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, and will try to get them re-enrolled with the help of "vote *rakshaks* [guardians]".

The announcement was made after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge chaired a two-hour long meeting of party general secretaries, State in-charges, and Pradesh Congress Committee chiefs at the Indira Bhavan here. The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, was also present at the meeting.

"The Election Commission has become the Cheating Commission of India," Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said. "[Gyanesh Kumar] is not leaving, even as the entire country wants him to be removed. We are not going to allow him to sit on the chair. We will ensure that he is removed," he added.

The Opposition party will also reach out to other parties outside the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) bloc, like the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and the Aam Aadmi Party, and invite them to join the planned protest march from Parliament to the Election Commission on Tuesday and a INDIA bloc rally here on November 1.

"We are inviting all the Opposition parties to be part of the November 1 rally at the Ram Leela Maidan," general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh said.

'BJP's distractions'

Sources told *The Hindu* that, in the closed door meeting, Mr. Kharge said the Opposition party should "oust the CEC now", but also cautioned that the ruling party may use distractions as "they [the BJP] know they have been caught out".

Mr. Gandhi said the alleged "vote *chori* [theft]" is a people's issue and the party's campaign should designed in such a way that common people should the programmes to protect their voting rights.

Giving details of the various programmes, Mr. Venugopal said from October 10 to October 20, block level marches will be taken out out and culminate at Sub Divisional Magistrates offices under Vote *bachao, desh bachao* umbrella.

"Village *chaupals* will be held in every village, where our workers will explain Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah's *modus operandi* of vote *chori*, and village leaders and heads will be invited. Booth- level agents (BLAs), our vote *rakshaks*, will have the task of identifying every voter deleted unfairly and ensuring their re-enrolment," Mr. Venugopal said.

The Congress will then take out six Delhi Chalo rallies from locations in Rajasthan, Haryana, and Uttar Pradesh on November 25, culminating in an event in Delhi on Constitution Day, November 26.



INBRIEF



Centre elevates three HC Chief Justices to top court

The Centre on Monday appointed the Chief Justices of the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts to the Supreme Court. The three additional judges will take the court's working strength to 37, leaving one vacancy against its sanctioned strength of 38. Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal said on X that Justice Sunita Agarwal, Chief Justice of the Gujarat High Court; Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court; and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court have been appointed to the Supreme Court. They are set to be sworn in on October 6.

SC seeks govt. response on Secretariat library relocation

The Supreme Court on Monday sought a detailed affidavit from the Union government in the *suo motu* case on proposed relocation of the 135-year-old Central Secretariat Library in Delhi, which houses over 8.5 lakh books, as part of the Central Vista redevelopment project. The Bench sought details of the space earmarked for the library and directed Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Union government, to file an affidavit within three weeks setting out the arrangements in detail.

'We need to foster a middle power approach'

India, a respected actor on the international stage, can help in finding a peaceful solution to the Ukraine war, says the French Minister-Delegate for European Affairs; stressing that India and France share a common attachment to multilateralism, he says the EU seeks de-escalation in West Asia crisis

INTERVIEW

Benjamin Haddad

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India and France have a common attachment to "strategic autonomy", says French Minister-Delegate for European Affairs Benjamin Haddad, indicating that European countries are increasingly seeking more "middle power coalitions" to hedge against the uncertainty in ties with superpowers U.S. and China. In Delhi for the 'Munich Leaders Meeting', where External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar indicated for the first time that India is mediating between Russia and Ukraine for a specific agreement, Mr. Haddad said that he hoped India would use its "voice" to bring Russia to the table for peace talks.

You're in Delhi two months before the culmination of the India-EU FTA, which is supposed to happen on December 16 in Brussels. Can you confirm that the date is now set, and are there any hurdles still to cross before that?

It's indeed our objective to close by the end of the year. France is very supportive of the FTA with India, which really shows the deepening of both a bilateral relationship and the broader relationship between the European Union (EU) and India. We are in a world of geopolitical turmoil, where we see that we have a common attachment to multilateralism, to cooperation, to a form of independence in international relations, which I think is what also brings France and India very close... this attachment to having strategic autonomy, to developing a sort of approach of middle powers in this world.

Do you see India and France coming together in some kind of a non-superpower coalition – with the middle powers versus the superpowers?


AFP

I don't think it's 'versus'. I think we are attached to a world that's driven by reliable partnerships, by cooperation and multilateralism in international law. We have our traditional allies, and we are very committed to the European project, but we can see that with partners like India, we share the objective of not just being passive bystanders of a rivalry between the United States and China, but also to be able to defend our own interest. In areas like access to space and leadership of AI, I think there is really an incredible potential for a partnership. The India-EU FTA will only operationalise and deepen this. And one of the reasons for my visits, my second visit this year, is beyond just the signature of [the FTA] document; [it] is to look at how we can take it to a stronger partnership and a common voice on the international stage.

An area of disagreement is the Russia-Ukraine conflict. What is your expectation from India, given it still imports more than half its oil needs from Russia?

I've seen Indian leaders state very clearly that they want to find a peaceful solution, including Prime Minister Modi, who told President Putin that it's time to stop the wars. In this respect, a country like India, that is a respected actor on the international stage, can play a role in working with us to find a peaceful solution , but clearly Russia continues to refuse. The best way to put an end to this war is to increase the pressure on Russia to get it back to the negotiating table, and so it means also increasing economic pressures. We generally don't lecture other countries on what they should do, but at the European level, we have adopted different packages of sanctions.

The recent BRICS Summit 'Delhi Declaration' made no mention of the Ukraine war. Does this indicate that it is now just a European problem, not for the rest of the world?

It would be [a] mistake to think that. Of course it is a European issue, as it pertains to European security. [But] this is also about international principles, not just law, [but] of the security architecture that we want. If we allow a state to invade its neighbour, to use nuclear blackmail to conduct a conventional war on its neighbours, it creates an extremely dangerous precedent for the rest of the world, including for the nations that were at this BRICS Summit.

The U.S. invasion of Iran earlier this year, the assassination of its Supreme Leader, of civilians there, targeting of nuclear installations, also ticks all these boxes, and yet no one is asking for the U.S. to be treated the same way...

Europeans are not involved in [the Iran] war. We have always called for de-escalation. We have always called to find peaceful and diplomatic solutions, whether that's on the freedom of navigation, the Strait of Hormuz, including on tackling issues where we agree with the U.S. for example, the Iranian nuclear programme, its ballistic missile programme, its support for terrorist proxies in the region. We said the best way is to do it through a diplomatic channel.

Plea in SC asks if States can redraw wards during Census

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to hear a petition questioning whether State governments can undertake a fresh delimitation of wards and alter the boundaries during an ongoing Census exercise.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant indicated listing the case on October 9 for hearing. The petition filed by Paka Suresh, a former Mayor of the Kadapa Municipal Corporation in Andhra Pradesh, said the question of law was of general public importance concerning the conduct of Census 2027, having national implications.

Rule 8(iv) of the Census Rules 1990 requires State governments to "freeze the administrative boundaries of districts, tehsils, towns, etc." from the date intimated by the Census Commissioner.

Bharat Innovation Challenge returns for its second edition

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Bharat Innovation Challenge is back with its second edition. Organised and hosted by Lovely Professional University (LPU), the Bharat Innovation Challenge 2.0 urges students from Classes 8-12 aged between 13 and 18 years to participate and identify real-world problems and develop innovative, practical, and scalable solutions.

Season 2 has 10 innovation themes, 29 winning categories, ₹14 lakh in cash prizes, including a ₹3 lakh Grand Champion prize, along with theme-wise and special awards. The top teams will advance to the grand finale at LPU, to be held on November 20-21. Registrations and online submissions close on October 10.

Students can participate in teams of two-five, with one faculty mentor and develop solutions across 10 themes: Agritech & Rural Innovation, Healthcare & HealthTech, Smart Living & Urban Intelligence, Cybersecurity & Ethical Tech, Education & EdTech, Climate & Sustainable Tech, Aerospace & Frontier Tech, AI & GenAI, FinTech & Financial Inclusion, and Social Impact, Culture & Heritage.

"India's young minds have potential to turn today's biggest challenges into tomorrow's solutions. Through Bharat Innovation Challenge, we want to give school students a national platform where their ideas are encouraged, mentored and transformed into solutions with real impact," Ashok Kumar Mittal, founder-chancellor, LPU and MP (Rajya Sabha), said.

The competition will take place in two stages. Stage 1 involves online registration and submission of ideas through a powerpoint presentation or PDF. Entries will be evaluated on innovation, problem-solving, feasibility, impact, scalability and presentation. The top teams will advance to the grand finale, where students will showcase their innovations and pitch it before experts and industry leaders.

The initiative is supported by *The Hindu in School* as media partner, Quantiphi as AI Partner, Kangaro as stationery partner and Scarters as lifestyle partner. For registrations, the participants can email: bic@lpu.co.in and dial +919888598702 for further details.

The registration link is *https://www.lpu.in/bharat-innovation-challenge/* or scan the QR code.

'Hasina's activities pose challenge to planning Bangladesh PM's India trip'

Kallol Bhattacherjee
DHAKA

The activities of deposed premier Sheikh Hasina and her team pose the "principal challenge" to planning a visit to India by Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, State Minister for Foreign Affairs of Bangladesh Humaiyun Kobir said on Monday.

Responding to questions from *The Hindu* on the sidelines of the ongoing Bay of Bengal Conversation organised by Dhaka's Centre for Governance Studies (CGS), Mr. Kobir emphasised the importance of "strategic autonomy" for Bangladesh and said India has to appreciate the "challenges of a newly elected government" in Bangladesh.

"The visit will be bilateral but there are challenges and through dialogue we will overcome them. The principal challenge is not too much to ask for. Sheikh Hasina and her team are stationed in Delhi and they are trying to destabilise a foreign country sitting in Delhi. This does not benefit India either," Mr. Kobir said, calling on India to restrain Ms. Hasina.


Humaiyun Kobir

Mr. Kobir accused Ms. Hasina of killing around 2,000 Bangladeshi citizens during the crackdown of the uprising of July-August 2024 and described her as a "terrorist".

He said Bangladesh's people need a "clean break" from the past as they have sacrificed lives in the process of overthrowing the previous government of Ms. Hasina that ruled for more than 15 years.

The Minister, however, said there are ongoing talks with India that have been welcomed in Dhaka.

"We are seeing some positive signs as India is trying to restrain them (Ms. Hasina and her group). That is the norm between two countries. If they are restrained, then there will be no problem in the [bilateral] relationship," said Mr. Kobir asserting that ties with India are a priority for Dhaka. "The visit of Prime Minister will take place at a conducive time and I am hopeful. PM has never said that he will not visit [India]," said Mr. Kobir highlighting the role of Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi in this regard.

Indian envoy's role

"The Indian High Commissioner here is doing a good role. He is trying and hopefully Delhi will be receptive to his opinion and if they give importance to his opinion, then we are ready to engage across the board. We are carrying out our consultations," said Mr. Kobir describing the Awami League leadership as a "hindrance" to normalisation of New Delhi-Dhaka ties.

The State Minister of Foreign Affairs said that Bangladesh is ready to discuss all issues but expects some "reciprocation". "When two governments sit down to discuss keeping in mind national interests, all issues can be addressed," he said arguing that Bangladesh will not allow anyone to work against India's interest sitting in Dhaka and he expects similar action from India.

Earlier, Mr. Kobir delivered a "ministerial address" at the Bay of Bengal Conversation and said Bangladesh seeks "strategic autonomy" in foreign affairs but will maintain strong relation with global stakeholders.

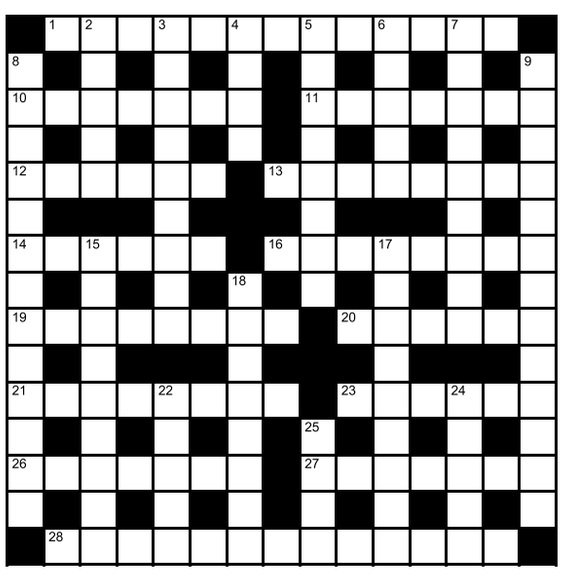
(The correspondent is visiting Dhaka as a guest of the Centre for Governance Studies)

TH CROSSWORD + 14916

(set by Karaoke)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Mrs. Henry rues uncontrollably while narrating unknown verses for children (7,6)
10 Where a train should be to make progress? (2,5)
11 Perfect to enjoy long time in retreat (7)
12 Lack of interest, of course, in any case (6)
13 Spooner's father gambles amounts that can never be recovered (3,5)
14 Before the end of day, fancy thing worn by women (6)
16 0° Celsius or 32° Fahrenheit from inception, maybe not new (3,5)
19 Skirts around central party's cocktails (8)
20 Programming specialist in school, skips advanced information engineering initially (6)
21 They guard the chests by taking extraordinary care with big guns at boundary (3,5)
23 Allowed nothing over board (6)
26 Hanging harmful revolutionary in dream (7)
27 Knock panda group at the midpoint? It's not possible (2,3,2)
28 Outstanding girl studies Hindi with difficulty (13)

Down

2 Diehard setter opts out of ritual dance (5)
3 Something to eat during breaks over the table mainly perhaps with Karaoke (9)
4 Ignore boy, check for playboy (4)
5 Fact-finding coordinator at centre leaves his career in a fit of anger (8)
6 Why I say, silently leave trophy and admit defeat (5)
7 Found enjoyment, going topless, holding rounded clubs (9)
8 Some rural man confused about new CIVIL ID perhaps? (5,8)
9 Terrible loss for other Congress mainly when politicians join the opposite side (5,3,5)
15 Mock up one person without natural covering mostly in loose blouse (9)
17 Inspector shot main criminal for major offence within boundaries (9)
18 Mercenary from Edinburgh working to eliminate bishop (5,3)
22 Part of hospital is tailor-made for noted celebrities in the show business (1-4)
24 Heavy-weight wife leaves Newton, while cycling (5)
25 Two-toed sloth runs heartily on the banks of Anapu (4)

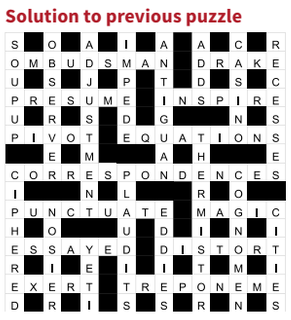
SUDOKU

9				8				
	1			2	6		5	
						1	8	6
	4					6		9
	6		4		5		1	
2		7					4	
3	8	2						
	7		8	9			6	
				5				2

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★☆☆

No.SS7023 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

7	2	4	3	5	9	8	1	6
9	1	5	8	2	6	3	7	4
6	3	8	4	1	7	9	2	5
2	4	7	9	6	8	5	3	1
5	8	9	1	7	3	6	4	2
1	6	3	2	4	5	7	9	8
3	7	1	6	8	4	2	5	9
4	9	6	5	3	2	1	8	7
8	5	2	7	9	1	4	6	3

FAITH

Selfless service

Lord Siva's penance has to be disrupted if He is to marry Parvati. And only if they marry, will Murugan take His avatara. So, Brahma asks Manmatha to disrupt Siva's tapas. Afraid of Siva's anger, Manmatha refuses, and Brahma uses his persuasive skills to convince Manmatha. He tells Manmatha that one must be selfless and must help those who need assistance, said Sumathi Sri in a discourse. He tells him the story of Dadhichi. When the war between the devas and the asuras came to an end, the devas left their weapons in Dadhichi's ashram, telling him that they would collect the weapons whenever a war broke out again. Many years passed, and since the devas did not come to take their weapons, Dadhichi dissolved the weapons in the sacred water in his kamandala, and drank it. As a result, his backbone became a strong weapon.

When Indra had to fight Vritasura, he went to retrieve the weapons. The sage told Indra that he had consumed the weapons, but Indra could use the sage's backbone to fashion a weapon. This meant that Dadhichi had to die. But he didn't mind dying for a good cause. He told Indra to take his backbone. The weapon known as Vajrayudha was made out of Dadhichi's bone. Brahma asks Manmatha to think of the ultimate sacrifice of Dadhichi. Shouldn't Manmatha think of others, instead of thinking only about himself? Brahma tells Manmatha about the churning of the milky ocean, and of Lord Siva's selflessness. When the Halahala poison emerged from the ocean, it posed a danger to everyone. To save everyone, Siva tried to swallow it, but Parvati clutched His throat, and the poison remained in His neck. That is why Siva is known as Neelakanta.

INBRIEF



Saudia Group's flyadeal plans network expansion in India

flyadeal, Saudia Group's low-cost carrier is planning major network expansion in India to provide efficient air connectivity between various locations of India and the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. The airline after starting a five times a week flight to Hyderabad in July, has introduced a flight connecting Mumbai from Riyadh starting October 3. Now plans are afoot to connect cities like Lucknow, Calicut, Delhi, Chennai and even Kolkata said the airline's acting Chief Executive Officer Sanjiv Kapoor, who is also Executive Vice President Strategies at Saudia Group. "The 100% increase in jet fuel prices in the last six months has slowed down expansion plans. We will scale it up once prices stabilise," Mr. Kapoor said. flyadeal now operates five times a week between Mumbai and Riyadh using a fleet of A320neo aircraft, adding more than 7,400 seats each month between the two cities.

AMI to get 20,000 more NVIDIA Rubin GPUs for India, Malaysia

AM Intelligence (AMI), the AI infrastructure platform set up by Greenko promoters, has placed two more orders for a total of 20,000 NVIDIA Rubin GPUs to be deployed in Malaysia and India. These are in addition to AMI's commitment in August, for 9,000 NVIDIA Rubin GPUs at its first AI factory in Hyderabad. The follow-on capacity of around 70 megawatts (MW) will be deployed in Malaysia and India with delivery scheduled for Q2 2027, AMI said. "Both facilities will be built to the same architecture standard as the Hyderabad AI factory, integrating the NVIDIA Vera Rubin platform with high-throughput RDMA over Converged Ethernet (RoCE) networking for fast, efficient data movement, alongside advanced storage systems," Chairman Anil Chalamalasetty said. Each site is engineered for high rack power density and liquid cooled throughout, allowing the infrastructure to accommodate successive generations of AI silicon within the same physical footprint, he said in a release on Monday.

MSMEs seek curbs on metal price surge

Industry body says timely intervention is essential to contain input-cost pressures and protect competitiveness of Coimbatore's MSME sector

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE



While WPI data indicate fluctuations and even a decline in steel prices, actual market conditions remain "adverse". FILE PHOTO

Coimbatore's Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), already reeling under higher prices of diesel, furnace oil and LPG, are facing mounting pressure from a sharp rise in the cost of key raw materials such as steel, pig iron, copper and aluminium.

The Joint Council of Associations of Coimbatore, in a memorandum submitted to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, said the "acute and unprecedented" increase in raw material prices was placing severe stress on MSMEs.

While Wholesale Price Index (WPI) data indicate fluctuations and even a decline in steel prices, actual market conditions remain "adverse", the council said. Steel prices have risen by around ₹8,000-₹10,000 a tonne between August and September this year, it added. The council urged the government to constitute a Price Monitoring Committee for steel to track availability and prices and prevent hoarding, cartelisation and abnormal price increases.

It also sought withdrawal of applicable import and safeguard duties on steel for six months and deferment of the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) requirements and Quality Control Orders for imported steel until March 2027.

To address shortages of non-ferrous metals, the council called for measures to encourage imports of copper and aluminium scrap.

It also urged the Ministry of Steel to explore setting up a SAIL depot in Coimbatore.

Amid 'volatile' ATF prices, IndiGo ups fuel surcharge for third time

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The revised surcharge ranges from ₹375-1,300 for domestic flights, based on distance

IndiGo has raised its fuel surcharge for the third time since the West Asia conflict pushed up aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices, with the revised levy applicable to bookings made from 0001 hours on October 6, 2026.

The airline said on Monday that ATF prices have remained volatile amid heightened geopolitical tensions in West Asia, with the latest month-on-month increase exceeding 14%. Fuel costs are now among the highest seen in a decade, IndiGo said, adding that ATF accounts for a significant share of its operating expenses.

IndiGo said the latest increase represents only a partial pass-through of higher fuel costs. A full pass-through, it said, would have required a significantly steeper increase.

The revised surcharge ranges from ₹375 to ₹1,300 for domestic flights, depending on distance. For journeys of up to 500 km, the charge has been raised to ₹375 from ₹275 under the schedule introduced in April. Flights between 501 km and 1,000 km will attract ₹600, against ₹400 earlier, while the charge for 1,001-1,500 km rises to ₹900 from ₹600.

For flights covering 1,501-2,000 km, the surcharge increases to ₹1,150 from ₹800, while journeys beyond 2,000 km will attract ₹1,300, up from ₹950.

International surcharges have also been revised. The charge for SAARC destinations has increased to ₹1,000 and ₹3,000 across the applicable distance bands, from ₹900 and ₹2,500 earlier.

Cygni Energy, Indus Towers ink MoU for telecom infra solutions

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Energy-storage technology and manufacturing company Cygni Energy and telecom tower firm Indus Towers have decided to explore collaboration on sourcing energy storage solutions for telecom infrastructure in the country.

The collaboration will include plans to establish Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) manufacturing capacity of up to 1.5 GWh to address the evolving energy requirements of telecom infrastructure, Cygni Energy said on Monday following the signing of an MoU with Indus.

The companies are also expected to evaluate advanced battery technologies for telecom applications, aimed at enhancing reliability, improving energy efficiency and enabling more sustainable telecom operations, it said.

'SEBI to partly reverse derivative settlement rules after pushback'

Reuters
MUMBAI

India's markets regulator SEBI is likely to stop using closing auctions to calculate derivatives settlement prices for at least a year, two sources with direct knowledge of the matter said, in a partial reversal of new mechanisms it has introduced for setting the closing prices of key stocks and derivative contracts.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India in August introduced a new mechanism called the closing auction session,or CAS, for stocks that have futures and options contracts linked to them.

Under this system, a short auction at the end of the trading day helps determine the closing price of a stock. The new process, similar to that used in global markets including the U.S. and Hong Kong, has led to sharp swings in derivatives prices on expiry days, prompting the regulator to review it.



SEBI said it had received 20,000 suggestions to tweak the rules.

In a post on social media platform X over the weekend, SEBI said it had received 20,000 suggestions to tweak the rules in response to a consultation paper issued last month.

Sources said that instead, the volume-weighted average price of the last 30 minutes of trading will be used to determine the derivative pricing.

For underlying stocks in the less liquid cash market, a closing auction will still be used to determine the end-of-day price, said the sources, who declined to be identified as they are not authorised to speak to the media. SEBI is expected to implement the changes by the end of this month. A SEBI spokesperson did not respond to a request for comment.

The new approach would align India more closely with US and European markets, where derivatives settlement is often determined using dedicated pricing mechanisms, including volume-weighted average prices over set trading periods, rather than a single closing auction. The regulator had also proposed in its review plans in September to stop publishing the indicative value of an index and publish only the indicative prices of individual stocks during the 10-minute CAS window, arguing that the index value was still being determined.

The majority of feedback comments it received said that sophisticated trading desks could reconstruct those values independently and that removing them would reduce transparency without addressing manipulation concerns, the sources said.

APPOINTMENT

Advertisement No. 107/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board invites online applications for the post of
Director Technical,
in
Central Mine Planning & Design Institute Limited, (CMPDIL).
Last date of submission of online application by the applicant is by 15:00 hours on
21st October, 2026
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours
30th October, 2026
For details login to website https://www.pesb.gov.in
Link for registration of nodal officers/competent authorities is available on PESB website.

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CENTRE FOR MATERIALS FOR ELECTRONICS TECHNOLOGY (C-MET)
(Scientific Society, Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology, MeitY, Govt. of India)
Panchawati, Off. Dr. Homi Bhabha Road, Pashan, Pune- 411 008, INDIA
CORRIGENDUM 1: Extension of last date of bid submission for Procurement of Laue Diffractometer.
Please refer to the captioned Tender Notice No. PN/ADM/TEN/001/2026 dated 14.08.2026
2. In this connection, it has been decided to revise the last date for submission of tenders and the date of opening of Technical Bids of Tender. The revised dates are given below:-

Particulars	Original date	Revised date
Last date for submission of Tender	29.09.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.	26.10.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.
Date of Opening of Technical Bids of Tender	29.09.2026 at 15.00 Hrs.	26.10.2026 at 15.00 Hrs.

3. All other conditions in the tender document remain the same. Bidders are advised to submit the bids well in advance and avoid the last-minute rush. C-MET, Pune will not be responsible for bidders failure to submit the bids within the time mentioned above.
(Sd/-)
In-Charge Administration

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
MANGALAGIRI (ANDHRA PRADESH)
Mangalagiri – 522503
Guntur Dist., Andhra Pradesh

ADVERTISEMENT FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POSTS OF FACULTY (GROUP - A) ON DIRECT RECRUITMENT /DEPUTATION BASIS IN VARIOUS DEPARTMENTS OF AIIMS MANGALAGIRI

Advt. I - No. AIIMS/MG/Admin/Recruitment/03/Faculty/2026/01 dated.11.08.2026

Date of Publishing on Website	11.08.2026	Opening Date of Online Application	28.08.2026
Closing Date of Online Applications	**12.10.2026**	Last date for receiving hard copy	22.10.2026

Details of Vacancies: Post, Department and Category-wise

Sr. No	Name of the department	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Anaesthesia	-	-	-	02 UR, 01 OBC *
2.	Burns & Plastic Surgery	01 UR	-	-	02 SC
3.	Cardiology	-	01 UR#	01 UR	-
4.	Cardiothoracic and Vascular Surgery	01 SC	01 OBC	-	01 UR, 01 OBC
5.	Dermatology	01 UR	-	-	01 UR, 01 ST
6.	Endocrinology and Metabolism	-	-	01 SC	01 UR, 01 ST
7.	Gastroenterology	01 UR	01 UR	-	01 UR
8.	General Medicine	01 OBC	01 UR	-	01 OBC
9.	Medical Oncology	-	-	-	01 OBC
10.	Medical Haematology	-	-	01 UR	01 SC
11.	Microbiology	-	-	01 OBC	01 UR
12.	Neonatology	01 OBC	-	01 UR	-
13.	Nephrology	-	-	01 UR	01 OBC, 01 ST
14.	Neurology	01 UR	01 UR	-	01 SC
15.	Neurosurgery	01 UR	-	-	-
16.	Nuclear Medicine	-	01 SC	01 UR	01 UR
17.	Obstetrics and Gynaecology	-	01 OBC	-	01 UR
18.	Ophthalmology	01 SC	-	01 UR, 01 OBC	01 SC
19.	Paediatric Surgery	-	-	01 ST	-
20.	Paediatrics	-	01 UR	01 OBC	-
21.	Pathology	-	-	-	01 UR, 01 SC
22.	Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation	-	-	-	01 OBC
23.	Physiology	01 SC	-	-	01 UR
24.	Pulmonary Medicine	01 OBC*	-	01 OBC	01 ST
25.	Psychiatry	-	-	-	01 UR
26.	Radiology/ Radio Diagnosis	-	01 ST	01 OBC	02 UR
27.	Radiotherapy/ Radiation Oncology	01 UR*	-	-	-
28.	Rheumatology & Clinical Immunology	-	-	-	01 OBC
29.	Surgical Gastroenterology	01 UR	01 OBC	01 OBC	01 SC
30.	Surgical Oncology	01 OBC	-	-	-
31.	Transfusion Medicine and Blood bank	01 SC*	-	-	01 UR
32.	Trauma & Emergency Medicine	01 UR	-	-	01 UR, 02 OBC
33.	Urology	01 ST	01 UR	-	01 UR
	Total	**17**	**11**	**14**	**37**
	Grand Total	**79 Posts**			

Advt. II - AIIMS/MG/Admin/Recruitment/03/Faculty/2026/02 dated.17.09.2026

Date of Publishing on Website	17.09.2026	Opening Date of Online Application	17.09.2026
Closing Date of Online Applications	**02.11.2026**	Last date for receiving hard copy	12.11.2026

Details of Vacancies: Post, Department and Category-wise

Sr. No	Name of the department	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	General Surgery	-	-	01 OBC	-
2.	Neurosurgery	-	-	01 OBC	-
	Total	**-**	**-**	**02**	**-**

* 4% horizontal reservation posts are reserved for Person with Benchmark Disability (PwBD).
Anticipated Vacancy

Sd/-
Administrative Officer (I/c)
AIIMS, Mangalagiri.

Andhra Pradesh State FiberNet Limited APSFL
Proposals are invited from interested agencies for the RFP Selection of an Agency for Providing Dedicated Customer and Operator Call Centre (OCC) Services on a Plug-and-Play Seat- Based Managed Service Model under APSFL Supervision. Details of the RfP and corrigenda may be downloaded from e-procurement platform **tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**
DIPR No. 5480PP/CL, Dt: 05.10.2026 **Managing Director, APSFL**

Government Of Odisha - "e" Procurement of Notice
Bid Identification No. 11 of 2026-27
Notice No.3673 Dated.03.10.2026
Ref- TCN No.3667 Dated.03.10.2026

Sr.No.	Item	Details
1	The GENERAL MANAGER, OSAM BOARD invites percentage rate bids in Double cover system in ONLINE MODE only for work as detailed below :	
2	Nature of the work	Construction of building type works.
3	No of work	01 Nos
4	Bid Cost	Rs. 10000.00 online transfer.
5	Value of Tender	Rs. 8078.19 lakhs
6	Class of Contractor	"Super" Class
7	Availability of BID Documents in the website	Dt . 06.10.2026 to 19.11.2026
8	Last date / time of Receipt of bids in the portal	Dt . 19.11.2026 up to 5.00 PM
9	Date of opening of bid	Dt. 20.11.2026 at 11.00 AM
10	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : https://tendersorissa.gov.in. Any Addendum/Corrigendum/Cancellation of the Tender etc. can also be seen in the website: https://tendersorissa.gov.in.	

Sd/- **General Manager, O.S.A.M. Board, Bhubaneswar**
39001/60/2627 OIPR-39001/39024/1/26-27/0004

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY
P. H. CIRCLE, ALAPPUZHA
ELECTRONIC TENDER NOTICE
E-tender No. - 03/2026-27/SE/PHC/ALP - AMRUT 2.0 - Alappuzha Water Supply Scheme - Operation & Maintenance of 24x7 Nehru trophy & Thirumala Ward
TPAC: Rs.8,17,24,719/-, Form fee: Rs. 11025/-, Bid Security (EMD): Rs.2,00,000/-, Tender Publishing date in website: 06.10.2026, 02:00PM, Tender closing date: 27.10.2026, 02:00PM, Tender opening date (Technical Bid): 28.10.2026,02:30PM
Phone No: 0477-2237954, Website: www.etenders.kerala.gov.in, www.kwa.kerala.gov.in
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE RAJ JAIPUR
No. V-5(18)Ps/Vardi/Tender/2026/2942 Dated- 27/09/2026
NOTICE INVITING BIDS
NIB NO. P012627A0021
Bids for Anti Roit Equipment of estimated value INR 1,47,00,000/- are invited from interested bidders up to 21.10.2026 at 1.00 pm. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in; https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in of the state of Rajasthan and Rajasthan Police Website - https://www.police.rajasthan.gov.in.
UBN. (1) POL2627GLOB00024 - Helmet
(2) POL2627GLOB00025 - B.P. Half
(Dinesh kumar agarwal)
Supdt. of Police
Central Stores, PHQ, Rajasthan, Jaipur
Tel - 0141-2744289
DIPR/C/16836/2026 Mail ID - sp.cstore.pmw@rajpolice.gov.in

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LTD.
O/o CE (fuel), 6th Floor, LIC Jeevandeep Building, Lalkothi, Jaipur
E-TENDER NOTICE: TN-09(RVU2627SLOB01367)
Online Tenders are invited for Rate contract for taking delivery of raw coal from WCL collieries on behalf of RVUN, through transportation and loading of the same into Railway wagons for dispatch to RVUNs TPSs and completing all documentation as required by Coal Company, Railways and RVUN for year 2026-27. Tender details are available on **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** (for e-tender), **www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rvunl & www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.**
Superintending Engineer (Fuel)
Raj.Samwad/C/26/11207 RVUN/PR-4482

MAHATRANSCO Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/53-2026-27
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.) Excluding GST	Due Date & Time (Hrs.) for Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0512/1026 RFx 5000001610 (1st Call) for Procurement of 220kV (13 No.), 132kV (10 No.) and 100kV (02) Voltage Class Power Transformers/ICT (Total 25 No.) along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Enhancement of Transformation Capacity under Amravati; Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar; Karad; Nashik, Pune & Vashi Zones of MSETCL.	21424.04 25000.00	22.10.2026 17.00 Hrs 22.10.2026 17.15 Hrs.
Pre-Bid Meeting Venue 8th Floor, MSETCL, "Prakashganga", BKC, Bandra (E), Mumbai	Date 06.10.2026	Time 14:30 Hrs.

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V)
CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai
Tel. No.: 022-69852712/ 69852720 **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in,
For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**
Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.** Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (P&C)

ADDIS ABABA

Eight killed in drone strike at camp for displaced people in Ethiopia



AP

A drone strike on a camp for internally displaced people in northern Tigray region in Ethiopia on Sunday killed at least eight people, a humanitarian source said on Monday. Fighting broke out between Tigray People's Liberation Front and federal forces on September 23, sparking fears of a return to the 2020-2022 civil war. AFP

WASHINGTON

U.S. withdraws all bomber aircraft from U.K. airbase over 'new threats'



AFP

The U.S. on Sunday said that it had withdrawn all B-1 bombers from the British airbase of RAF Fairford, reportedly due to "new threats", with Britain's government insisting on Monday that the site is safe. A counter-terrorism probe was launched after a group was reported for "suspicious" activity near the base on September 27. AFP

LAGOS

Nigerian President confirms 32 dead after military plane crash



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

A Nigerian Air Force plane crashed on Monday in the country's southwestern Ondo state, killing all 32 people on board, President Bola Tinubu said. The passenger aircraft was on a "routine mission" from Benin City in southern Nigeria to the economic hub of Lagos when it went down at Igbokoda in Ondo state, he said. AFP

BEIJING

Philippines involved in 'provocative acts' in South China Sea, says China



AP

China warned Philippines on Monday against "provocative acts" in the disputed South China Sea, accusing a Philippine aircraft of an airspace violation. The Philippine forces said a Chinese fighter jet interfered with a "routine military patrol" carried out by a Cessna 208 turboprop near the Scarborough Shoal on Saturday. AFP

Brazil lurches to the right as Lula falters

President trailed his challenger Flávio Bolsonaro by about 1.8 percentage points, or 2.2 million votes; the right-wing Liberal Party broke voting records in Congress, emerged as the dominant force in the Senate and made significant gains in State assemblies; Lula and Flávio will face a run-off on Oct. 25

Shobhan Saxena
SAO PAULO

Sunday night was supposed to be historic for Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, who was seeking a record fourth term as Brazil's President. But when the results came in, the night looked gloomy. Instead of winning in the first round, as his supporters had expected, Lula trailed his challenger Flávio Bolsonaro by about 1.8 percentage points, or 2.2 million votes. With Flávio also falling short of the 50% needed for an outright victory, the election now moves to a second round on October 25 – leaving Lula facing a tougher contest than anticipated, while Bolsonaro heads into the runoff with the momentum of having finished first.



Men look at newspapers displaying coverage of Brazil's presidential election results at a newsstand in Rio de Janeiro on Monday. AFP

The two candidates struck sharply different notes as the results became clear. Flávio, the eldest son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, declared that Brazilians were demanding change. "It is the end of the era of the Workers Party (PT); it is a big change in our country," he told reporters in Brasília. Lula, speaking to supporters in São Paulo, acknowledged that the result had been unexpected. "I confess to you that I was convinced I would win the election in the first round," he said. But Lula insisted that the contest had now entered a new phase. "The second round is a new campaign," he said, arguing that the runoff would give voters a direct choice between the two candidates and their visions.

Political pundits agree that the second round is a new election and can go either way. But there is little doubt that, for now, the momentum is with the right. As if Flávio staying ahead of Lula in the presidential election was not shocking enough for Brazil's left, the results for Congress, the Senate and State governors came as a big jolt too. Candidates from the Bolsonaros' Liberal Party (PL) broke voting records in Congress, while the party emerged as the dominant force in the Senate and made significant gains in State assemblies. Flávio's supporters also account for a majority of the governors elected in the first round, pointing to a broad rightward shift that extends beyond the presidential race.

But the most significant feature of the rightward shift may be that the PL has not grown at the expense of Lula's party. The far-right party has expanded its base by eating into the traditional conservative and centre-right political space. With 19 senators elected, the PL will increase its representation from 15 to 28 seats from February 2027, giving it the second-largest single-party bloc in the Senate since Brazil's return to democracy.

While the left has maintained its position in the Chamber and Senate, the far right has grown by devouring much of the right.

Another factor behind Flávio's strong performance was the evangelical vote, which has increasingly consolidated behind the Bolsonaro family, while Lula failed to translate Brazil's large Catholic population into the electoral advantage his campaign had expected. The contrast was particularly striking after the controversy surrounding Nossa Senhora Aparecida, Brazil's patron saint, which became a political issue during the campaign. In municipalities with an above-average concentration of evangelicals, Flávio won 52% of the valid votes. The contrast was even sharper in municipalities with the highest concentration of Catholics. Lula's share there fell by 11 percentage points compared with his previous performance.

Pakistan, Turkiye to deploy forces in Saudi Arabia

Reuters
ISLAMABAD

Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye agreed on Monday to move immediately to implement their collective defence commitments and ensure the "rapid deployment" of agreed military forces and capabilities in Saudi Arabia, the three countries said in a joint statement shared by Pakistan's Foreign Ministry.

The decision was taken at an emergency meeting of the Mecca Defence Alliance in Riyadh and would be carried out under "approved arrangements" and the laws of the three countries, the statement said.

The meeting "reaffirmed the solidarity and unity of our countries in confronting the heinous attacks against the Kingdom and the holy sites," Saudi Defence Minister said on X.

The three countries signed the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement in August, under which an armed attack on one member is considered an attack on all.

Forces of the Saudi-led coalition fighting in Yemen have recaptured several key areas around Bab el-Mandeb Strait from Iran-backed Houthi rebels, Yemeni officials said Monday.

The offensive came just after the rebels said they had captured more territory in the southwestern Yemen, taking a key town in a blow to the Saudi-backed forces as they advanced toward a strategic provincial capital in the region.

(With AFP inputs)

Sánchez calls early elections in Spain after housing protests

Associated Press
MADRID

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez announced early general elections on Monday, looking to seize momentum from housing protests that have roiled the country and frame the vote around issues that are favourable to his Socialist party.

The election is scheduled for November 29 and will come roughly eight months earlier than originally planned.

In recent weeks, Spaniards have demanded solutions for the country's entrenched housing crisis, holding repeated protests in cities across the country after public outrage grew over the widely publicised eviction of an 87-year-old woman in Madrid last month. Mr. Sánchez's government suffered a bruising legislative defeat last week after right-wing Opposition parties voted against emergency decrees introduced by his government to address evictions and real estate speculation.



Spanish PM Pedro Sánchez

But if Mr. Sánchez's decision backfires, it would pave the way for a right-wing coalition of conservatives and the far-right Vox party, bringing an end to one of Europe's most prominent progressive governments and vocal critics of the Trump administration in the U.S.

Pneumonia death at plague institute in Siberia raises alarm

The Associated Press

Russian authorities have quarantined a hospital and are monitoring contacts of an employee at a plague research institute in Siberia who contracted pneumonia of an "unknown" cause. Local state TV said the woman died last week.

Russian authorities said they found no evidence that her illness was caused by any of the pathogens she worked with. But the case has raised alarm in Russia after unconfirmed media reports suggested she might have died of pneumonic plague – a less common but severe form of plague that can spread from person to person.

The woman worked at the Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia in the Far East in Irkutsk, southeastern Siberia.

Irkutsk Gov. Igor Kobzev said called it a suspected case of "a particularly dangerous infection."

U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Monday he did not think there is cause for alarm, but the U.S. was closely watching.

Two dead, 11 rescued as ship catches fire, sinks in Black Sea

Agence France-Presse
BUCHAREST

Two crew died and 11 were rescued on Monday after a fire broke out on a ship in the Black Sea which later sank, Romanian authorities said.

The cause of the fire was not given. The Black Sea has become a battlefield for increasing drone attacks in the Russia-Ukraine war.



A Romanian naval spokesperson said the ship, Royad Mammadov, sank about 30 nautical miles south of Sfantu Gheorghe. REUTERS

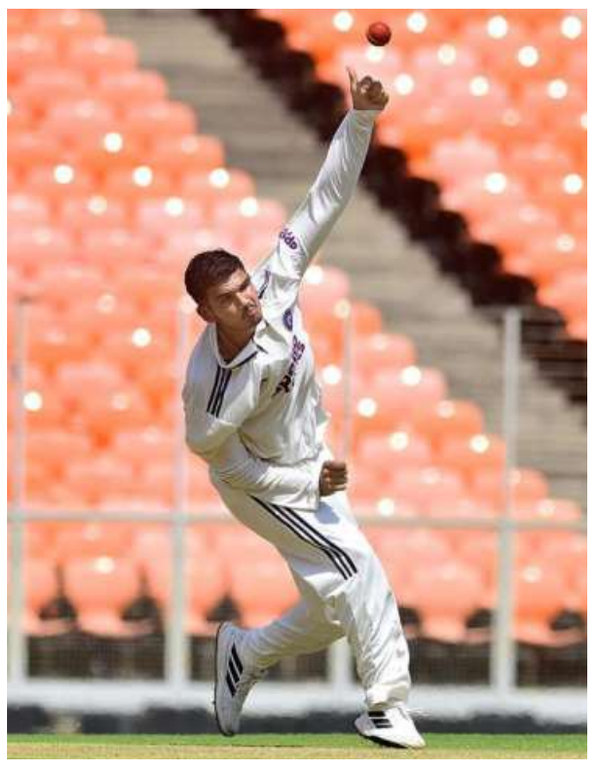
A Romanian naval spokesperson named the ship as the 139-metre long Royad Mammadov and the interior ministry said it sank about 30 nautical miles south of the fishing port of Sfantu Gheorghe.

Asked if the vessel was hit by a drone, the Defence Ministry did not reply.

Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelensky claimed that Russian drones struck the "civilian vessel carrying corn". He said Azerbaijani and Indian nationals were on board.

Sport

Baloda's six-for leaves the Aussies in a bind



Wheeling away: Baloda's toil reaped rich dividends. VIJAY SONEJI

AUS U-19 IN INDIA

Sahil Mathur
AHMEDABAD

Tanmay Baloda had a long, laborious day. The left-arm spinner bowled 25 overs, including 18 in his first spell.

But it was all worth it when he leapt in joy after picking up a six-wicket haul on the opening day of the second youth Test between India under-19 and Australia under-19 here at the Narendra Modi Stadium on Monday.

Baloda finished with six for 32 and helped the host bowl out the visitor for 174. India u-19 ended the day 136 runs behind, but lost openers Lakshya Raichandani and Sagar Virk to bring Australia back in the game.

Baloda had taken centre stage earlier.

The 18-year-old broke three acts of resistance from the Australians. The first came when Neel Patel (31) and Eli Brain put on 22 after Priyanshu Singh and Mohit Ulva reduced Australia to 28 for two.

Baloda immediately trapped Brain in front for four, and when Neel danced down the track, the wicketkeeper stumped him. From the other end, Ayaan Akram had Blake Cattle poking, while Baloda had Zed Hollick caught behind.

After Australia lost four wickets inside five overs, Charlie Henderson (37) and Jacob Pietz (26) put up the second act. The duo, solid in defence, tested India's patience, adding 70 runs off 242 deliveries for the seventh wicket.

However, right after tea, Baloda broke through Pietz' defence, and soon Akram had Henderson caught at first slip.

But Australia fought back through Thomas Vaseo and Patrick Sullivan. Baloda, though, did what he had done throughout the day – break the tailenders' resistance.

The scores: Australia u-19 174 in 73 overs (Tanmay Baloda 6/32) vs. India u-19 38/2 in 15 overs.
Toss: India.

LIVE TELECAST

India vs West Indies: First T20I, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 7 p.m.

Football: International friendly, India vs Uruguay, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 7.30 p.m.

Nations League: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 9.30 p.m. & Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & LIV, 12.15 a.m. (Wednesday)

An opportunity for the 'A' team players to stake claim in ODIs

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

In 366 days, India will step onto the park for its 2027 ODI World Cup opener against Australia in Cape Town, South Africa.

The 'A' squads of both nations will contest a three-match one-day series starting at the Cricket Association of Pondicherry Stadium on Tuesday, hoping to book a ticket to the plateaus of southern Africa next year.

The countdown to the global tournament will seem to be ticking faster for these players, as opportunities to stake a claim for selection diminish with each passing day. Both India and Australia have fairly settled squads in the 50-over format, leaving only a few spots up for grabs.

The India-A squad for the one-dayers wears a similar look to the one that participated in a tri-series involving Afghanistan and Sri Lanka in June. Among those added was all-rounder Hardik Pandya. The series was a critical step to gauge his fitness ahead of the New Zealand tour later this month. But a reported shin injury has ruled him out. Mumbai's Suryansh Shedge has been named his replacement. Jharkhand's Anukul Roy has replaced Naman Dhir, who has been added to the squad for the West Indies T20Is.

"There is a lot of flexibility in this squad. All these players are multi-dimensional and can fit into any role," said India-A coach L. Balaji.

"India-A is a direct pathway toward the international stage – you saw Anshul Kamboj getting an immediate opportunity. BCCI has been phenomenal in scheduling these opportunities for youngsters," he added.

Only six players remain from the Australia-A side that lost the multi-day leg 0-1 a few days ago.

A fresh set of pacers, including the uncapped Mahli Beardman, will have the chance to improve their stocks ahead of a World Cup year.

The first match of the one-day series will be a day-night contest, starting at 2 p.m.

GAME PLAN

Men in Blue will look to rotate the players, says Morkel



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

India's bowling coach Morne Morkel said the team will look to rotate the players. "I'm pretty sure (head coach) Gautam (Gambhir) will look to rotate (them). It is up to the selectors, the coach, and the captain to decide which XI will be the best to win a game on home soil. That will always be the main focus".

ADMIRABLE ATTITUDE

Bowling coach Morkel all praise for rookie pacers Prince and Mayank



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Prince (Yadav) was a net bowler a couple of years ago. He's now playing for India; the resilience and hard work he's put into his game is admirable. Mayank (Yadav) had a couple of injury setbacks; for a youngster to get through that and play again for India shows real attitude — India's bowling coach Morne Morkel.

PRESTIGIOUS HONOUR

Kumkum and Sujeet named first winners of IOA awards



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Archer Kumkum Mohod and wrestler Sujeet Kalkal have been named the inaugural recipients of the Jaspal Rana Award and Raja Randhir Singh Award, respectively, by the Indian Olympic Association (IOA). They have been rewarded for their outstanding performances at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games.

FILLIP

A good result is important as it builds confidence, says Jamil



K.R. DEEPAK

India football coach Khalid Jamil stressed on the importance of the result in building confidence. "The result is important because if you get a good one, it gives the team confidence. But we also have a plan to build a strong team for the future," Jamil said ahead of the Uruguay game.

West Indies could run India close in five-match T20I series

The host boasts of a power-packed batting line-up; Samson under the scanner; how the team management handles Sooryavanshi will be interesting; the visitor gets a big boost with the return of Hetmyer, Powell, Shepherd and Akeal

WI IN INDIA

S. Dipak Ragav
LUCKNOW

For quite a while now, a lot of ink has been spilt on the packed schedule, especially for Team India. The country is blessed with an immense pool of talent, so much so that it can easily field multiple squads across formats. While that is often used to justify the gruelling fixtures, the powers that be need to seriously think about how much is too much.

Just two days after beating Pakistan to secure a gold medal at the Asian Games, Shreyas Iyer's men will be out on the park again to take on West Indies in a five-match T20I series that starts at the Ekana Stadium on Tuesday.

The Men in Blue's record in T20Is since the World Cup triumph earlier this year has been mixed. The side lost six games on the bounce in completed games, including a shock 0-2 defeat to Ireland followed by another wipeout in England (0-4). Following that, India breezed past Zimbabwe (3-0) and, more recently, Afghanistan (3-0). Now this assignment offers a chance to test the squad against a formidable Caribbean outfit. The host has a power-packed line-up that bats deep, including all-rounders Shivam Dube and Nitish Kumar. It is complemented by the potent spin combination of Kuldeep Yadav, Ravi Bishnoi and Axar Patel. Arshdeep Singh will lead the pace attack, with Prince Yadav and Mayank Yadav being the other quicks.



Big question: Will the Indian think-tank prefer Sooryavanshi over Samson? SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

However, one player who is under scrutiny is Sanju Samson. The wicket-keeper-batter has had a lean run since the World Cup, barring his two half-centuries against Afghanistan. With the next T20 World Cup scheduled in late 2028, it is an ideal time to experiment and groom the next batch. One thing to watch is how the think-tank handles Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and helps him find his feet in international cricket.

The visitor will hope to put the ODI series defeat behind it. The return of T20 specialists like Shimron Hetmyer, Rovman Powell and Romario Shepherd adds the much-needed firepower. On their day, any one of the trio can take the game away from the opposition quickly.

The bowling, too, will be bolstered by the addition of left-arm spinner Akeal Hosein, who had an impressive IPL for Chennai Super Kings. Though India will start as favourite, Shai Hope's men will be keen to give the home team a run for its money.

The teams (from):

India: Shreyas Iyer (Capt.), Tilak Varma (Vice-capt.), Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (wk), Sanju Samson (wk), Shivam Dube, Kuldeep Yadav, Axar Patel, Naman Dhir, Ravi Bishnoi, Nitish Kumar, Arshdeep Singh, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav.

West Indies: Shai Hope (Capt. & wk), Jewel Andrew, Roston Chase, Matthew Forde, Shimron Hetmyer, Akeal Hosein, Shamar Joseph, Gudakesh Motie, Keemo Paul, Kamil Pooran, Rovman Powell, Sherfane Rutherford, Quentin Sampson, Romario Shepherd, Shamar Springer, Amir Jangoo (wk).

The dates: Oct. 6 (Lucknow), Oct. 9 (Ranchi), Oct. 11 (Indore), Oct. 14 (Hyderabad), and Oct. 17 (Bengaluru).

Matches start at 7 p.m.

India looks to bounce back as it faces the Uruguay test

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA



Danger man: Nunez is likely to keep the Indian defence busy on Tuesday. K.R. DEEPAK

The most high-profile international chapter in Indian football ends with perhaps its most intriguing test when the national team meets two-time World champion Uruguay at the Salt Lake Stadium on Tuesday. The Blue Tigers have already faced Panama and Brazil in this window, holding the Central Americans to a 1-1 draw before suffering a 0-4 defeat at the hands of the five-time World Cup winner.

Uruguay provides another test of how far Khalid Jamil's side can compete against an opponent with considerably greater stature and international experience.

Jamil has a squad built around experience and emerging players. Forward Ryan Williams, who gave up his Australian citizenship to play for India, will be the the principal attacker after scoring against Panama. Manvir Singh, Edmund Lalrindika and Vikram Partap Singh provide further options in the final third.

In midfield, Anirudh Thapa's return adds experience alongside Apuia and Sahal Abdul Samad. After the lessons of the Brazil game, India will need discipline without the ball and greater efficiency when opportunities arrive. Anwar Ali, Abhishek Singh Tekcham, Bijoy Varghese and Akash Mishra form the backline, while goalkeeper Gurpreet Singh Sandhu needs to bounce back after a rather poor outing against Brazil.

Beginning a new chapter under former star Diego Forlan, Uruguay will look to build on its 4-1 victory over South Korea on September 28. Forlan is in his first international window as head coach and has already seen his team respond strongly on the Asian tour. After a 3-1 defeat by Japan, Uruguay outplayed South Korea, with Darwin Nunez scoring twice in Seoul.

Nunez will pose the most obvious threat to India's defence, but Forlan will be without some of his biggest names. Federico Valverde and Giorgian de Arrascaeta are missing through injury.

For Jamil, the challenge is to restore belief in the Indian side by demonstrating that it can restrict a celebrated opponent and punish it when chances arise.

Uruguay last met India in Kolkata during the 1982 Nehru Gold Cup, winning 3-1 at the Eden Gardens. Forty four years later, *La Celeste* returns to the city, but the stakes are different.

For India, it is another occasion to measure the distance between itself and one of world football's established powers, and perhaps narrow it even if only for one evening.

Akeal confident Windies will push India

S. Dipak Ragav
LUCKNOW

West Indies spinner Akeal Hosein expressed confidence that his side would push India, the reigning T20 World champion, hard in the five-match series starting on Tuesday.

"I back my boys. Even when we played in the World Cup, we gave them a hell of a run. They know the fear that we bring to T20 cricket. They know the brand that we play. We know they are a dangerous team, but we're not going to back down," said Akeal.

"I would think both teams are looking forward to the challenge. It's about who plans best and who executes best. We are going to focus on the things that we can control. ."

The 33-year-old is set to play in his 100th T20I match on Tuesday, and the Trinidadian hoped he could continue for another five years.

"I wish I could see the next five years. But for me, first of all, I'm still at 99. I have to get selected to make that 100 game. That being said, it's an achievement in itself. It shows you're dedicated, you're hungry, and your performances have been up to par, too. So it's a good achievement," said Akeal.

Need to strike a balance between continuity and exposure, says Morkel



Task ahead: Morkel and Gambhir will have to put on their thinking cap. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

S. Dipak Ragav
LUCKNOW

India bowling coach Morne Morkel felt that the five-match T20 series against the West Indies would provide a good platform to develop the country's next batch of players in this format.

"Yes, it will be great for Indian cricket if we keep on growing that pool, keep on giving guys that experience and the taste of what it is to play in an Indian shirt," said Morkel.

"The main goal will always be to win games. This group of players has played some exceptional cricket in the last couple of years. The guys who got opportunities have done a brilliant job.

"So it is about looking at the bigger picture, but you also want to win games with them. You want to give the guys who have done well so far the chance to continue that," he added.

On Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's development, Morkel was of the opinion that being around the team will be useful for the youngster even if he doesn't make it to the XI.

"If he's not getting that game time, he's still on a bus, in the dugout, in the hotel with guys who have a lot of experience. Vaibhav sharing that sort of dressing room and talking to guys, watching how they go through their processes and how they set up an innings will be key.

"I'm a big believer that if you put guys in the right environment, they can ask the right questions and observe. I always ask him on the bus, 'What's the one thing you've learned today? Tell me, what did you think about that guy's batting?' That makes him think. The next time he comes to the nets, he will observe those things and adapt," said Morkel.



Messi is the *Albiceleste*'s leading scorer (125) and most capped player (207). FILE PHOTO

Last hurrah for Messi in Argentina colours

Agence France-Presse
BUENOS AIRES

Lionel Messi will bring the curtain down on his glittering Argentina career on Tuesday with a friendly against Benin that marks the dawn of a new era for the South American champion.

After more than two decades of service to his country, the 39-year-old will hand over the captain's armband for good as he makes his final appearance in the *Albiceleste* jersey at the Estadio Monumental. Messi will be joined for his swansong by 85,000 spectators and several of the teammates with whom he reached the pinnacle of football at the World Cup in Qatar, alongside members of Argentina's emerging generation.

India can hurt Uruguay if given time and space: Forlan

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

Uruguay coach Diego Forlan urged his side not to be complacent against India, insisting the host deserves respect despite the gulf in standard between the two sides.

"We know it's going to be really difficult, but we always respect everybody," Forlan said on Monday, the eve of the international friendly.

Uruguay comes into the game after a 1-3 defeat to Japan and a 4-1 win over South Korea, with Forlan stressing that his team has had more time to recover and prepare since the first loss.

"We have more days to work, more days to rest a little bit," he said.

The former Uruguay star, who played an ISL season with Mumbai City FC in 2016, was particularly impressed by what he saw from India against Brazil. "If you give them time and space, they can damage you and they can play well," Forlan said.

The coach said Uruguay would carry its traditional competitive mentality into the contest. "We try to continue that legacy, something that we felt as a player," he said.



Doing the hard yards: It remains to be seen whether Cardozo gets to guard the Uruguayan citadel. K.R. DEEPAK



Jamil. K.R. DEEPAK

Jamil urges India to stay focused

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

India head coach Khalid Jamil has urged his players to maintain concentration throughout the game as the team prepares to face two-time World champion Uruguay at the Salt Lake Stadium on Tuesday.

Acknowledging the quality and experience of the Uruguayan side, Jamil warned that even a single mistake could prove costly against an opponent strong at both ends of the pitch.

"Against Uruguay, we have to start with good concentration and maintain it from the first minute till the end of the game. We have to believe that we can get a good result," he added.

Postal copies: Posted at Egmore RMS, Pathrika Channel



Picture perfect: Rest of India pacers Mukesh, Akash and Mukesh Choudhary celebrate with the trophy.
IMRAN NISSAR

Mukesh and Akash savour tight bond

The RoI pacers shared nine wickets between them to bundle out J&K for 111 in the fourth innings at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium

IRANI CUP

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

When did Mukesh Kumar and Akash Deep meet for the first time?

Neither seems to consider that relevant to the friendship.

"Forget it. *Jab bhi mile hain, gale mile hain* (Whenever we have met, we have hugged each other)," Mukesh grinned after the pair starred in Rest of India's victory over Jammu & Kashmir in the Irani Cup.

Such is the bond of two fast bowlers who have had eerily similar journeys from Bihar to the Indian team via Bengal. At the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium on Sunday, Mukesh (six for 33) and Akash (three for 25) shared nine wickets among them to bowl out J&K for 111 in the fourth innings.

> Whatever happens for us, it happens together. I don't know what is written in our destiny
> AKASH

"Whatever happens for us, it happens together. I don't know what is written in our destiny," Akash said. "The bodies are different, but our fate is the same. That's why it is difficult to explain. We ourselves don't know why everything happens alike for us."

For Akash, a bag of wickets in this fixture has added significance given he was coming back after a seven-month injury layoff. The 29-year-old touched speeds in excess of 140kmph right through. "My body needed a rest. God gave it to me in the form of an injury and I utilised it well. I am not putting in a lot of effort to bowl 140kmph-plus. This is the result of 6-7 months of training," he noted.

Smotherman wins maiden PGA Tour title

Agence France-Presse
LOS ANGELES

American golfer Austin Smotherman claimed the first PGA Tour victory of his career on Sunday, sealing a two-stroke win at the Bank of Utah Championship.

Smotherman carded a closing three-under-par 68 at the Black Desert Resort in Ivins to finish on 25 under. That was good enough for the World No. 121 to hold off Doug Ghim in second place, who shot a final-round 69 for a 24 under total. David Ford's seven-under-par 64 left him tied for third with Trace Crowe, three shots off the lead, with Kevin Streelman and Ben James a shot further back

AROUND THE CITY



Champion spikers: The SRM IST team that beat Karpagam University 21-25, 25-19, 25-18, 24-26, 15-6 in the final to win the State-level invitational men's volleyball tournament, organised by JHYC Volleyball Club, at Neravy in Karaikal.

Pandiaraj's five-for helps Mugalivakkam win

Pandiaraj claimed five for 28 to set up a seven-wicket win for Mugalivakkam CC over Guru CC in Zone-B of the Kancheepuram DCA league.

The scores:
Zone-B: Guru 74 in 18.3 overs (Y. Pranav 35, Pandiaraj 5/28) lost to Mugalivakkam 77/3 in 13.4 overs. Budding Star 217/4 in 30 overs (Rithul 102, Sarvesh 36) bt SSCC 128 in 24.4 overs (Manikandan 31, Ajay Kumar 37, Remo 3/30, Praveen 3/11).
Zone-C: KTCA 167/6 in 30 overs (Thanush Adhityan 46, Dinesh 50) lost to Vijay 168/3 in 25.2 overs (Janakiraman 97, Sampathkumar



Pandiaraj (Mugalivakkam CC, 5/28), Rithul (Budding Star CC, 102).

55).

Elumalai and Siundararaman win

M. Elumalai and R.V. Siundararaman secured 67.32% to win the Madras Gymkhana Club open bridge tournament. Pooja Chhabria and R. Krishnan finished runner-up with 66.29%



Vaidehee.

Manish and Vaidehee have it easy

NATIONAL TENNIS

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Top seeds Manish Sureshkumar and Vaidehee Chaudhari launched their campaigns in style, advancing to the second round with straight-set victories on the opening day of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship at the DLTA Complex here on Monday.

The results:
Round of 32: Men: Manish Sureshkumar bt Prasad Ingale 6-1, 6-2; Nitin Sinha bt K. Suresh 6-2, 6-2; Maan Kesharwani bt Vansh Bisht 6-4, 6-4; Parth Aggarwal bt Madhwin Kamath 7-5, 1-6, 6-2; Rohan Mehra bt A. Senthilkumar 6-3, 5-7, 6-2.
Women: Vaidehee Chaudhari bt Riya Sachdeva 6-0, 6-1; Shruti Ahlawat bt Chevika Sama 6-4, 6-0; Akanksha Nitture bt Lakshmi Gowda 7-6(4), 7-6(5); Akansha Ghosh bt Divya Bhardwaj 6-4, 6-2; Saily Thakkar bt Pooja Ingale 6-3, 6-3; Yubrani Banerjee bt Hasini Davunaboina 6-1, 6-0.
Round of 64: Boys u-18: Praneel Sharma bt Ritvik Dutt 6-0, 6-0; Kushagra Arora bt Aritra Sasmal 6-3, 6-0; Veer Jiten Madam bt Yaj Malik 6-1, 6-1.
Girls u-18: Riddhi Shinde bt Zoha Qureshi 6-2, 6-1; Paavani Bisht bt Ruhin Kaushal 6-2, 6-0.

Portugal, sans Ronaldo, seals last-eight berth

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Portugal became the first team to reach the quarterfinals of the Nations League when it beat Norway 2-1 on Sunday, but Jurgen Klopp's Germany was frustrated by Greece.

The Portuguese showed they did not need Cristiano Ronaldo, who walked out of the camp on Wednesday when coach Jorge Jesus relegated him to the bench.

Germany failed to break down a resolute Greek side in a goalless stalemate in Thessaloniki.

The results:
League A: Greece 0 drew with Germany 0; Netherlands 2 (Koopmeiners 31, Zirkzee 71) bt Serbia 1 (Cvetkovic 35); Portugal 2 (Joao Cancelo 38, Goncalo Ramos 79) bt Norway 1 (Ajer 36); Wales 0 lost to Denmark 1 (Hojlund 75-pen).
League B: Kosovo 1 (Asllani 70) drew with Austria 1 (Lang 85); Rep. of Ireland 1 (Parrott 39-pen) drew with Israel 1 (Peretz 47).
League D: Malta 1 (Teuma 49) bt Andorra 0; Azerbaijan 1 (Khaibulaev 25) bt Lithuania 0.

Ragnarok obliges in the feature event

HYDERABAD: Trainer D. Netto's ward Ragnarok, ridden by Surendra Singh, won the Royal Calcutta Turf Club Trophy, the main event of Monday's (Oct. 5) races. The winner is owned by M/s. Donald Anthony Netto & P. Ranga Raju.

1. LAND OF GLORY PLATE (1,100M): CALABASAS (Swarup Singh) 1, Winning Attitude (Md. Ekram) 2, Great Giver (Sonu K) 3 and Starlight Dancer (Trevor) 4. 1-1/4, 2-1/4 and 2. 1m, 7.92s. ₹21 (w), 18, 17 and 17 (p). SHP: 39, THP: 39. FP: 148, Q: 112, Tanala: 930. Favourite: Calabasas. Owners: M/s. M. Ramakrishna Reddy, Bharat Venkat Epur & Mrs. Rajini Meka. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

2. BELOVED PRINCE PLATE (1,400M): CHAMPION REEF (P. Trevor) 1, Twilight King (D.S. Deora) 2, Rajendra (Ashad Asbar) 3 and Gachanmanasvin (Md. Ismail) 4. 3/4, 7-1/4 and 1. 1m, 27.43s. ₹16 (w), 10, 17 and 21 (p). SHP: 35, THP: 36, FP: 39, Q: 32, Tanala: 191. Favourite: Champion Reef. Owners: M/s. H.S. Srikanth & Anup Kumar Bajaj. Trainer: M. Srinivas Reddy.

3. MYSORE RACE CLUB TROPHY (1,200M): POWER OF THE SEA (P. Trevor) 1, My Way My Rules (Akshay K) 2, Suryavanshi (Surya Prakash) 3 and Beverley (Arjun) 4. 2, 2-3/4 and 1-1/4. 1m, 14.00s. ₹24 (w), 14, 12 and 12 (p). SHP: 24, THP: 46, FP: 54, Q: 27, Tanala: 233. Favourite: Power Of The Sea. Owners: M/s. Rajendran rep. Rapar's Galloping Stars LLP, Anjan Kumar Rangaraj, M/s. Manjri Horse Breeders Farm Pvt. Ltd. & Ram H. Shroff & Raj H. Shroff rep. Stride Livestock Pvt. Ltd. Trainer: A. Imran Khan.

4. CHARMINAR TROPHY (1,600M): LOVE IN PARIS (Akshay Kumar) 1, Kinship (D.S. Deora) 2, Ashwa Jaffna (Gaurav) 3 and Valledonna (Trevor) 4. 1-1/2, 4-1/2 and 5-1/4. 1m, 40.02s. ₹15 (w), 11 and 16 (p). SHP: 28, THP: 38, FP: 33, Q: 28, Tanala: 54. Favourite: Love In Paris. Owners: Mr. M. Raghunath rep. Gava Racing Syndicate LLP & Mr. P. Amarender Reddy. Trainer: K. Satheesh.

5. ROYAL CALCUTTA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,200M): RAGNAROK (Surendra Singh) 1, Glorious Power (Bhawani S) 2, Exclusive Black (Trevor) 3 and Dyanoosh (Kuldeep Jr.) 4. 1-1/2, 2-1/4 and 1/2. 1m, 13.13s. ₹31 (w), 16, 28 and 28 (p). SHP: 83, THP: 82, FP: 710, Q: 405, Tanala: 6,047. Favourite: Ragnarok. Owners: Mr. Donald Anthony Netto & Mr. P. Ranga Raju. Trainer: D. Netto.

6. STAR OF GWALIOR PLATE (1,200M): DECEMBER RAIN (Mohit Singh) 1, Exclusive Luck (B. Nikhil) 2, Vedanta (Kuldeep Jr.) 3 and Hopewell Island (G. Naresh) 4. 3-1/2, 1/2 and 3/4. 1m, 16.25s. ₹22 (w), 16, 55 and 10 (p). SHP: 125, THP: 79, FP: 363, Q: 277, Tanala: 3,452. Favourite: December Rain. Owner: Mr. Gurjinder Singh. Trainer: Jasbir Singh.

Jackpot: 70%: ₹710 (544 tkts.) & 30%: 84 (1,965 tkts.).
Mini Jackpot: 450 (152 tkts.).
Treble: (i) 90 (301 tkts.), (ii) 117 (372 tkts.).

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Grit, gold and a house that kabaddi built

A player-turned-coach, Neeta Dadwe has spent decades learning the game, building teams and pushing the women's game towards a promising future

Anirudh Velamuri



Gold. Silver. Bronze. Brass. It all gleams at you the moment you step inside. A towering cabinet blazes with medals, cups, and memorabilia, every piece neatly in its place. Flanking it stand trophies as tall as a small child, too big to fit anywhere and too important to hide. "Kabaddi gave me this house. Everything you see here is what the sport has given me. All of it is a result of my hard work," declares Neeta Dadwe, pride lighting up her face.

To understand the woman behind that wall of silverware, step out of the house and onto the road that leads to it. A quiet bylane in the heart of the city, far from the roar of Hyderabad's traffic, it tips steeply downhill, as if to remind you that you are indeed standing on the Deccan plateau.

At first glance, it's unremarkable. Only, it isn't. This is a roll call of Indian sport and power. Two-time Olympic medallist P.V. Sindhu, India's first woman Grandmaster Koneru Humpy, and former cricketer Venkatapathy Raju all live in these bylanes. C.V. Anand, Telangana's Director General of Police, is a resident too, while Karnam Malleswari, the first Indian woman to win an Olympic medal, once called it home.

And somewhere amid all that star power lives Neeta, who has just led India's women's kabaddi team to gold at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.



The reinvention

An Arjuna Awardee with a stellar playing career, she reinvented herself as a coach and never looked back, guiding the national side to gold at the 2014 Asian Games and the 2016 South Asian Games.

Her name may not echo as loudly as those of her neighbours, but the shine of her achievements is every bit as bright. A day after she landed in the City of Pearls to a roaring welcome at the airport, *The Hindu* stepped into her cozy home for a conversation.

The Indian women's kabaddi team defeated Iran 37-34 in a closely fought final, successfully defending the gold medal it won at the Hangzhou edition in 2022. As captain Pushpa Rana, all-rounder Jyoti Thakur and several other players revealed after the triumph in Japan, the groundwork for this success was laid at carefully planned training camps.

"Our first camp was at SAI Gandhinagar in May for one month. We had 42 girls and brought it down to 29 there, which was a tough task for us on the selection committee - which includes Mamata Poojary and V. Tejeswini Bai. The next camp was for 15 days, again at SAI Gandhinagar, while the third was at the JSW facility in Ballari," Neeta recalled.

"We got stuff like a fitness trainer, masseur, sauna bath, ice bath, and more, which is not common for us in kabaddi. I was the coach in 2014 (Asian Games) and we didn't have as many facilities as we got this time. The kids were very happy because our camps were like international ones. And because of that, for probably the first time, we barely had any injuries during the tournament."

No mobiles, please

Besides physical and mental training, video analysis and tactical discussions, the team followed a 'no mobile phones' policy during the camps.

"We asked the federation and got their permission to do it. The more you use your mobile, especially later in the night, the more you will feel tired the next day. We got the players very much involved in it. One girl would take turns to collect the phones and deposit them. They would get them on Saturday and by Sunday's end, they would be returned."

What they could not prepare for, and what has since been widely reported, were the poor living conditions that awaited them. The entire contingent was put up on a docked cruise ship, and it wasn't as luxurious as it sounds.

"The schedule was very tight for us, and the ground was very far from the ship where we were put up. To be honest, not everyone fits [in the accommodation provided] on the ship. Food was also an issue. Non-vegetarians didn't have a problem, but the vegetarians faced many. However, the girls managed to face it all without many complaints," Neeta explained, adding that bread became a staple of her diet there.

On the mat, however, things were largely smooth. The side breezed past its group-stage and semifinal opponents before running into a familiar rival, Iran, in the final. India made a bright start and raced to a 5-2 lead, before Iran levelled with a super tackle and surged ahead 7-5.

In the side's closest contest in Japan, it had a vocal crowd behind it, including members of the Indian Olympic Association, headlined by its president P.T. Usha.

"P.T. Usha came to watch our match. The whole of IOA came. We were all very tense. I was so tense that I couldn't even look back [at the stands]. The girls and I were under a lot of pressure, but we all had the same goal, which was to win the gold medal," she admitted.

"In 2018 we won silver. Besides that, we won gold in 2010, 2014, and 2022. I was very scared and worried about how we would fare this time. Not just because of past results, but also because we selected a strong team this time and had good camps."

Among the things that helped the team get past the Iranians was video footage of their time in India in the months leading up to the Asiad.

"They had been practicing in India for two months. They were in Himachal, played with two or three clubs in Haryana. We asked the federation for some of their videos, and we studied them well."

For this Asian Games, Neeta was assisted by Mamata, someone she had coached extensively before, including at the 2014 edition of the continental competition. While that familiarity helped in discussing tactics, the two also shared the same nervous tension as the campaign kicked off.

"We used to sit at night and map on a piece of paper who should be played where. And on the first day there, neither of us slept because we were tense. If we used Ritu Negi in the corner pool, then they [the opponents] would've made a strategy for it. So we changed things up to give others some food for thought. In the end, we were working towards bringing the country a medal. We were not playing for our States or for Railways or anything. We were representing India."

Neeta has coached the Indian women's side to two Asian Games golds, but can't bring herself to compare both. "Zameen aasman ka farak hai" (a world of difference) came the declaration.

"The emotions involved are very different. In 2018, Iran edged India narrowly in the final. They were coached by our very own Shailaja Jain, who taught them exactly how to play against us. Also, there is a lot more competition now. Look at how well Nepal (lost to India in the semifinals) did. No one expected that."

Having excelled as a player and a coach, how does Neeta compare the two experiences? "A player and a coach are different. A player gets to enjoy more; I was one, I know it very well," she grinned.

Neeta the player greatly helped Neeta the coach. She channelled those experiences to help gel better with the team and structure training sessions in ways that kept players wholeheartedly involved. That also included keeping the workload relatively light in the days leading up to the tournament.

Fitness, however, was one area where there were no compromises.

"When I was a player, we used to make a fitness schedule. And on the days we had to do fast training or speed workouts, those days we used to cry or make excuses. So I told my girls upfront that I did not want to hear any excuses. I said we are all working towards a common goal and that they can express their feelings freely. And to be fair, they also supported me well in this endeavour."

Professional pathway

While interest in kabaddi took off with the launch of the Pro Kabaddi League in 2014, it is the men who have reaped the rewards, while the women's ecosystem is yet to get an equivalent. A Women's Kabaddi Challenge was held in 2016, but it was a flash in the pan.

"In 2016, we had the Kabaddi Challenge, but it took place in the men's court. If there are three steps in a women's court, there are five in the men's court. And many argued that since volleyball and basketball have same-sized courts for men and women, why not kabaddi? But I believe that if that Challenge took place in a women's court, it would have been a big success," she opined, adding, "If Pro Kabaddi starts for girls, it will be beneficial as more kids will come out in the ecosystem."

PKL's format has allowed the best international stars to ply their trade in India, which has not only helped coaches here understand how they operate but also helped Indian players improve by rubbing shoulders with them. Neeta believes the same knock-on effect would carry over to women.

"Besides getting to know the foreign players better, we will also get better in terms of fitness, nutrition, and more. Pro Kabaddi also provides players with great facilities; I have seen it. In India, after cricket, it is kabaddi only."

That said, Neeta explained that the women have enough tournaments to keep them busy all year round.

"We had the World Cup earlier. From 21st to 31st this month, we have the Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship in Ahmedabad. After that, we have the Indo-Asian Games in Dubai in November. After that, there's the World Cup again. There is something or the other continuously; it's not like before."

"Kabaddi, as you know, is not a game for rich people. I have seen kids come from nothing. Take Aslam (Inamdar) and so many other boys and girls. He told me that there was a time when he did not even get to eat; only he knows what all his mother did for him. He told me his story. If kids benefit from [getting a professional league], it's a matter of pride for them. They can then come up in life thanks to kabaddi."

The Indian women's kabaddi team has clearly benefited from a coach who has walked many a mile in their shoes, back when chances were rare, the spotlight was dim, and the money was thin. That road made Neeta who she is.

And as the interview wound down, she threw in a reminder that it wasn't time for her to rest just yet. For she had already packed for the next stretch: a family road trip to her hometown, Nagpur, home to a local club, the Maratha Lancers, which first lit the fuse on her career.



THE GIST

- An Arjuna Awardee with a stellar playing career, she reinvented herself as a coach and never looked back, guiding the national side to gold at the 2014 Asian Games and the 2016 South Asian Games
- Neeta the player greatly helped Neeta the coach. She channelled those experiences to help gel better with the team and structure training sessions in ways that kept players wholeheartedly involved
- While interest in kabaddi took off with the launch of the Pro Kabaddi League in 2014, it is the men who have reaped the rewards, while the women's ecosystem is yet to get an equivalent

New discovery comes ‘close’ to test biology’s central dogma

The discovery of a protein that can, by itself, dictate the sequence of nucleic acids has caused a stir in the scientific community; commentaries accompanying the work have highlighted the unusual nature of the finding and its implications for one of the foundational ideas of molecular biology

Arun Panchapakesan



Cells use the information in DNA to make a messenger molecule, called mRNA, which then serves as the instruction manual for the cell to make proteins. Representative illustration. IMAGE MADE WITH AI

The field of molecular biology began when scientists attempted to answer a simple question: what molecule makes up the genetic material of an organism?

In the early 1900s, when the field was still in its infancy, there were two plausible candidates: nucleic acids (DNA and RNA) and proteins. At the time, proteins were the preferred candidates thanks to their diverse building blocks.

All proteins (on the earth) are made up of some combination of 20 amino acids. Nucleic acids on the other hand were made up of just four nucleotides, leading to fewer molecular combinations than scientists believed were necessary for the carriers of heredity.

In 1944, three scientists – Oswald Avery, Colin MacLeod, and Maclyn McCarty – showed that when you destroy the proteins and the RNA in certain pathogenic bacteria, something still remains – and mixing that mysterious something with non-pathogenic bacteria could ‘turn’ them into pathogenic ones.

But when you specifically destroy the DNA, the transformation does not happen.

The central dogma

The final nail in the coffin for proteins came in 1952 when Alfred Hershey and Martha Chase used bacteriophages – viruses that infect bacteria – and showed that when you radioactively label the phage DNA with phosphorus and its proteins with sulphur, you could find phosphorus inside the bacteria that the phage infected, but never the sulphur. The phosphorus was even present in subsequent generations of the phage produced by the infected bacteria, showing that DNA was the genetic material.

Soon afterwards, James Watson and Francis Crick proposed the double helical structure for DNA, and their model also explained how one strand helical strand can be used as a template to synthesise the other.

However, finding the answer to molecular biology’s foundational question opened a Pandora’s box of new questions. One of those questions was how the chemical information present in DNA was used to make proteins. At the time, scientists knew that proteins were the ultimate workhorses of the cell and performed all the cellular tasks. However, they did not know how the cell made proteins based on the instructions in the DNA.

In 1958, Crick, with remarkable foresight, proposed what he called the “central dogma” of molecular biology. In a paper in the journal *Symposia of the Society for Experimental Biology*, Crick wrote that “once ‘information’ has passed into protein, it cannot get out again”. He further elaborated that the core principle behind the central dogma was that the “transfer of information from nucleic acid to nucleic acid, or from nucleic acid to protein, may be possible, but transfer from protein to protein or from protein to nucleic acid is impossible.”

Crick used the general term for DNA and RNA collectively, i.e. nucleic acid, rather than DNA alone, because by that time scientists knew that some viruses used RNA as the genetic material. In all other forms of life, RNA serves a different purpose.

An unbeaten rule

Today, we know that cells use the information in the DNA to make a messenger molecule, called mRNA, which then serves as the instruction manual for the cell to make proteins.

The mRNA is a transient intermediate: a cell can stop making it if required and can degrade it if it needs to stop protein production. This way, the cell preserves the instructions in the DNA, makes a copy of the DNA into RNA, and makes protein from RNA.

But when Crick suggested the central dogma, scientists did not fully understand the role of mRNA. The DNA to RNA to protein flow sequence was only elucidated in 1961, and that sequence itself came to be known as the central dogma of molecular biology.

But one wrinkle turned up in 1970. U.S. biologists Howard Temin and David Baltimore reported the discovery of retroviruses – a new family of viruses that used RNA as the genetic material, but then made a DNA copy of it using an enzyme called reverse transcriptase, then mixed this DNA with the DNA of the host. The viruses then continued the ‘DNA to RNA to protein’ sequence. However, the starting point was RNA, and technically, information was flowing backwards along the sequence before it flowed in the conventional way, supposedly violating the central dogma.

The discovery stirred significant debate in the scientific community, and researchers published several articles along the theme of how the central dogma had been violated. Weeks later, Crick himself wrote another paper explaining in greater detail how his guidelines for the central dogma still held, and how, even in his original 1958 paper, he had not ruled out the transfer of information within nucleic acids. He emphasised that in order to violate the central dogma, one had to find information flowing from proteins to proteins or from proteins back to either one of the nucleic acids, i.e. DNA or RNA. It was a credible argument.

Thus, for 69 years, Crick’s central dogma has been unchallenged. There have been some interesting deviations but none completely broke the rule.

A novel mechanism

Now, however, two new papers in the journals *Cell* and *Science* have reported finding a new family of bacterial reverse transcriptases. These enzymes direct cells to synthesise a DNA molecule without a template. Usually, reverse transcriptases use an RNA molecule as a template and make a DNA copy of it. But the new studies said these specific bacterial reverse transcriptases could synthesise DNA without any template at all. Instead, the enzyme itself provided the information needed to determine the sequence of the DNA it generates.

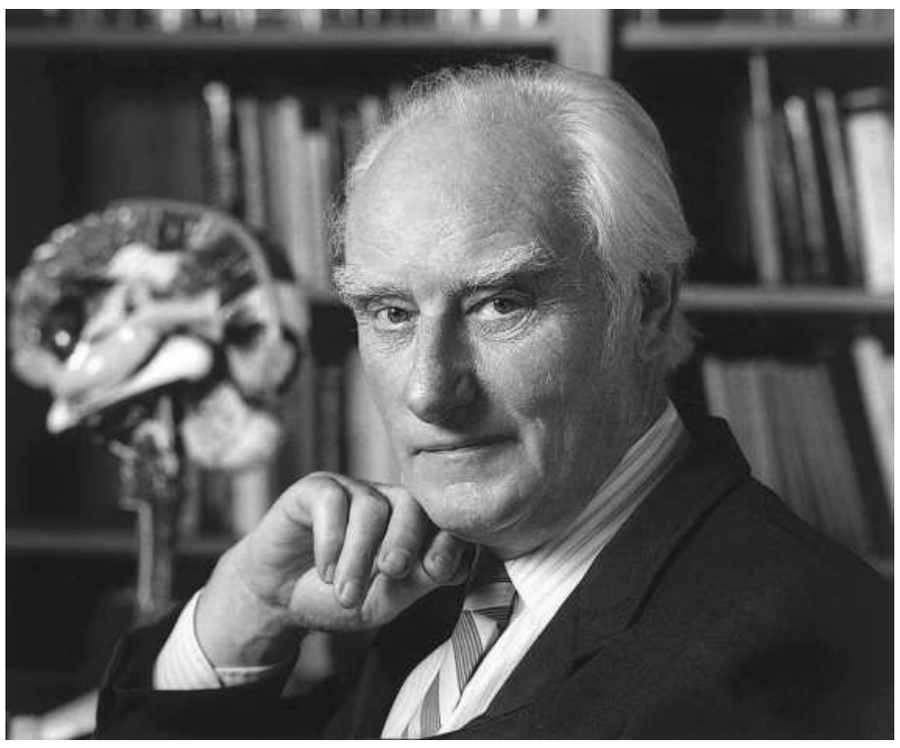
The discovery of DRT3b suggests that a protein can direct the synthesis of a specific DNA sequence without a nucleic-acid template, an unprecedented finding that pushes the boundaries of, but does not overturn, the central dogma of molecular biology

These enzymes belong to a class called defence-associated reverse transcriptases (DRTs). These enzymes help bacteria fight off bacteriophages by producing unusual DNA molecules that trigger defence mechanisms, stopping the invading phage from successfully reproducing. There are several ways in which the DNA produced by DRTs stop a phage infection. Some interfere with essential phage proteins. Some activate other bacterial defence systems. Others cause the infected cell to shut itself down before the phage can multiply and spread.

The new family, called DRT3, described in these two papers, follows a novel mechanism to achieve the last outcome. According to the papers, DRT3 contains two enzymes – DRT3a and DRT3b – that work together to produce the two strands of a DNA molecule.

When this DNA accumulates inside the bacterial cell, it causes the cell to shut down and enter a dormant state, preventing the phage from completing its replication. In normal circumstances, the bacterium keeps this system under control by using a separate set of enzymes that acts as a brake.

But when a phage infects the cell, it makes proteins that inhibit these brakes, causing the DNA made by DRT3 to build up, disrupting the bacterial cell and stopping the phage from spreading.



For seven decades, the central dogma postulated by Francis Crick (1916-2004) has remained unchallenged. MARC LIEBERMAN (CC BY)

Unprecedented in molecular biology

But the most intriguing aspect of the papers was how the DRT3 system made the two DNA strands. DRT3a makes the first strand of the DNA using a bacterial RNA molecule as a template, as reverse transcriptases normally do. But the second enzyme, DRT3b, makes the second strand without using any template at all. Instead, the protein itself dictates the order of the nucleotides that determines the DNA sequence.

Interestingly, enzymes that can make DNA without a template are not new in molecular biology. One example is terminal deoxynucleotidyl transferase, which adds nucleotides to the ends of DNA without using a template. But the transferase does not add nucleotides in any specific order: if you mixed it with all the four nucleotides that make DNA in a tube, the transferase will produce a new sequence each time.

Rule challenged

DRT3b is different primarily in this regard. Although it also makes DNA without a nucleic-acid template, it does not produce a random sequence. The protein itself dictates which nucleotide is added next, producing an ordered sequence of two alternating nucleotides cytosine (C) and adenine (A), i.e. CACACACA... Despite the enzyme’s product being a simple two base pair repeat, the idea of a protein that can produce a defined DNA sequence without a nucleic acid template is unprecedented in molecular biology.

The discovery of a protein that can, by itself, dictate the sequence of nucleic acid has once again caused a stir in the scientific community.

Commentaries accompanying the work have highlighted the unusual nature of the finding and its implications for one of the foundational ideas of molecular biology. Some have gone so far as to suggest that the discovery challenges the central dogma because it appears to demonstrate information flowing from a protein back into a nucleic acid – which is just what Francis Crick had said was impossible.

However, it is important to note that while the study represents an important conceptual advance, in no way does it overturn the central dogma.

The core principle of the central dogma deals with the information lost when it is passed from nucleic acid to protein. That is, once a cell has made a protein, the protein’s amino-acid sequence will not contain enough information for the cell to rebuild the DNA sequence from which it originated. This is because there are many different DNA sequences that can encode the same protein sequence.

DRT3b also does not violate this fundamental principle governing information loss. At most, it puts a toe over the line; it does not cross it. But it does illustrate one point very beautifully: that nature is far more creative than the rules we use to describe it.

(Arun Panchapakesan is an assistant professor at the Y.R. Gaitonde Centre for AIDS Research and Education, Chennai. arun.panchapakesan@gmail.com)



Aerial view of a boat pulling a dead southern right whale calf in Puerto Madryn, Argentina. AFP

Scientists puzzled as whale calves wash up dead in Argentina

Associated Press

Investigators in Argentina are trying to solve the mystery of baby whales washing up dead in unusually high numbers along the country’s Patagonian coast.

Scores of the calf carcasses have been washing ashore around Peninsula Valdes, a major breeding ground for southern right whales in Argentina’s Chubut province. Hunted to the brink of extinction in the 19th and 20th centuries, the whales now gather in the peninsula’s sheltered waters to give birth and nurse their young.

“We’re looking into the whale calf deaths based on 23 years of monitoring that we have of this same population. That’s what allows us to say that this is an unusual event,” said Marcela Uhart, a veterinarian with the One Health Institute at the University of California, Davis, who is leading the investigation as head of the Southern Right Whale Health Monitoring Program.

The leading hypothesis is that the whale calves are suffering infections from marine bacteria that can enter their bodies through injuries inflicted by kelp gulls, Uhart said.

Researchers are searching for the dead calves by boat, plane and drone; they photograph and examine the carcasses, racing against decomposition to collect tissue samples for testing

For decades, the seabirds have pecked at whales surfacing to breathe, gorging on their skin and blubber. Adults learn to surface with only their heads exposed, keeping their backs underwater and out of reach of the gulls. Calves can not do that manoeuvre, leaving them vulnerable to attacks.

The carcasses have been washing ashore around the gulf city of Puerto Madryn, including near the central waterfront where they alarm residents and tourists. Residents have reported hundreds of them, but researchers declined to give a death toll, saying that would become clear after the season ends around late November.

Uhart and a team of biologists, veterinarians, and park rangers have been searching the area for the dead calves from shore and with boats, planes, and drones.

The work is gruesome: they photograph and examine the bodies, racing against decomposition to collect skin and organ samples for testing at a veterinary school farther north, in the city of Tandil. Bacteria have already been detected in those tissues, but researchers are still culturing samples to identify the microbes and determine whether infection was the cause of death, she said.

Even if bacteria are to blame, researchers must still determine why they have become so deadly this year.

Changes in marine conditions like warming sea temperatures, potentially linked to climate change or El Nino, could contribute to “this perfect storm where this bacteria is powerful enough to overcome the immunity of the babies and cause their deaths,” Uhart said. “So to the extent that we can, we’ll try to identify at least what factors may be triggering this event and making it so massive.”

Right whales got their name from whalers who considered them the “right” animals to hunt because they swam slowly, stayed close to shore and floated when killed, according to the International Whaling Commission, a global body tasked with regulating whaling.

Although illegal hunting continued into the 1970s, southern right whales have gradually rebounded since gaining international protection in 1935.

But their recovery remains threatened by the same pressures facing whales worldwide: declining food supplies, fishing gear entanglements, oil spills, and ship strikes.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Decline in India's sunflower oil imports in September

36 in per cent. Indian sunflower oil imports fell in September to their lowest level in more than four years after the Ukraine war disrupted shipments. India's sunflower oil imports plunged 36% from a month earlier to 103,000 metric tonnes in September, dealers' average estimates showed. PTI

Years after which Odisha is holding student union polls

8 Students' union elections will be held in public colleges and universities across Odisha on October 15, ending an eight-year hiatus, Higher Education Minister Suryabanshi Suraj said on Monday. "The election is aimed at preparing the leadership for the future from the college level," he said. PTI

High schools disrupted due to French student protests

413 France high school students protest disrupted lessons at 413 of the country's 3,700 schools on Monday, the Education Ministry said, down from the number of schools affected last week. It said the drop was due to "sustained dialogue with high school students". AFP

Death toll from flooding in Thailand since mid-September

31 Thai authorities on Monday warned of more rain and flash flooding as the death toll from floods across the country since mid-September rose to 31. Thunderstorms, strong winds and heavy rain are expected across much of upper Thailand from Monday through Wednesday. AP

Spain's crude oil imports from January and August

2.32 million metric tonnes. Between January and August, Spain imported 2.32 million metric tonnes of crude from Venezuela, the highest for this period since the 2.39 million tonnes imported in 2006, according to data. REUTERS

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Why is Buxa bringing tigers back?

Why was Buxa chosen for reintroduction? How will the tigers be reintroduced? Why was Valmiki chosen as the source? What are the challenges? Can Buxa sustain a tiger population? How has tiger reintroduction worked in India? Why did tigers disappear from Buxa? How will the reintroduced tigers be monitored?

EXPLAINER

Shiv Sahay Singh

The story so far:

On October 2, a three-year-old tigress, T138, was released in Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal, marking the beginning of a phased programme to reintroduce tigers and establish a viable, self-sustaining population in the reserve. Three more tigers are likely to be introduced to the reserve, which has not recorded much presence of tigers over the past few years.

The tigress was translocated from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve and released in the presence of Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari.

Initially, the tigress would be kept in an enclosed area of about 2.3 hectares to allow the animal to acclimatise to its new surroundings before it is released into the wider reserve. T138 would be subject to intensive post-release monitoring using a combination of telemetry, camera trapping and field-based monitoring to assess her movement, adaptation, health and behaviour.

The release of the tigress is not merely about bringing tigers back to Buxa, but its "objective is to create the conditions in which a tiger population can establish, breed and ultimately become viable and self-sustaining," PIB said in a statement.

Why is Buxa Tiger Reserve significant?

Buxa was declared a tiger reserve in 1983 and is the 15 th tiger reserve in the country. Buxa Tiger Reserve is situated in the Alipurduar Sub-division of Jalpaiguri District, West Bengal.

With an area of 760.87 sq. km, the reserve stretches over a length of 50 km from west to east and 35 km from north to south. The reserve has corridor connectivity across the border with the forests of Bhutan in the north; to the east, it has linkages with the Kochugaon forests, Manas Tiger Reserve, and to the West with the Jaldapara National Park.



Three-year-old tigress, T138, walks through the forest after being released into the wild at Buxa Tiger Reserve, in Alipurduar, West Bengal. PTI

One of the reasons for low tiger density has been changes in the habitat due to increasing anthropogenic pressure. "Over the decades, however, habitat degradation and fragmentation, changes in land use and decline in prey availability have affected the ecological conditions required to sustain a resident tiger population. The Reserve subsequently witnessed a prolonged absence of a stable resident tiger population," a PIB statement said.

Why was Valmiki Tiger Reserve selected for bringing the tigress?

The National Tiger Conservation Authority found that there were no tigers at Buxa, Dampa and Palamu tiger reserves; it initiated a programme of reintroduction of tigers in 2018, which has resulted in the reintroduction of tigers at Buxa. Scientists and forest officials were looking for a habitat similar to Buxa from which the tiger may be brought to the reserve. Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve, which lies in the easternmost part of the Terai Arc Landscape, was considered suitable for tiger augmentation because of the similarities in terrain with Buxa.

West Bengal has a thriving tiger population in the Sundarbans, the only mangrove forest in the world to have tigers. As per the last census, the Indian Sundarbans is home to about 100 tigers in the unique mangrove ecosystem. However, translocating tigers from the Sundarbans to Buxa may not have worked because of the vast differences in the terrain and the habitat.

What has been the experience with reintroduction of tigers?

Tiger 'reintroduction' done in India is the first such scientific endeavour in the world, says NTCA. Reintroducing tigers in the Indian context means establishing a tiger population in an area which was part of its historical range but from where it has gone locally extinct.

The tiger reintroduction has been a successful collaborative venture between the NTCA, State governments, and the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), with numbers of tigers increasing in reserves where the exercise was carried out.

The reintroduction started in 2008 when tigers were successfully reintroduced in Sariska (Rajasthan) and Panna (Madhya Pradesh) Tiger Reserves. The tiger reintroduction programme has been carried out across 12 tiger reserves in less than two decades.

The success of the programme, however, has not been uniform across the reserves.

A publication titled "Reintroduction & Population Recovery of Tigers in India: Field Experiences & Key Learnings" released by NTCA and WII earlier this year has pointed out that relocation of tigers in Satkosia Tiger Reserve posed several challenges. "The translocated tigers encountered difficulties in adapting to the new environment, and the landscape experienced considerable human-tiger conflict, including incidents of livestock depredation and negative local responses," the report said.

The NTCA website also added that in the past there have been few examples of tiger 'release' (Dongarpur in Rajasthan and in Russia) which were not successful owing to several factors.

Keeping these challenges in mind, the NTCA has prepared a protocol on tiger re-introduction. The protocol deals with aims and objectives of reintroduction, constitution of team, pre-project activities, conducting feasibility study, selection and evaluation of site, suitability of release stock of tigers, socio-economic requirements, preparation for release and post-release activities.

What are the challenges?

Buxa Tiger Reserve had not had a resident tiger for several years, though on some occasions tigers have been recorded in the winter months.

The reserve is dotted with settlements and surrounded by revenue villages and tea estates. The State government has convinced about 300 families to relocate so that they can make the tiger reintroduction exercise successful. Wildlife, particularly elephants, has been threatened by linear infrastructure including a railway line, resulting in the deaths of hundreds of pachyderms over the decade. Because the region lies close to Bhutan, heavy commercial traffic on the road connecting Bhutan and West Bengal through Buxa poses an additional concern.

THE GIST

- A three-year-old tigress from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve has been released in Buxa Tiger Reserve as part of a phased programme to establish a viable, self-sustaining tiger population
- Valmiki was chosen because its terrain is similar to Buxa, while translocation from the Sundarbans was considered unsuitable due to differences in habitat and terrain
- The reintroduction faces challenges including habitat degradation, low prey availability, human settlements, linear infrastructure and heavy commercial traffic through the reserve

Why are States divided over the mining amendment?

Amendment curbs States' fiscal powers, but their responses vary with dependence and political alignment

Safira Hussain
Sanjay Kumar

In a federal country like India, differences between the Centre and the States over certain issues are not unusual. One such instance recently arose over the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026, passed by Parliament.

Under the amended Act, the Centre's regulatory powers over mining have been expanded to cover not only mines and mineral development but also mineral-bearing lands. It bars States from imposing fresh taxes on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands, except under conditions prescribed by the Union government. It also cancels mineral taxes imposed by States but not fully collected before the Act came into force.

Mines and minerals are a subject over which legislative powers are divided between the Centre and the States. State governments are empowered to regulate mines and minerals under entry 23 of the State List, but this power is subject to central legislation as per entry 54 of the Union List. The latter entry gives Parliament the discretion to determine the extent of authority over mining regulation and development in the public interest. The Constitution also gives States powers to tax mineral rights and land through entries 50 and 49 of the State List. The recent amendment draws on the Centre's regulatory authority over mineral development to place new limits on these State-level taxing powers. So, the issue widens from mining regulation to the fiscal autonomy of mineral-rich States.

The amended provisions contradict the constitutional position articulated by the Supreme Court in 2024. The court held that States can tax mineral rights, subject to Parliament's power to limit this in the public interest, while their power to tax mineral-bearing land cannot be curtailed through Parliament's powers under Entry 54. The Centre has argued that uneven and multiple State-level taxes raise the cost of domestic minerals, prompting industries to turn to imports and placing an additional burden on the exchequer. By invalidating unrecovered past dues, the law hits at the potential source of revenue for States, narrowing the prospective mineral-related revenue for some of the major mineral-bearing States.

The fiscal stakes

Mineral-related receipts account for 85% of non-tax revenue in Jharkhand and 80% in Odisha, compared with 48% in Karnataka, 41% in Madhya Pradesh and 39% in Rajasthan. Telangana and Chhattisgarh are less dependent, with mineral receipts making up 11% and 6%, respectively. For Jharkhand and Odisha, restrictions on the ability to impose or retain mineral-related levies therefore have significant fiscal implications, while the immediate impact may be smaller in Telangana and Chhattisgarh. Odisha is particularly revealing in this regard. Despite deriving a substantial share of its non-tax revenue from minerals, the State has not responded with a unified position. The Opposition has demanded a special Assembly session. The BJP-led State government, however, has rejected the demand and argued that the amendment would not harm Odisha's mineral revenues. Telangana, where mineral receipts account for only about 11% of non-tax revenue, has also joined other non-NDA-ruled States intending to move the Supreme Court against the amendment. While Karnataka, Telangana, Himachal Pradesh and Kerala are planning to challenge the law in the Supreme Court, arguing that the restrictions on State taxation of mineral rights and mineral-bearing land undermine States' fiscal powers and federalism, Kerala has additionally argued that treating mineral-bearing land in this manner gives the Centre wider powers over areas such as the State's coastal and forest regions. Jharkhand has also raised objections, with the Chief Minister warning that the loss of revenue from mineral taxes could affect social-security schemes benefiting millions because the amended Act renders certain uncollected past dues invalid. By contrast, there has been no comparable challenge from States such as Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan or Chhattisgarh so far.

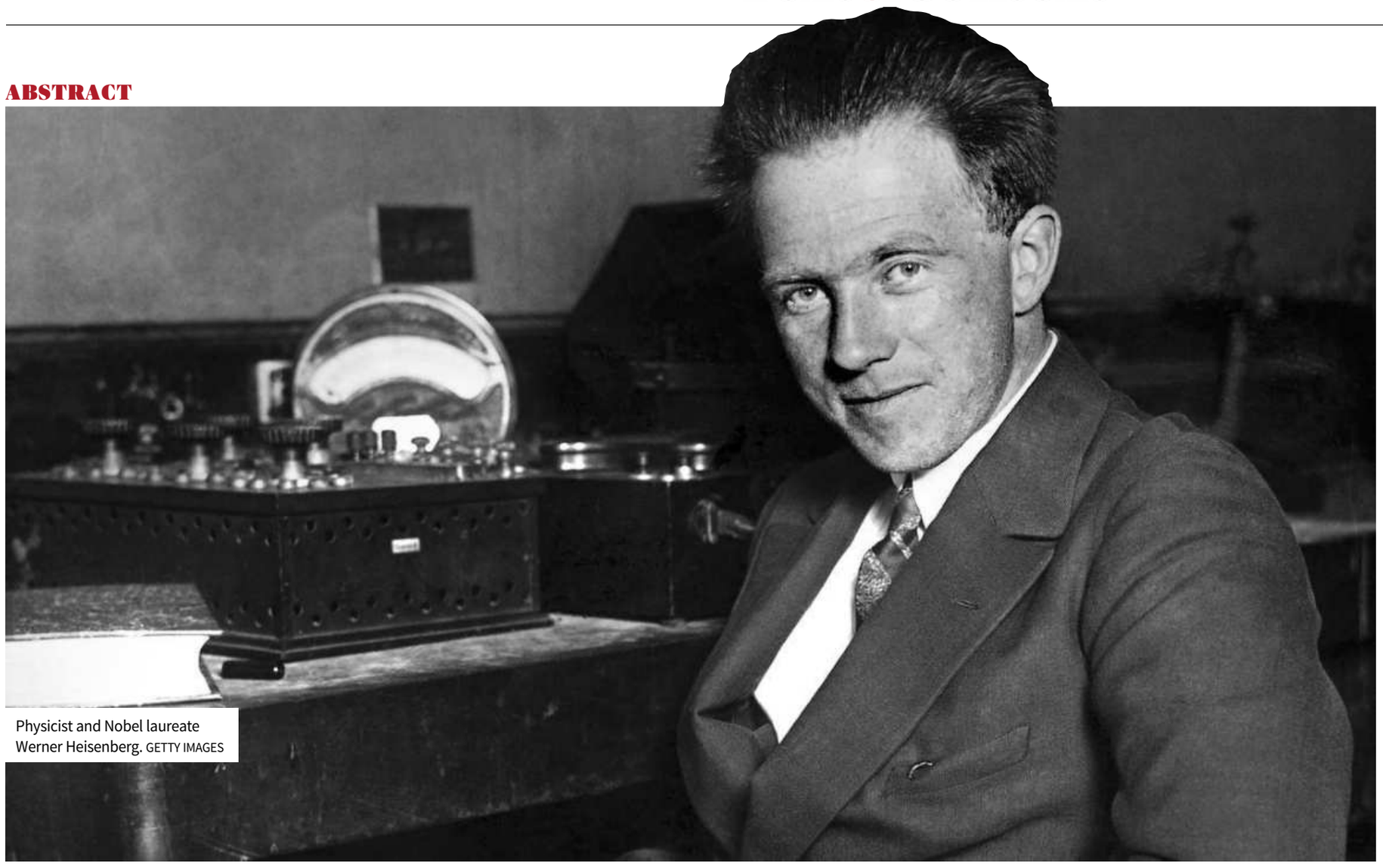
The political geography of this discontent points to an interesting feature of Indian federalism. Even when the underlying concern is perceived erosion of States' fiscal space, the extent to which it becomes a federal issue varies across States. Mineral dependence creates a material stake, while political alignment may influence whether that stake translates into an organised federal challenge.

India's fiscal federal structure comes across as asymmetric rather than purely decentralised. It gives greater taxation powers to the Centre while placing greater expenditure responsibilities on the States in several areas. The Centre has significant influence over borrowing and transfers to the States, which restricts State autonomy when they depend on the Centre's transfers or require its approval for borrowing. How much fiscal autonomy do States possess, and how far can the Union influence it often becomes a bone of contention between them.

The evolving Indian federal dynamic is marked by push and pull between the central authority and States' autonomy. Conflicts between the Centre and the States over legislative jurisdiction, fiscal resources, administrative control, and even foreign policy engagements have surfaced time and again, be it over the GST compensation, the terms of reference for Finance Commissions, the National Education Policy, the Citizenship Amendment Act, and proposed amendments to All-India Services rules, to list a few. This amendment therefore adds another fault line to India's continuing Centre-State contest over legislative authority and fiscal autonomy.

(Safira Hussain is currently associated with Lokniti-CSDS; Sanjay Kumar is a Professor and an election analyst)

ABSTRACT



Physicist and Nobel laureate Werner Heisenberg. GETTY IMAGES

The Nazi nuke: Werner Heisenberg was more off target than he believed

Using nuclear archaeology, scientists have found that the Nobel laureate may have grossly overestimated his team's ability to build a nuclear weapon by 1945; they found that Germany lacked the uranium, heavy water, and reactor-grade graphite needed to achieve a sustained chain reaction

Vasudevan Mukunth

Patrick J. Park, Brittany Robertson, Miriam E. Hiebert, Jason Zhao, Ciara B. Sivels and Timothy W. Koeth, 'Nuclear archaeology reassesses Heisenberg's last reactor experiment', PNAS Nexus, Vol. 5, Issue No. 9, September 29, 2026

Hans Bethe. Felix Bloch. Niels Bohr. Albert Einstein. Enrico Fermi. James Franck. Otto Frisch. Samuel Goudsmit. Lilli Hornig. Rolf Landshoff. Maria Goeppert Mayer. Rudolf Peierls. George Placzek. Eugene Rabinowitch. Joseph Rotblat. Leo Szilard. Edward Teller. Stanislaw Ulam. John von Neumann. Victor Weisskopf. Eugene Wigner. These are just some of the scientists who had emigrated from Europe, many of whom later made critical contributions to the Manhattan Project – the American effort to build the world's first nuclear weapon.

Many of these scientists had seen firsthand the horrors Nazi Germany was perpetrating in Europe; many were Jews who were escaping persecution themselves. They showed their contempt for Adolf Hitler and his armies by bringing a sense of urgency to their research on the bomb, and were often motivated by what they believed the stake was: the fate of the world itself.

The Manhattan Project tested its first atom bomb on July 16, 1945, and delivered two to the U.S. military in July-August. Part of their sense of urgency was rooted in doubts about whether Nazi Germany was also building a bomb, including some groups led by the physicist and Nobel laureate Werner Heisenberg. The anxieties were not unfounded: in April 1945, only weeks before Germany surrendered to Allied forces, Heisenberg's team had assembled a nuclear reactor in a cellar beneath a church in Haigerloch, in the country's south.

The setup, called the B8 pile, had 664 cubes of uranium suspended on chains in around 1,400 litres of heavy water. A 40-cm-thick shell of graphite surrounded the core, and was itself surrounded by a layer of aluminium and a 60-cm-thick layer of (ordinary) water. The team had taken six years to build B8 but had little to show for it. When a few neutrons were shot into the reactor, the uranium multiplied them into more – but no chain reaction followed.

Far from critical

After the war ended, Heisenberg said the team had come very close; he wrote in a 1947 article in *Nature* that Haigerloch didn't have enough resources and that just a little more quantity of uranium would have done the trick.

According to a new study in *PNAS Nexus*, by researchers from the U.S., Heisenberg & co. were actually way off the mark.

Only around 14 of the 1,100 or so uranium cubes made for Heisenberg's efforts still survive. Using a pycnometer, the team found the density of one cube to be 18.535 g/cm3, lower than the 19.01 g/cm3 of solid uranium, indicating the cube was porous. Another cube contained 0.724% of uranium-235 (by mass), meaning it was natural rather than enriched uranium.

In March 1944, a German physicist named Karl Wirtz had reported that Nazi Germany's stocks of heavy water had accidentally been diluted to 98.85% purity. A post-war sample from Haigerloch in 1947 found only 96.8% purity. The team also started from the records of aluminium giant Norsk Hydro to estimate that Nazi Germany had a maximum supply of 1,836 kg of pure heavy water during the war.

When the team worked upwards from here, including the design of the B8 pile, they concluded it had a neutron multiplication factor of 0.942. A reactor needs to have a factor of 1 to be critical. A difference of 0.058 is actually large. The team found that the uranium cubes in B8 were arranged too close together, preventing the heavy water from efficiently slowing the neutrons. The researchers estimated that increasing the heavy water's purity to 100% would improve the factor to only 0.95.

They also simulated over 1,200 combinations of uranium and heavy water and found that the B8 pile would have required at least 2,994 kg of uranium and 3,411 litres of heavy water to become critical. B8 however, contained 1,538 kg of uranium and 1,549 kg of heavy water when it was dismantled. More importantly, the team also estimated all German facilities at the time combined possessed only 2,572 kg of uranium and 1,890 kg of 96.8%-pure heavy water – a significant shortfall and which could support a factor of 0.959 at best.

The first U.S. reactor, called Chicago Pile-1, first became critical on December 2, 1942, using natural uranium as fuel and graphite, rather than heavy water, as the moderator. So some nuclear historians have opined that Heisenberg *et al*. had simply picked the wrong moderator.

A 2025 study in *The European Physical Journal H* demurred, however: while the U.S. was able to source petroleum coke extremely low in boron and turn it into reactor-grade graphite, the graphite made from metallurgical coke in Germany was high in boron, which absorbs neutrons. The B8 pile used the graphite from the predecessor B7 pile, and the new study also found that it contained 3.4 weight-parts per million (wppm) of equivalent boron contamination. The Siemens graphite from earlier contained around 6.6 wppm. On the other hand, the Manhattan Project used graphite with around 1.4 wppm of boron. In simulations, it didn't matter how far apart the uranium cubes in the B7 pile or in any previous piles could have been: the contamination made criticality impossible.

The significant difference between the Nazi German and the Manhattan Project programmes, then, seems to have been industrial capacity. The Americans developed and built multiple technologies to enrich uranium, set up reactors and chemical separation units, and a weapons laboratory, which together created 1.3 lakh jobs and invested $2.2 billion at the peak. Nazi Germany had nothing of similar scale.

According to a 2015 study in *Angewandte Chemie*, some uranium from the Nazi nuclear programme had not experienced a significant neutron flux and had probably come from Joachimsthal in today's Czechia, indicating (in a limited sense) the absence of an industrial uranium enrichment programme.

Many questions about the Nazi nuclear programme still remain open, often rooted in different interpretations of common data. Some important ones are centered on whether German scientists deliberately delayed the bomb project. Some technical questions are open, too. For example, the purity of the heavy water at Haigerloch itself is unknown and the graphite's boron content is based on archival rather than direct, firsthand information.

The overall picture today is neither that German physicists were incompetent nor that they were tantalisingly close to building a bomb. Their base of materials fell short of what a nuclear programme required and their supply chains were not good enough. Ultimately, given the information available at the time, and more so given Germany was also home to many of the world's best nuclear physicists, the Manhattan Project scientists' concerns were understandable.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Test yourself on India's show at the recently concluded Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1
The 85-medal tally is India's second-highest ever haul at the Asian Games, following the record 107 at Hangzhou 2022. With which country did India tie for the gold medals with 21?

QUESTION 2
Who was the only Indian to win all three types of medals, and in which events?

QUESTION 3
At 15 years, 6 months, and 6 days old, who became India's youngest-ever gold medal winner?

QUESTION 4
Which sport gave India the maximum gold medals with five?

QUESTION 5
Apart from Neeru Dhanda in shooting, who else returned with two gold medals to his/her name?

QUESTION 6
Pincky Balhara and Suchika Tariyal won bronze medals in which contact sports?



Visual Question:
Identify this person. She became the first Indian woman to win an individual gold medal in which sport? REUTERS

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Singeetham began his career as an assistant to which esteemed director? **Ans: K.V. Reddy**
2. '*Dikkatra Parvathi*' won the National Film Award for Best Feature Film in Tamil in 1974. On which Bharat Ratna's literary work was it based? **Ans: Rajaji (C. Rajagopalachari)**
3. Singeetham had the honour of directing Rajkumar's 200th and Kamal Haasan's 100th film. **Ans: '*Devatha Manushya*' and '*Raja Paarvai*', respectively**
4. Of his 61 films, what is special about these four: '*Bhagyada Lakshmi Baramma*', '*Samyuktha*', '*Ghatothkach*' and '*Welcome Obama*'? **Ans: He also composed the music**
5. Name the 1985 biographical dance film based on the life of Sudha Chandran. **Ans: '*Mayuri*'**
6. He was an executive director of which National Award-winning 1970 film? **Ans: '*Samskara*'**
7. He is credited with creating the first dialogue-less feature film in 1987. Ans: '***Pushpaka Vimana***' (Pushpak/Pesum Padam)
8. The famous song sequence '*Sundari Neeyum*' from '*Michael Madhana Kama Rajan*' was visualised differently. How? **Ans: It was filmed at 48 fps instead of the normal 24 fps to give it a romantic slow-motion feel**
9. What is special about '*Sing Geetham*'? **Ans: All the dialogues are in a 'sing-song' format**
Visual: This is a screengrab of Singeetham making a cameo with a bioscope to introduce a film with a song. Name the film. **Ans: '*Michael Madhana Kama Rajan*'**
Early Birds: Arun Kumar Singh | G. L. Vadhera | Dodo Jayaditya | Sudhir Thapa | Sunil Madhavan



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

"What is the meaning of 'wicked'?"

"Wicked? Well, when you say that someone is wicked, it means that he/she is evil. He/she is behaving in a way...."

"I know that meaning of wicked! But does it have another meaning?"

"Another meaning? Well, I have heard...."

"...you see, today my cousin in America emailed me saying that the Harry Potter movie is wicked. What does he mean by that? How can a movie be "wicked"?"

"Well, what he means is that the movie is excellent. In informal contexts, the word 'wicked' is used to mean excellent."

"Wicked means excellent? You are joking, right?"

"No, I am not. Native speakers of English use the word 'wicked' to mean 'excellent or impressive'. For example, I can say, the masala dosai that you get in that restaurant is wicked."

"I bought some really wicked shoes last weekend. How does that sound?"

"Sounds great. But remember, this use of the word 'wicked' is restricted to informal contexts. It is considered to be slang by many people."

"Ok, I'll try and remember that. Let's hope I get some...."

".... where did you get that shirt? It's really tight."

"This shirt is not tight. Most of my friends have said that it's a great shirt."

"I agree. It is a great shirt. No doubt about it."

"But you said it was tight. How can...."

".... one of the meanings of 'tight' is excellent."

"You mean 'tight' and 'wicked' mean the same thing?"

"That's right. In informal contexts, they can both mean the same thing. "Look at those really tight shoes that the woman is wearing. How does that sound?"

"Sounds good to me. You must see Lord of the Rings. It's really tight."

"But when a person says, ' Those shoes are really tight, how do we know what he means? Does he mean that the shoes are really tight or...."

"... I understand what you are saying. Well, I guess the meaning will depend on the context."

"That makes sense."

"That does make sense, doesn't it? But what you are doing doesn't."

"What do you mean?"

"Well, with the exams around the corner, shouldn't you be studying? Most of your friends are pounding the books."

"Pounding the books? Does it mean studying very hard?"

"That's right. When you 'hit the books', or 'pound the books', you study very hard. For example, my neighbour's son has been pounding the books for over six months now."

"I spent the entire weekend pounding the books."

"You could also say, I spent the entire weekend hitting the books."

"I've been hitting the books for over three months now."

"It's about time that you became a study animal."

"A study animal? Does it mean someone who studies all the time?"

"Students refer to person who studies very hard as a 'study animal'. People tell me that my friend Madhu is a study animal."

"My sister has been a study animal."

"Too bad you aren't one."

"I know. I wish I could become a study animal."

Published in The Hindu on March 5, 2002

Word of the day

Vicissitude:
a variation in circumstances or fortune at different times in your life or in the development of something

Synonyms: ordeal, misfortune, tragedy, challenge, trouble, adversity, difficulty

Usage: *She faced many vicissitudes after moving to a new city.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/vicissitude

International Phonetic Alphabet: /vɪsɪsɪtjuːd/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'